GABI PREVOT

FORGOTTEN GODS

Blue Futanari: Series Book 2

Forgotten Gods

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Gabie Prevot

OceanofPDF.com

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Contents

Title Page
Copyright
*7 1691
*8 Seduction
*9 Aria
*10 Ravenous
*11 Preceptors
*12 Treachery
Author's Note

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*7 1691

The path into the city was little more than a dirt track that led to three or four, simple, wooden buildings. The products of the trees that had once been the path, they were rough cut, too simple, and less than uniform. The village itself was no more than space forcibly taken from the forest, a small clearing where the sky was visible for a hundred or so paces before it was swallowed by pine and oak.

Standing in the middle of the path, staring at the tiny village, I didn't know what to do. I had a few minutes, maybe less, before a band of a hundred or so Indians, armed to the teeth with strange looking swords, little hatchets, and bows, burst from the forest like a swarm of angry hornets and attacked. One of the buildings was a church with a little, two-story bell tower. I took a breath and concentrated, I was weak, but I had to help. The bell tower.

With a blink, I found myself inside the church, a space steeped in history and hushed reverence. The place was little more than one large, square room. There were two sets of four, straight-backed wooden pews, a small wooden cross on the wall over a simple podium, and a prayer bench.

My knees were weak. I was exhausted. My failed attack on Toniat had wiped me out. I tried to focus what strength I had left. Then I heard her thoughts.

Is there even a god? I mean, do I really believe there is some invisible, magical man somewhere keeping an eye on everything and everyone? I think my mother was right, if there is a god, she's a woman. My mother was right. This separatist, puritan talk is nonsense. The old ways. They hate the old ways.

I turned around to find a young woman, her eyes filled with a mix of determination and sorrow, striding toward the front of the church. Her black hair, streaked with hints of gray, framed a face that had seen hardship, yet her posture spoke of resilience and unyielding faith.

She was tall and thin, in her early twenties with pitch, black hair, fair skin, and green eyes. She was a beauty by anyone’s standards and, had it been my own time, I imagine she would have been an actress or a model, a woman with a string of men behind her, each trying to outspend the other for her affections. But in the light of a church hundreds of years before the advent of even the most basic luxuries, she was a beautiful woman in a hard place. It showed in the expression on her face - the furrowed brows and pursed lips. She was the picture of unhappiness, an angry woman in rigid clothing and uncomfortable shoes.

Her footsteps reverberated through the room, each resonant tap echoing my own uncertainty. Her eyes were furrowed in frustration. She flattened the front of her plain, black dress with both hands as she walked past me and I felt like I was in the middle of an historical reenactment from a time period I knew almost nothing about. Where am I? I wondered.

I can’t believe I have to hide inside a church. How I wish I was a man. If I were a man, I would have beaten him senseless last night. What folly! What a foolish thing to do. How could he take a loan against a house that isn’t even built yet? She reached the little prayer bench and stopped.

From my vantage at the back of the church, I observed her every step, my empathy for her palpable. She was troubled and, instinctively, something inside of me wanted to help. I wanted to ease her frustration, wanted to put her mind at ease.

As she knelt and bowed her head, her whispered plea for protection and prosperity hung in the air, making me ponder the beginning of such a journey.

I wondered myself if he was up there. There were other gods, Toniat and Muma had taught me that, but what about here and now? Was the god that everyone always talked about, the god of the Bible and Christianity real? What of Buddha? The devil? I started to follow the chain of thought but then remembered why I had come to the church - the attack was coming.

The bell tower seemed a later addition, a testament to the passage of time since the church's first stones were laid. Behind the podium was a small, plank door that led to the little, two-story tower that held the bell. I slipped through the door.

The room was small and lit only by the light that made it past the roof and the bell a few meters over my head. I thought of the approaching Indians and the coming attack. I didn’t have the energy to stop them and, even if I did, I wasn’t sure how. I had never done anything so grand before. No, the only thing I could do was warn the village. I wrapped my hands around the rope and pulled.

Within a moment, the bell was clanging back and forth alerting all who could hear and vibrating every board and slat.

After half a minute, the little door to my right opened and the woman who had been about to pray was staring at me. I knew I was invisible, or was fairly sure, I mean she hadn’t seen me when she walked into the church, but now.

A perplexed furrow creased her brow as her gaze swept from my head to my feet, leaving me to wonder how much she truly saw. *Who? Are her eyes glowing? That robe, it’s so…and the symbols…are they moving? What is she?*

My breath caught as I spoke, urgency pushing each syllable out, "Native Americans!" The words hung in the air, a plea for understanding and action, a plea that I hoped would transcend the gulf between our worlds.

Amid the anxiety-laden silence, her gaze met mine, a perplexed crease furrowing her brow as if grappling with the urgency in my voice.

I questioned how much she could truly see - my otherworldly robe, the symbols that seemed to dance upon it. Were my fears and purpose as transparent as my presence?

Her gaze held mine for a fleeting moment before sliding away, leaving a trail of uncertainty in its wake. She uttered no words, and though her lips remained closed, I could almost hear the thoughts tumbling through her mind, like a waterfall of curiosity and disbelief.

Then, a sudden intrusion. A man, aged by the passage of time yet harboring a kindness in his demeanor, stepped into the doorway, his gaze shifting between the woman and the bell in the tower above.

The woman's startled response was palpable, her discomfort evident in the downward cast of her gaze. The interaction felt like an intimate dance

of shared secrets and unspoken emotions. She stared into my eyes and I could tell that the words had rolled off of her like water.

“The town is about to be attacked! A group of Indians…”

Her gaze went from my face to my robe again and I was just about to shift into something that her mind wouldn’t wrestle with when a man stepped into the doorway behind her.

He was older, in his early fifties. His hair was cut short and gray and his face, though hardened and wrinkled, held a certain kindness. He looked at her and then up at the bell in the tower. “Hester?”

The woman almost jumped out of her skin. “Pastor.” She looked down at the ground between them like she was embarrassed.

“What’s the meaning of this? Why have you rung the bell, child?”

Hester glanced over at where I stood and then back at the pastor. “Indians,” she said. “Indians are about to attack the village.”

A flicker of concern washed over the pastor's features, his complexion paling as if the gravity of the situation had solidified before him. "Are you certain?" he queried, his voice catching on the edge of desperation.

The woman's response held a steadfast resolve, her affirmation unshaken, like a beacon amidst the encroaching shadows. "Yes," she replied, the word carrying the weight of conviction.

The pastor's hands clenched the rope with renewed vigor, the bell's resonating chime punctuating the air with each forceful pull. But then, as if struck by a lightning of thought, his gaze shifted to Hester. "Remain here, Hester," he instructed, his words a mixture of command and concern. "Guard the tower, but do not sound the bell." A purposeful nod, a hurried closing of the door, and his retreating footsteps marked his departure.

As the pastor vanished from view, the sudden hush of silence intensified the building tension. My presence, once a secret observer, now felt like a shadow in plain sight, a witness to the unfolding drama.

The distant murmur of voices reached my ears, a growing assembly of people gathering in the street, their anxiety a palpable undercurrent. I stepped back through the tower wall.

How did she see me? The question gnawed at my mind, defying logic. I was certain I had been invisible, a mere wisp in the shadows. I Was it because I was weak or because of where I was?

***

I walked around the church until I could see the crowd. The realization that she could see me shouldn't have shocked me; my strength was a fading ember, a dwindling force that left me vulnerable, exposed, and questioning my own abilities. It was true, the little strength I had left was waning. I had never felt so exhausted like I could sleep for a week. Everything I did drained me further, took more from me, but I couldn’t stop. I had to help and something inside of me drove me on.

Less than fifty people had gathered in the middle of the street. The pastor burst from the church doors, his face flushed with panic, his voice cracking as he shouted: “Indians! Indians are approaching!”

Most in the crowd turned toward him. A few went for their horses and started down the road. Fear and wonder went through most of the crowd. Those with children gathered them close. Others mumbled their disapproval and worry while they waited for action.

A figure, towering over the pastor, stepped forward, his inquiry slicing through the unsettled air like a blade, demanding attention. His clothes were neater and obviously more expensive. Where everyone else in the group seemed to be in desperate need of a laundry - hemlines and cuffs were covered in road dust, coats were threadbare, and shoes were worn - this man's attire was pristine, as if freshly tailored, standing in stark contrast to the worn garments around him.

“Hester Winthrop,” the pastor said.

A ripple of recognition passed through some in the crowd as Hester's name reached their ears. “She rang the bell?” The taller man stared at the church as he spoke.

“Yes, brother. She must have seen them on her way into the village, she must have…”

“Yes, little brother. She must have passed by a troop of Indians on their way to attack the village.” He laughed the words and turned to two

men behind him. “Gather the muskets.” The two men turned and headed toward the largest building of the four, others in the small crowd followed.

“Brother, we can’t fight them. There could be fifty or more.” The pastor wrung his hands. The worry dripped from every syllable.

“Little brother,” the tall man said, his voice dripping with sarcasm as he laid a heavy hand on his older brother’s shoulder. “God will protect his children from the heathens, isn’t that what the Bible says?” The pastor's face tightened, but he said nothing, his faith unwavering.

He looked at the rest of the people, the women and children who stared at him waiting for direction. “Come with me, come into the church. We will be safe there.”

***

Time stood still, stretching seconds into a seemingly endless stretch of minutes. The air grew charged with an anticipation that hung in the atmosphere, like an impending storm ready to break free.

Gradually, a sense of unity coalesced from the uncertainty. Between thirty and forty men, faces etched with determination, formed a human wall along the street outside the tiny church. Muskets rested in their hands, a testament to their readiness, while the glint of swords and hunting knives hinted at a defiance unwilling to yield. Their collective presence painted a portrait of resolve, a defiance against the encroaching shadows.

Atop the bell tower, I gained a vantage over the forest and beyond. In truth it was unnecessary. I could feel the anxious excitement of the raiding party as they approached. Their energy, foreign and unsettling, tickled across my skin, a sensation far removed from the familiar blue wisps of sexual energy I knew. It was a new, raw force, and it resonated within me.

As they reached the village, they spread out across the edge of the forest. The men on the street heard them moving in but waited for the tall man to give them orders.

“Did you hear that, Mr. Tucker?” A man with a long mustache and a musket taller than he was looked up at the crisply-dressed man beside him.

Tucker stared off into the forest between the buildings. “Show yourselves,” he aimed his musket into the shadows. “You have come to find

your end, you deviled heathens.”

Eyes darted between Tucker and fellow villagers, uncertainty and fear mirrored in their glances. Of the group, he was obviously the bravest, the man all of them believed in and his strength held the rest steady.

And then it started.

With a deadly whistle, a hatchet flew from the shadowed forest, striking Tucker's loyal friend, a man who had grown from a timid recruit to a courageous fighter. The impact was more than physical; it was a blow to Tucker's heart, a loss that would shape him into a more hardened and resolute leader.

The sickening crack of bone resonated through the air, akin to the snap of a dry branch underfoot. His musket fired and he fell to the dirt with little more than a grunt.

A deafening cacophony of gunfire erupted, a relentless volley of fifteen or twenty shots, each one a manifestation of fear, determination, and a desperate will to survive.

Shouts and cries rang out as Indians sprang from the woods. Their war cries echoed between the buildings.

The men in front of the church reloaded as fast as they could. Tucker pulled a small, silver pistol from his belt, fired, and a man fell, face first, into the dirt.

More shots rang out and more Indians fell and writhed in the street.

A man to Tucker’s left let out a gut-wrenching scream as the long, thin shaft of an arrow suddenly protruded from his belly, a cruel and unexpected invader.

“Keep firing!” Tucker yanked the arrow back through the man and threw it on the ground. “Kill them all!”

I couldn’t bear to watch any longer, the street a nightmarish tableau of falling bodies, screams of agony, and the relentless clash of battle. The men in the city fired and reloaded. Indians rushed forward screaming while other’s fired bows or threw axes. There were far more Indians than townsmen, but the muskets seemed to hold the Indians back. I couldn’t tell if they were afraid or if there was some plan, something they were waiting for. But Tucker didn’t care. He rallied his men, shouting that they fire or

reload or pointing out into the forest wherever he was sure he had seen one of the painted faces.

Desperation clawed at me. How could I intervene? How could I halt this tide of violence? Closing my eyes, I focused on the energy around me. I couldn't see it, but I could feel it. It was dirty and dark - the strange mix of bravery and fear of anger and regret. I drew it in, energy coursing through me.

My essence deepened, shadowed, as if a dark shroud had engulfed my very soul, casting a chilling pallor over my existence. Anger welled inside of me. Inhaling deeply, arms outstretched, I manifested atop the bell tower.

Look at me. I sent the thought through the forest like a wave.

The dark energy of the battle attached to me like tendrils of black smoke.

The Indians stared up at the bell tower and found my eyes glowing blue, my robe awash with golden symbols that swirled across the fabric, and my most disapproving look. I stood as an angry goddess, a figure of judgment they had never seen before, my wrath spreading through their ranks like wildfire, igniting terror. Amidst gunfire and screams, they bellowed, fingers tremblingly aimed at me. Wrath incarnate, I ignited dread, their panicked flight echoing.

***

When I was sure the majority of the Indians had retreated and the battle was all but finished, I disappeared. Of the villagers that had fought, more than half were standing, but the street was littered with dead. Bodies lay face down in dark brown patches - a mix of dirt and blood, some at odd angles, rag dolls devoid of life and spirit. A few were wounded. The air was filled with groans and cries. Where there wasn't death there was pain and where there was neither, there was regret and pity.

I ventured into the mind of a dying man, navigating the labyrinth of his pain and fear, feeling the echoes of his lost dreams and unspoken love for his family. Each memory was a poignant reminder of a life once vibrant, now slipping away. I reached into his memories and showed him the joy of

his life, his children, his marriage - there was little else I could do Too weak to heal, I found myself ill-prepared for this heart of darkness I now confronted, a stark contrast to my past and rebirth.

I had never been surrounded by death before. I had seen movies, the gentle Hollywood depictions, but real battle was something different, something vicious and dark. No victors, only the survivors - stark reality of a world drenched in the aftermath.

Craving solace, I slipped into the forest's embrace, grappling with this newfound wellspring of power. Past the lines of fallen Native Americans, I turned north away from the village and toward the sea. The trees were almost empty of leaves. The air was cool. Autumn was close. Every breeze rolled the forest floor, dry leaves tumbled and scraped. I took a deep breath and watched the forest breath around me. A squirrel clung upside down to a tree trunk, a raven called out for its mate from a high branch, and a fallen tree lay like the ancient bones of a great dragon, all part of the forest's living tapestry.

I caught the scent of the ocean, the salt in the air. It was a smell that took me back to my childhood, to summers spent on the beach, to bright sunlight and bathing suits. I stepped onto the shore and dug my toes into the cool sand. The water gently lapped at my ankles.

As far as the eye could see, the beach was empty. The horizon was clear of ships. The world around me seemed, for a moment, untouched and almost new. I drew a deep, shuddering breath, fighting back the sadness that welled in my eyes and lodged a lump in my throat, a physical manifestation of my despair.

I didn’t know where I was. I didn’t know how to get back. Muma had said that time was a hard thing to manipulate even for a god, but Toniat had made it seem easy. I thought back to the moment I was flying towards her ready to strike - the look in her eye, that wicked smile, and then in the space of a heartbeat, she cast me back, flung me through time like a stone.

In my own time, I had been a stranger to my true self. But here, in this unfamiliar place, my confusion deepened. I sat down on a large gray boulder, light blue tears rolling down my cheeks, a manifestation of my despair. I needed help. Without it, I was fairly sure I would wither and what? Die?

Muma. Muma where are you? I need you, Muma. Can you hear me? Doubt gnawed at me. Was he even part of this reality? Though my surroundings resembled the birth of America and the New World, there was no guarantee that I was in the same reality, or even the same world.

My evening with Muma had taught me that much - that there was more than one reality, more than the plane of existence that humans inhabited. No, there were far more from the planes that my kind came from to others that my kind could no longer reach.

I watched the waves roll onto the shore, their rhythmic dance mesmerizing. Staring out across the water, I lost myself in the vast expanse, feeling both connected and adrift. I was getting used to feeling alone, getting used to having nothing, but I was getting dangerously weak and I knew it. I had seen Enele weakness when I rescued her and, though I may not have been as weak, I was heading in the same direction. Without worship, I would disappear and Toniat would finally have her victory - the end of her sister and her power - forever.

I need a supplicant, someone to believe in me. I sighed, memories of Julia flooding my mind. She had given herself to me wholly, completely, and without question. Her love, her worship, had been a balm to my soul. Just the thought of her love warmed my insides. It was such a wonderful thing, the way it felt to be worshiped.

Something called to me. I stood up and looked around. It felt like something tugging at my soul like there was an invisible bit of string wrapped around my thoughts and somewhere someone was gently pulling. I closed my eyes and tried to focus on the sensation, it was new and strange, I had never felt anything quite like it.

And then I understood. Someone was calling for me. Where is it coming from? How can I follow it? I turned back toward the south, toward the village. It was a woman, I could hear her thoughts and I recognized it. Hester.

***

Smoke rose from a pile of hewn timbers and roughly hewn planks. There was a body on the ground beside the pile of smolder and smoke. Part of his head was missing, the rest was charred. The scene looked violent. Whoever had come through had acted like a storm, a hurricane of death and

destruction. Hester was a few meters from the house and the dead man. She knelt along the edge of the forest. Her eyes were closed and she was mumbling words that I both recognized and understood, Latin, an ancient dialect. I moved closer and saw on the ground in front of her a vine that she had woven into an ornate pattern - a spiral intersected with a four pointed star. She had placed a blossom of a red flower on each point of the star.

Magic. The realization struck me like a bolt of lightning. She's casting a spell. Could that be what brought me here? The connection between us was undeniable, a mystical force pulling me towards her.

“Goddess of earth, hear my plea,” Hester said.

I stared down at the symbol she had constructed. It was indeed some sort of magic, there was some strange pull that I had never felt before. Carefully, I stepped into the center of the red blossoms as if I knew that I was supposed to.

Hester opened her eyes. “Goddess!” She fell backward until she was sitting in the grass.

I smiled but did not move. The last thing I wanted to do was scare her. She didn’t look fragile, not as fragile as I may have been surrounded by the death and destruction around us, but she definitely hadn’t expected my arrival.

She stared into my eyes while she collected herself. “Everything inside of me said that you would come, that you would hear my words and attend my plea,” she slowly got back to her knees.

I looked around at the smoke and ruin. “He was your husband?”

She stared across the trodden grass. “Yes.”

There was no pain in her voice, no sign of loss or regret. She stared up at me and started to speak, but the sound of horses cut her off.

From the west came a small wagon pulled by two horses. Two men sat on the driver’s bench, one was Tucker, the man who had led the band of villagers and the other was a wiry fellow in his early twenties with multiple scars across both cheeks. The young man's posture, leaning away from the rotund, impeccably dressed Tucker, hinted at a painful history. His old wounds seemed to bear Tucker's signature, a silent testament to their relationship. When I saw him I immediately thought: henchman.

As soon as Hester saw them, she got to her feet, ignored me, and started toward them leaving me and the spiral behind.

The wagon came to halt and Tucker stared out across the devastation.

Hester stopped within earshot but didn’t say a word.

Eventually, Tucker let his eyes fall on the young lady. His face was emotionless. He took a breath deep enough that his chest expanded with the effort. “Mrs. Winthrop, it appears God has made you a widow,” Tucker said, his words short and harsh, like little slaps across Hester's face. His tone revealed a man accustomed to control, to having everything precisely as he wanted.

But Hester didn’t flinch. She stood still and stared at the ground.

My curiosity piqued by the woman who had seen me when I thought she couldn't, and who had summoned me with magic, I tuned into her thoughts, eager to unravel the mystery of her abilities.

Jacob was a fool for listening to you, a fool for falling into your trap, but I am not like him. I am no fool.

“What do you have to say for yourself?” Tucker stared down at the woman from his perch on the wagon.

“Nothing,” the word was quiet, matter of fact, and alone.

“Nothing?” Tucker glanced at the man beside him. “God has seen fit to punish you, Hester Winthrop and in doing so, he has punished me. You and your husband owed me a great deal of silver and,” he waved his hand, “and I see no crop of wheat in the spring, no means for repayment.”

Hester looked up at Tucker, her eyes betraying nothing, but inside her anger was boiling, murderous thoughts flashing like lightning. I could hear them, feel the intensity of her rage. *He owed you silver. I owe you nothing.*

“Did you hear me, woman?”

Now my own anger was starting to stir. There was no excuse for such behavior, I didn’t care what year it was - Tucker was proving to be a bully, but I stayed in the center of the circle of vines and flowers. I wanted to see what Hester would do. She didn’t look weak, she didn’t look afraid.

Instead, she looked and thought like I felt, like she wanted to end him where he sat.

“Yes, Mr. Tucker, I understand that Jacob owed you silver. We were grateful for your kindness when we sought land to build and farm. But to say that I am responsible for his debts...” Hester's voice trailed off, her eyes challenging.

“That you are responsible for the debt of your house, lady?”

Hester stared up at the man. Her hands clenched into fists and her breathing became steady.

“Surely, Mr. Tucker, you can reclaim the land and…”

“I have no interest in your land, Mrs. Winthrop,” Tucker interrupted. “Your husband signed the deed. The land belongs to you as does the debt. But,” he waved his hands in the air as if he were erasing their conversation from the breeze, everything that had been said up until then, “these are words we will have another time. For now, I am sorry for the loss God has seen fit to visit upon you. Gideon,” Tucker pointed to the body on the ground a few meters away, “give Hester a shovel so she that she may bury her husband and entreat God for mercy.”

The thin man, his face impassive, reached into the back of the wagon and tossed a shovel at Hester's feet, the metal clanging against the ground. The metal clanked along the ground and skidded to stop in front of Hester with a little cloud of dust.

She hadn’t taken her eyes off Tucker. I will see you hang...

Tucker held her glare for a moment before he nodded to the driver who snapped the reins along the horse’s backs and started them moving.

***

Hester watched the wagon disappear into the forest before she turned back to me. The anger still lingered, mingled with a burning hatred for the men in the wagon, yet beneath it all lay a palpable sense of pain and worry. She walked to the edge of the little symbol I stood inside of and collapsed to her knees.

“Where did you learn this magic?” I asked, my eyes drawn to the red flowers and intricate pattern of vines, feeling their pull."

“My mother,” Hester sighed. “She was a secret practitioner.”

“What is it?” I was fascinated by the idea of it, that a simple arrangement of vines and flowers along with a string of words, had such an effect on me. All my life I had denied the possibility of the supernatural - the idea of gods and magic. That there was a power that could summon a goddess was exciting.

“There are those that call it witchcraft.” Hester stared at the symbols and edicts that flowed across my robe. “My mother said it was the power of the earth, that we asked the goddess to bless us and she did.”

I was the goddess of the earth. I was the goddess of love and happiness. I was the goddess she called upon, the one summoned to her side.

Everything inside of me wanted to touch her, wanted to take her and suckle the energy she could provide. My soul felt hungry but I denied the urge. I was a goddess, a goddess unlike Toniat who kept a temple full of slaves to give her power. I didn’t need a group of humans who had their brains scrambled. I would be worshiped by choice or trade. My adherents would love me. I would not force or betray a human to gain what I needed. I would not.

“Goddess,” Hester's voice trembled, her smile weak, “I would give you anything, anything you ask. I am alone, my husband dead, my home burned. I have nothing left. I cannot even afford passage back to England. I implore you. Give me any task, ask anything you will of me, I am yours.” The words bubbled out of her - a mix of fear and respect, of awe and wonder - but there was something else, she was doing her best to hide it, but it was there.

I knelt down in the circle, playing along with her game, and took her face in my hand. Her tears were flowing, but I sensed they were for show. I could feel it, Hester was stronger than the side she was showing me. No, she wanted something, I knew it, but I needed her as much as she needed me. “Ask of me what you will.”

Her eyes widened momentarily at the sensation of my touch, a brief exchange of energy that I felt too, a connection that went beyond the physical. But then her spirit emerged from hiding, the darkness of her hatred shadowed everything and her eyes narrowed. “I want my revenge,” she hissed, her voice dripping with venom.

Revenge—a feeling I knew all too well.

Revenge. I knew the feeling well. As soon as Hester said the word, my own lust for it returned. I would have traded anything, including my very existence to see Toniat destroyed. What Hester felt, I knew well. But unlike me, Hester could have her revenge. I couldn’t destroy Toniat, I was too weak and too far away, but once I had my strength I could turn Tucker to smoke and ash with a thought if I wished. “For your devotion, you shall have it,” I smiled.

Hester looked around at the destruction we knelt in the midst of. With a determined glint in her eye, she reached for the shovel, deliberately sawing her palm against the metal edge until blood ran down, staining the tool's face. She lifted her fist over the vines and flowers beside me. “I give myself to you.”

A few drops of her blood fell onto the vines and I felt a shiver run through me, like a cool breeze blowing through my soul. “I am yours completely, a vessel for your will. Take me, my life, my all - completely.” The words were in Latin but I understood them. It was strange, the way the magic moved around me and through me.

I thought back to the moment I had opened my eyes and found myself in Enele’s temple - the moment I had given myself to her. I remembered the intimate warmth of her body against mine, the sensual touch of her skin, the provocative sensation that bound us together. They were moments that would stay with me forever, the binding of my soul to hers, but the magic that Hester wove brought them back.

The feeling was strange, the way the magic affected me, some strange invisible force or energy. I couldn’t be sure what was happening. It was at one point pleasant, a tingling but then it changed. It slid into something darker and heavier like the energy I had consumed during the battle. Shadows of hatred and anger slithered through me, a dark dance that mirrored my inner turmoil.

Hester held her hand still as the drops of blood continued to slowly fall onto the spiral. She was mumbling the spell over and over again. I could feel us binding - her spirit became mine but I was bound as well, the magic was meant to hold me to my word and the idea of breaking it almost frightened me.

I looked down at the earth around me, the vines shifted, the spiral turned and the red flowers moved around the star. I took a breath and focused on the sensations the magic wrought, I didn't completely understand what was happening, it was different than Julia's devotion, this was a bargain. We were bound to a deal.

Hester stared into my eyes. "We are bound, what do you wish of me?"

I glanced down at her dress, the solid, black fabric splotched with dirt and ash was straight cut and, though it was laid over three layers of other fabric, a burgundy petticoat, and an abused, white apron, all of it did little to hide her curves. It was impossible to deny that I wanted her. I wanted to feel the energy of her devotion, her worship, coursing through me. It wasn't so much a longing as a desire, something almost predatory, and I realized it. I felt the difference, the strange sense of power. She was mine to take. I could devour her, savoring every moment, and leave her an exhausted, satisfied heap if I so desired. The feeling caught me off guard, it wasn't something I expected.

She smiled an evil little smile. "Do you wish to take me here?" Her eyes wandered over my robe, lingering not on the symbols but on the hidden promise of what lay beneath.

I lifted my hand and the string that held her petticoat closed untied.

Hester closed her eyes, tilted her head back, and spread her arms wide. "Goddess of earth, let me taste your gifts."

Immediately, the energy I so desperately needed started to move between us not like the energy that I was used to - a wispy cloud of blue vapor. No, instead, the energy between Hester and I was a tendril, a snake like column of power that flowed from the center of her body into mine.

My entire being vibrated, a symphony of sensation, as I absorbed the raw energy.

"I am your vessel, a tool of your will…" she whispered.

I moved my fingers and the petticoat slid from her shoulders. The laces that crisscrossed the back of her dress untied themselves.

Hester shrugged her shoulder free of the black fabric revealing a layer of white cotton.

Her breasts were visible through the thin fabric, ample mounds with erect nipples that pressed against the cotton.

I leaned forward and untied the knot of string at her throat with my fingers.

Hester closed her eyes and inhaled my scent as I leaned in.

The rope of energy, the pale tendril of twisting, snapping lightning between us intensified.

“Hester! Hester!” The voice came across the clearing.

A woman, her apron and collars drenched in a shocking red, stumbled out of the forest, her face a mask of horror. “Catherine,” Hester stood and glanced at me before she tugged her dress back onto her shoulder and started running.

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The blood that covered Catherine's dress was a grim mystery, making it difficult to discern whether it was her own or someone else's. As soon as Hester was within arm’s reach, Catherin collapsed onto the ground. Hester grabbed her and cradled her head. “Catherine, stay with us,” Hester pleaded, her eyes darting over the blood-stained dress, searching for the extent of the injury.

Looking down at the two, I could see that Catherine was dying. There was a thin knife wound along her belly. She had moments.

Hester looked up at me. “Save her,” she screamed.

Everything inside of me wanted to, but I knew I didn’t have the strength. The small amount Hester and I had shared was barely enough to bring some comfort to the dying woman in front of me. There was little else I could do.

I was embarrassed. There I stood, a goddess, yet as helpless as a mere mortal. The frustration became an ache in my chest. I wanted to scream or cry or both. I didn’t deserve the godhood that Enele had passed to me.

“Hester,” Catherine lifted her hand and ran it along Hester’s cheek. “Pray for my soul.”

“Goddess!” Tears fell from Hester’s eyes

I met the sorrow in her eyes. “I am too weak.”

Hester looked down at Catherine. “The goddess is here, Catherine. The goddess has come to save us, to show us the way.”

Catherine smiled weakly. I could see her life slipping away.

Hester’s tears came freely, falling onto the woman’s dress. “Don’t leave, Catherine,” she sobbed.

Catherine’s eyes closed as she slipped into unconsciousness.

Hester laid her head to the ground. “Time and hold,” she leaned across Catherine’s dying body and started to scrawl symbols in the dirt with her finger. The earth under her finger started to glow. The symbols came to life and the magic moved around Catherine’s still body.

Satisfied that her spell was complete, she stared up at me. The look on her face was cold determination. “Take my strength,” she said before she closed her eyes. “Goddess of earth, part my soul…” Hester's voice trembled as she began another spell, her eyes ablaze with determination. The words came fast and in a cadence that was almost musical. It was compelling. Somehow the words affected me. The hunger I had felt before, during her first spell, returned. My mind was clouded with desire, with need, I stared down at her. Her black hair hung almost to the ground. Her fingertip dug into the dirt, more symbols appeared and glowed.

I felt a surge of strength, but it was accompanied by something else, something different and elusive that I couldn’t quite identify. I took a breath and spread my arms wide.

Hester’s body imitated my own. On her knees in front of me with her back arched, she threw her arms out from her sides. She moved like a puppet, her every motion guided by my will.

Our eyes met and she smiled. Her last spell interrupted, she started another, this one with words that I could no longer understand. But the look on her face told me it was a challenge.

I didn’t care. My desire had grown to the point that I didn’t want to control it any more. I needed the power to save Catherine and there was only one way that I could gain it.

I waved my hand.

Hester grabbed the front of her dress with both hands and tore the fabric open. Her breasts fell free. She stared at me while she continued to speak the words to her spell.

I tried to read her thoughts but found that all I could not penetrate her mind which was new. What is she doing? Why am I angry?

Hester smiled, her breasts exposed, her nipples stiff in the autumn air it was as if she was daring me to take her, to satisfy myself with her.

With a thought, I slipped the fabric free of her shoulders until she was naked to the waste. The wisps of energy started to rise from her. *She's excited. She likes this, a little domination, a little power struggle*. I inhaled the wisps of energy that floated off her skin with abandon.

Since our meeting in the church, curiosity had gnawed at me, wondering what lay hidden beneath her layers of clothing. My imagination had been close. Her body was slender and lean. The harshness of frontier life had sculpted her body, her gentle curves shadowed by lean muscle.

Her beauty was undeniable, and the confident look on her face told me she knew it, wielding it like a weapon. She cocked her head slightly and ran her gaze over me. Now it was my turn to show her what I looked like underneath my heavy robe.

But I was only just getting started. I took a deep breath of the energy and waved my hand again forcing her to tear the dress and the rest of the fabric down the center until it fell to the ground behind her.

She bit her lip and smiled, a knowing glint in her eye, as I soaked in the view of her, every curve a tantalizing promise.

My cock, excited by the sight of her naked and kneeling, started to grow from my clit. The sensation was magnificent, the way the pressure built behind my navel and then slowly spread until it reached the top of my pussy. The way the flesh of my little nub tingled and then began to stretch, to pull and widen. I swallowed hard as my clit transformed, extending from my body, hungry.

Hester finished the words of her spell and grinned. The tendril of power that we had shared earlier began to snake from the middle of her chest, reaching toward me with a life of its own. The vapors of energy that came off of her mixed with it and wrapped around it as it came.

The magic and the energy together was like drinking ten shots of Tequila as fast as I could. I pulled open my robe and accepted it. The warmth spread through me, enveloping my senses like the heat from a raging bonfire on a bitterly cold night.

“There you are,” Hester said. Her eyes traced the orbs of my breasts, now standing proudly. Then she lowered her gaze to the weight of my dick, still emerging - heavy, a throbbing rod of eager flesh.

“Oh…” she cooed and licked her lips.

But I had no desire to woo Hester, no desire to take my time. I was Hester’s god. I was in control.

With a mere gesture of my hand, I lifted her body into the air, her form weightless and obedient to my will. She floated up from the ground like she was lying on her back on a plank, her limbs hung down loose and free.

“Yes,” she gasped and squealed, her eyes alight with anticipation. She wasn’t afraid. The mischievous, triumphant, little smile never left her face.

I moved her closer. The feeling of power was like honey on my tongue. I loved it, the supple, compliant servant. I drew her body through the air until she was floating in front of me. I turned her until she was upright, standing in front of me but unable to do anything but what I wished with her feet still suspended a few inches off the ground.

I leaned forward and touched my lips to hers. They were wet and warm. I opened her lips with my tongue and inhaled more energy.

Her eyes grew wide as I greedily inhaled for a moment. I wanted to make sure she understood that I was in charge, that I was the goddess, and she was the human. I stopped after a few moments and smiled.

She glanced down at the fully erect cock between us, and smiled. “Goddess of earth?”

“Yes?”

“Let me worship you.”

More tendrils of energy grew from her body connecting us. Our energies mixed and exchanged.

I lowered her to her knees. “Worship my cock,”

My engorged member twitched and dripped its excitement onto the ground between us, a pool of blue precum.

She reached forward and wrapped both hands around my dick before she opened her mouth and stuffed my tip between her lips.

My size was too much for any human mouth, a challenge that seemed insurmountable, yet I reveled in watching her determination to please me. With a thought, I enlarged her mouth and pressed myself deep into her.

She gasped, a look of surprise and anticipation in her eyes, as I tangled my fingers in the curls at the back of her head. Our connection was more than physical; it was a dance of trust and desire, a shared exploration that went beyond mere pleasure.

“Mmmmm,” I said as I pulled myself free - her lips and tongue slid along my cock flesh until her mouth made a popping sound and saliva dripped stretched between her lips and the tip of my rod.

I expected humility, but she smiled up at me and licked her lips. She’s nothing if not sure of herself.

She opened her mouth and sucked me back to her throat.

Her mouth was hot, wet, and smooth. Every motion of her tongue sent shivers through me but I couldn’t stop myself – I pressed and pulled, stroking my cock in and out, fucking her face for a few moments.

Hester moaned every time my waist touched her nose. I looked down and saw her left hand between her legs, her fingers glistening, and knew she was finger-fucking herself toward an orgasm.

“That’s my job,” I roughly pushed her back onto all fours.

She chuckled, a sound rich with invitation, and spread her knees wide, revealing the thick patch of dark hair that concealed her most intimate secrets.

"I lowered myself to my knees, growling, “You are mine now,” as I dug my fingers into her hips, pulling her closer." Her scent was a strong, heady musk that I inhaled with the pleasure. She was mine.

Sliding my tongue between her labial folds, I stared up at her. Her face, framed by her two perky breasts, wore a mask of ecstasy. I slid my tongue deeper, pressing her tight little hole wide.

“Yesss….” She moaned and ran her fingers through my hair. “Turn around.”

I turned to straddle her face. My cock oozed precum along her belly, just under my chin.

She gripped the tops of my thighs and pulled me down to her mouth. I heard her mutter a few words I couldn’t make out before my anxious pussy touched her lips.

Her mouth was like ice. A chill ran through me as her cold tongue traced my lips.

A clever spell indeed. I spread my knees wide, greedy for more of her tongue's attention, lost in the unique sensation she had conjured.

Boldly, she plunged two, ice cold fingers into my wetness. My pussy contracted around them. It felt so good, the cold thickness along my dark walls.

I took a breath, holding her still, feeling her tongue scraping my lips, her fingers clenched inside of me, before I began to move against her hand, a rhythm building between us.

My cock, slick with precum, slid easily between our bodies as I lengthened my tongue, exploring her depths with a hunger that matched my own.

Her moans and gasps were heaven. I felt my strength returning, the surge of energy as another orgasm started to build inside of her.

When she came, I drank from her pussy like it was the cup of everlasting life.

Sitting up in front of her, my cock throbbing and bouncing against my chest, I stared down at the woman I had bargained with.

She grinned up at me and stretched like a cat still reveling in the afterglow of her orgasm.

I glanced over at Catherine, lying still, her breath shallow. The spell Hester had cast seemed to slow her impending death, a faint glow surrounding her fragile form. Your friend,” I said.

“The spell will hold her awhile longer. I wanted to make sure you had the strength.”

“You wanted to bind us.” I knew why Hester had done what she did, why she had thrown herself at me. It wasn’t just for Catherine’s life. No, Hester was clever, she had a plan that her magic alone could not carry out. She needed me. She needed a powerful goddess to get whatever it was she wanted and I had happened along at the perfect time.

“Was that not our bargain?” Her words were bold, impertinent almost.

I looked down at her. “Oh yes,” I smiled, my voice dripping with anticipation, “for your devotion…” I spread her legs wide, pressing myself against her, a reminder of the pleasure I had already coaxed from her body.

She squirmed against the pressure and pushed her legs further apart in an effort to accommodate my size, but I didn’t wait. The snake-like tendrils of energy that snapped between us flashed red as she cried out and I spread her pussy wide.

It was the bargain that made me revel in her pain. Hester’s devotion was not like Julia’s. It was not freely given; it was not total. No, Hester’s came with a price and was mixed with human magic. It was different and dark and, although it gave me strength, it also upset me.

I pressed deeper, spreading her wider, teetering on the edge of pleasure and pain, a fine line that I danced upon with deliberate intent.

She cried out, a mix of pleasure and pain.

I tried to slip into her mind but her magic still held me out.

The familiar pressure started to build in my stomach and I began to thrust. I wasn’t gentle, each thrust was a punishment, forcing her open, pressing myself deeper – coupling in an almost animalistic fashion.

Hester’s eyes glowed blue. She grabbed my waist and started to meet my thrusts with her hips.

It took only moments before I groaned and my cock started to spray.

Hester cried out, her body thrashing against the earth, lost in the throes of another explosive orgasm that rippled through her.

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I slipped free of Hester and cum quickly formed a puddle between her legs as it drained from her swollen pussy.

She slowly sat forward. Her hair had become a rat's nest of tangles and there were bits of dried leaves and grass sprinkled through the chaos. She glanced at the puddle of light blue liquid and then at me. "You have your strength. Heal her."

There was anger in her voice and I found some satisfaction in that. It was a strange power struggle between us. There was something I envied about Hester and her witchcraft. I couldn't understand how or why a human woman could affect a goddess and it was disturbing.

Hester, on the other hand, understood enough to know that I was bound to our deal. That she was on the verge of getting everything she wanted and she cared little for the cost. I could have put her threw a great deal more and she would have still come away smiling.

She pointed at Catherine's body.

The magic she had woven to slow Catherine's death was fading. The gentle glow of it was barely visible and Catherine's breathing was all but imperceptible.

I waved my hand and vanished – even from Hester's sight.

Catherine gasped for air, opened her eyes, and sat straight up like she had just woken from bad dream. Hester pulled her torn dress closed and knelt by her side.

"Catherine," she smiled.

"Oh, Hester. They killed Jonas, they killed him and burned the house. I tried to stop them, I grabbed leapt on one," Catherine put her hand to the place the Indian had buried his knife and gasped. "It's…Hester, what has happened?"

"The goddess has restored you, Catherine. She heard our prayers and answered." Hester's voice was gentle as she laid a comforting hand on her shoulder, her eyes filled with reverence.

Catherine's eyes grew wide. "This is truth?"

Hester nodded and Catherine threw her arms around the woman.

“It is truth, Catherine. The goddess has saved us for a purpose.” Hester’s eyes glittered blue, leftover energy from our exchange.

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*8 Seduction

With each gentle breeze that caressed the meadow, the tall grass danced across my naked thighs, whispering memories of Kim's touch, her delicate fingertips that once traced my skin. It felt like fingertips. Kim's fingertips. I thought back to the way she touched me, the way we would lay on our sides facing each other in the dark - her fingertips delicately tracing my naked skin. I loved the way she touched me, the warmth of our bodies when we were close.

Though centuries had become mere whispers in time, the memories lingered, as vivid and poignant as if they were etched into the very fabric of my being.

I had left Hester and Catherine behind, seeking refuge in a secluded meadow along the shore, a place where I could reflect on the complex emotions they had awakened in me. I knew that if she needed me, she could reach me. Her spell had caught my attention before, and now that we were bound, a strange connection lingered between us. I didn't fully understand it or how it worked, but it was there.

My head was buzzing with the strange mix of magic and energy Hester and I had shared, but I was as troubled by the exchange as I was excited. Hester's magic, the way it had affected me, was just one more thing I didn't understand. Magic, once a foreign concept to me, now danced at the edges of my understanding. What was it exactly? A force of nature, a gift from the gods, or something more elusive? Its nature was different from my own essence, not lesser, but uniquely distinct. The questions were endless, and the answers remained shrouded in mystery. How do humans control it? Where did they find it? Why don't all of them have it? More questions. It never ends, there are always more questions.

I surveyed the meadow, my thoughts drifting like leaves on an autumn breeze. Fall had taken hold, its gradual embrace mirroring my own transformation, a dance of change and acceptance. The lush green was

fading to a dusty brown. The wind rattled through everything - every leaf, every blade of grass. The last of the wildflowers, their blooms withered and defeated, dropped their petals to the ground in a silent surrender to the inevitable decay.

I pressed my hand to the earth, my energy seeping into the roots of the grass. It was a symbolic act, a gentle defiance against natural decay, as life bloomed anew beneath my touch. The energy flowed through my fingers and each blade of grass sucked it in greedily, as fast I gave the energy, they took it. From dusty brown to vibrant green, the grass transformed under my touch, reborn and lush. I smiled, feeling the power flow through me, a gentle stream of life and renewal. The meadow responded in kind, the earth warming under my touch as colors rippled and danced in a harmonious ballet. With a contented smile, I released more power, a symphony of energy that resonated with the meadow. Colors rippled and danced in a harmonious ballet, the earth warming in response to my touch.

But it felt different than when I had constructed my temple - the last time I had really tried to control my surroundings. Hester’s magic was there, mixed in with my power. I felt it. It was like a shadow, a cool darkness that mixed in. I felt a fusion, a melding of energies, as if Hester's magic had woven itself into my very essence, becoming a part of me, or perhaps I a part of it.

The expenditure of energy, even the small amount I used to breathe life into the grass, felt invigorating. I touched a dying flower and it immediately straightened. The leaves along the stem grew fat and wide. Little purple petals sprouted anew from the bare disk before it too changed to a fuzzy yellow.

I smiled at the daisies, symbols of the life I had breathed into the meadow, vibrant splashes of color defying a dying world, mirroring my own struggle and resilience. But it was strange, with the expenditure came need, almost like an itch that I could only scratch by doing it again. And I wanted to do more. I laid my hands on the ground and took a breath.

In a breathless moment, the entire field transformed into a blanket of green. I watched, entranced, as wildflowers sprang forth, slowly unfurling their petals to explode into vibrant bloom.

The sensation was intoxicating, a rush of power and connection that rivaled the energy I'd once shared with Julia, or even Jenny in New York. It was a reminder of my growth, a testament to the journey so far, the changes that I was experiencing

It was a surge, a rush like a drug that tickles against the part of your brain responsible for happiness. But I wasn’t dining on worship; I was alone, there was no one, no supplicant or servant. I was by myself, yet something felt strange.

I looked down, a stirring sensation awakening within me, a primal response to the power I wielded. The memories of intimacy and pleasure intertwined with my newfound strength, a connection that transcended mere physicality. The sensations were a metaphorical embrace, a reflection of my growing understanding of my own power and the profound connection between body and soul. The energy pulsed through me, a rhythmic beat that resonated with the very core of my being, awakening a desire to explore, to understand, to become.

With a breath imbued with intention, I summoned a tree to grow beside me, its burgeoning life intertwining with my own, a shared symphony of growth and connection. First the little sprout appeared and then two tiny leaves, it was like I was watching a documentary with a time-elapsed scene. I focused and felt the power move through my hand, into the earth, and then into the tree. It was so exciting, a lover’s tongue along my skin.

A pulsing sensation resonated within me, a connection between the tree's growth and my own arousal, a sensual dance of nature and desire, each feeding the other in a rhythmic embrace. Branches and leaves sprang forth in the breeze. It felt as if the tree itself was an extension of me, worshiping and responding to my every whim.

Towering above me, the trunk matured from a tender green to a robust dark brown, its bark thickening and roughening, a symbol of nature's strength and resilience.

My heart raced, and a longing ache pulsed within me, a yearning that seemed to reach out, begging for attention like a lost puppy.

The tree seemed to groan in pleasure as it soared, growing wider and taller with every breath, mirroring my own rising excitement. The heat of

ecstasy was so close it almost burned, a tantalizing promise that one touch would unleash. Another caress of the breeze, and I would have surrendered to the wild abandon, losing myself in the sensation.

But I could feel the darkness in the seduction. It was like I was feeding Hester's magic. I pulled my hand away from the ground. Using my own power to grow and then harvest life from the earth itself.

As far as the eye could see, the world was caught at the height of spring.

Strange magic indeed. I felt the energy of the world around me, a power that was both alluring and dangerous, but I had broken the spell, resisting its call. Whatever strange magic Hester had given me, I still didn't understand it.

What is this and what is it that she really wants? Is it revenge? I know she wants to stop Tucker, but what else? This is so much more than a single man's life. She's playing with darkness.

I thought of my encounter with Hester, recalling the intensity and forcefulness that had surprised even me. My pussy quivered - never before I had felt as strong. In all my life, I had never thought to willfully control and dominate someone. The memory tingled across my skin.

What had surprised me was the fact that she had liked it. She had liked that I was willing and able to push back. I was a goddess.

But how can a human have any control over me?

The tree's leaves whispered over my head. I looked around at the lush forest. My mouth was dry and my heart was still racing. It felt so good, strangely different, the way Hester's magic drew power from the earth itself, from the life of things. I knew that if I had continued to focus my power, caught in the glow of pleasure, I could have destroyed everything, draining the very life from every plant and tree. Dust and ashes would have been all that I left behind. And it was exhilarating.

Reaching down, I traced my fingertip along my skin, feeling a new awareness and connection to my body. *You don't get as much attention as you used to.* I thought of Hester's tongue, how she had been so eager to please all of me. Eager but at a cost.

I pressed my hand against my body, exploring sensations and feelings that were both familiar and new.

The breeze tickled across the sensitive skin and I thought back to Kim. How we would hold each other open and then kiss and make out for a little while. Then one of us would grab our favorite dildo. And we would lean back and slide the two-headed monster into our, already dripping, cunts. There is nothing better than that feeling; the way a cock stretches open a pussy.

My finger slipped into the darkness and a little wave of pleasure washed across me. My head was a storm of thoughts. I was happy and sad, turned on and frustrated all in the same breath.

A climax, a release, a moment of transcendence and connection to something greater.

I stroked my finger in and out and thought of Kim's scratchy little tongue. The way she would lay it flat like a blanket between my pussy lips before she pressed and drug her tongue along me.

Another finger disappeared inside and I remembered her breasts, the way they felt pressed into my belly while I buried my face in her slippery darkness, sucking and licking.

I closed my eyes, lost in memories and sensations, the way our bodies had tangled, a dance of passion and power. The smell of her juices, the heady musk of her pleasure. I lengthened and thickened the fingers inside of me, a perk of being able to do whatever you want.

Lost in sensation, writhing in the lush grass I had created, I explored my body, rushing toward a bliss that was more than physical, a connection to the earth and the magic within me. I needed to be filled and stretched. I wanted to feel it. I needed to cum, needed to let go. The energy I could take from the earth, the way the magic seemed to long for it, tickled along my spine. I wanted to taste it.

My cock expanded, the familiar pressure rising along its length. Cum rained across my breasts and I moaned as the I inhaled and took a sip of the force around me.

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The sun slipped past the horizon, and I sat up breathless and satisfied. I decided that if I was going to be stuck in the past, I might as well get to know where I was and who I would be stuck with. I stood and let a cool breeze wash across my skin before my robe appeared and wrapped around me, the warmth enveloped me in an instant. With a single step, I invoked my goddess power, covering the distance from the shore to the center of the town, where the remnants of an ancient battle still lingered. The street was empty, the bodies from the battle removed, yet the dirt bore the stains of the day's carnage—dark spots marring the road in the semi-darkness. I could see the bodies, their limbs twisted and lying at strange angles. The townsfolk had piled them in a clearing just past the tree line. It saddened me. The sight of so many dead, but there was nothing I could do. They had died to protect their loved ones the same as the Indians. It was senseless, but it is what humans do. How many battlefields had I stood in as an archaeologist?

The largest building in the town still had a warm glow coming through the windows. I stepped through the front door, invisible. "I tell you, those two are not right," Mary, the innkeeper's wife, sat in a straight-backed chair next to the fire, her fingers busy with two knitting needles. The fire in the hearth crackled, its little hisses and pops seeming to cheer and reinforce her words.

Her husband, sitting in a chair across from hers, stared into the flames. "Yes, they did not seem very moved by the loss of their farms or their husbands, but who are we to judge?"

"God has already judged them, Henry. It is God who brought those devil worshipers, those heathens, as a tool of his will." Mary's words were quiet but laced with malice. She glanced up at the ceiling as she spoke like she knew someone was listening.

Henry took a sip from his cup and shook his head. "Tucker says he's going to raise an army."

"The pastor should raise an army and combat the evil that woman has brought. The devil hides in their smiles."

Mary continued her tirade against the day's events and those she thought were responsible, but I left her and her husband and visited the first room at the top of the stairs.

Catherine was sound asleep in the center of the small bed. Her face was like a boat in a sea of red curls, and I couldn't help but notice how strikingly beautiful she was. It made sense when I had last seen her she was covered in blood, horrified, and almost dead. But healed and washed, she was quite pretty.

They are all so young. I touched the woman's cheek, letting a trace of my energy flow into her. She inhaled sharply and grinned.

I walked through the wall adjoining the two rooms, almost eager to see Hester.

"I wondered if you would check on me," she whispered with a mocking tone, swinging her legs over the edge of the bed. Even in the darkness, I felt her power. She was stronger for our bond.

I was both intrigued and unsettled by her uniqueness. Unlike most humans, she could see me when I was invisible, summon me, and even hold sway over me. Her power challenged my understanding of my own abilities.

She spread her legs and arched her back, taunting, "Is this what you came for? You wish to take me again?"

I couldn't deny my desire for her, for the rush of our mingling powers, but something else called to me even more.

"Take my hand," I stepped toward the raven-haired temptress, her eyes gleaming with a challenge I found both alluring and disconcerting.

She eyed me suspiciously for a moment, obviously unsure of my intentions, before she took my hand.

Within the space between two heartbeats, we went from the tiny room in the inn to the shore, a hundred or so meters from the surf.

Hester looked around like a child in a fairytale and laughed out loud. "How? Where are we?"

Although I would have never imagined that the easiest thing, the very first thing I did on my own as a goddess - moving across vast distances with little more than a thought - would impress her, it did feel good. "I am a goddess or have you forgotten?"

She took a step back and bowed slightly. “My apologies, Goddess. I should have expected nothing less from you,” there was a mischievous tone in her voice. I did so like her playfulness. With no moon in sight, a million, trillion stars washed across the sky, stretching from one horizon to the other. I waved my hand, and a heavy coat wrapped around her shoulders.

She pulled the fabric tight and closed the buttons. “Thank you,” she said as we started down the shore. I took a deep breath of the fresh, salt air and listened as the surf rolled across the sand. We had come because I had questions. My theories and ideas about what Hester was and what she wanted had rolled back and forth like a ship in a storm, but I wanted to hear it from her. I wanted the truth. “What is it that you want, Hester?”

“A great many things,” she grinned, her eyes alive with purpose. “I want to end the tyranny of man that has shackled us for so long. I want to punish Tucker and his brother for their sins. I want to purify our village and those around us, to cleanse them of the corruption that festers within.”

“The tyranny of man?” Of all the things I had imagined she would say, the statement had not been among them.

“Yes,” she stopped and turned to me, her face illuminated by the rising moon’s light. “Their god holds women as less than cattle.” The sneer on her face was a mark of her disdain. “You heard Tucker, and my own husband was no better. We are their slaves, servants to their whim. We’re their property. Catherine was put in the stocks last week for an entire day because she questioned her husband in front of the pastor.”

I had seen the stocks sitting outside the church - heavy wooden beams and forged iron shackles on chains.

“Goddess, you must help me. Together, we will change this place, forge a new path, bring a new religion to this new world, and build a temple in your honor,” Her eyes were bright and alive, her voice filled with conviction.

I looked into her eyes, a storm of emotions swirling within. “Nothing is ever that easy, Hester,” I warned, my voice a gentle caress, a warning wrapped in understanding.

Her brows furrowed, a hint of doubt in her eyes, but she wasn’t completely dismayed. “I will give you worshipers, a coven of witches to give you power. You will be as strong as the old gods, and that is only now,” Her eyes grew wide with excitement. “Every day more women are brought to these shores - servants of their husbands, or indentured servants to evil men - and that is to say nothing of the brothels and taverns.”

The words hung in the air, a bargain laid bare, a pact waiting to be sealed. Time seemed to pause as I weighed the offer.

“A coven?”

“We are four already,” she held my gaze, her eyes filled with determination and hope.

Four adherents already. The thought of the power I would gain, a force that could reshape destinies, sent a chill of excitement racing through me, a tantalizing promise of what was to come. How much do I need to get home? How much will it take to kill Toniat? “And from me?” I asked, my voice tinged with curiosity and caution. Everything came at a cost.

Hester took a breath and gave me an appraising look. “Little,” she finally said, her voice soft but firm. “An appearance would have a most dramatic effect. We shall need to solidify their faith and dedication.”

“An appearance?” It was too little, and I knew it.

“The sight of you will be enough to prove that what I have told them is real,” she looked behind us at the two sets of footprints and then turned back down the beach. “They have nothing, and we will give them everything.”

Hester was no fool. Before I had appeared, she had already begun undermining the fabric of the village, converting the women to her cause, but I was surprised she hadn’t asked for more. An appearance was a trifle. There were greater things she could have requested, but much like me, I don’t think she understood exactly what I was capable of. I was as much a mystery to her as I was to myself.

It was late into the night, the world bathed in a silvery glow, when I returned Hester to her bed, her body a delicate silhouette against the soft linen. She was exhausted, but she had shared a great deal of her plan, and I had learned more about where and when I was from the details.

We were somewhere in the wilds of Massachusetts, a land caught between the old world and the new. It was the fall of 1691, late September, a time of change and uncertainty. The English king had just reclaimed the area and declared it a royal colony. The people of Hester’s village were separatists, the most zealous of the puritans. Here, if a man looked at a woman who was not his wife in a way that anyone thought of as lustful or covetous - the man was headed to the stocks if not a hanging tree or whipping post.

Intentionally or unintentionally, Toniat had essentially locked me away, a prisoner of time and circumstance. A strange, puritanical time where the prevailing religion was both severe in its judgments and uniquely anti-sexual in its doctrines. From Toniat’s point of view, this place was perfect; I could potentially starve and wither away to nothing. But there was a small amount of hope, a glimmer.

Hester’s grand plan was nothing short of a religious revolution, a radical reimagining of faith and power. She would usher in a new era,

bringing a new god to the Americas, and that god was me.

The prospect of having worshipers thrilled me; it was an interesting idea. The power they could offer was tantalizing, a temptation I struggled to resist, but I tried not to dwell on it. For the moment, I was trapped and dependent on Hester, who I didn't completely trust. The local tribes revered a complex pantheon of gods and goddesses, each with unique attributes and domains.

Leaving Hester neatly tucked under her blankets, I decided to find the pastor and his brother, Jonathan Tucker - the men who seemed to be the leaders of the village, the elders as Hester had called them. I wanted to know more about them. I wanted to know who they were and where they came from. The way I saw it, Jonathan and his brother were Hester's enemies, the largest obstacles to her vision of the future, our vision of the future. But they wouldn't be easy to overcome. If men could place a woman in the stocks for a few words spoken out of turn, there was no telling what they would do with the notion of magic, especially if it was a group of women who were suspected. Losing Hester to zealotry would leave me stranded, a fate worse than death, trapped in a world where I didn't belong, my very existence hanging by a thread. The brothers held the entire village under their thrall: Jonathan with his strength and wealth, and Victor with his religious influence. Their power was formidable, but it was not true power, it was not my power. Hester's tales of Jonathan Tucker's cruelty were so extreme, they bordered on the unbelievable, yet her fear was palpable. A fortnight before my arrival one of the villagers had been caught having sex with his indentured house servant, a young man. The man's beloved wife had walked in on them - the servant bent over the table while her husband had his way. The next day, the man was beheaded in front of the church. The separatists had little tolerance for sin. The idea gnawed at my very soul, a cruel injustice that I, as a goddess of love, could not abide.

Behind the church, nestled among the trees, stood the pastor's small cabin, a humble abode where Victor resided. It consisted of a single room with a loft, furnished with a small hearth, a table, a chair, and some shelves. It was both humble and minimal. He was asleep in the loft. His breathing was soft and slow. I closed my eyes and floated into his mind. It was little more than curiosity really. I wanted to learn more about the brothers and

what better way than to visit their dreams, the thoughts their minds chewed like leather while they slept.

The land lay barren, scorched by the relentless sun, a desolate wasteland stretching to the horizon. Victor's clothes were sweat-soaked, and his face was gaunt like he hadn't eaten or had a drink in days. He was barefoot, in a sleeping gown, and staring down at a simple table that held a stack of paper cards. Some of the cards were scattered around his feet, I could see others in the dirt where the breeze had tossed them. He appeared half-crazed, his appearance dirty and disheveled. He stared intently at the card before him, mumbling under his breath. The words were familiar, a prayer from the Bible but I wasn't sure. He stared at the card as if willing it to move or burst into flame, but it remained motionless and black. Wind howled through the desolate landscape, whipping dust into a frenzied dance that stung our eyes and filled the air with grit. Other cards on the table took flight and tumbled across the parched earth, but the black card remained. "All is lost," Victor shook his head. "Death will find us here. Death will chase us down. We will die here."

I extricated myself from the dream, the sensation of returning to reality a jarring transition that left me momentarily disoriented. I stared around the chilly, little room and noticed a house cat peering down at me from a rafter in the corner. She was a lean, grey figure, poised on the edge of the rafter like a cougar in a tree. The green eyes were barely visible in the dark, but they were there, silently considering me, silently watching.

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From Victor’s tiny house, I moved to his brother’s. The place was a stark contrast, a true dichotomy to Victor's home. Jonathan's house, the largest in the village, boasted two floors and eight symmetrical windows flanking the grand front door. In Jonathan's parlor alone, I counted at least three oil lamps, accompanied by more candles than his brother had pieces of firewood. The entire house was infused with the warm aroma of cinnamon and the fresh scent of pine.

There was a candle burning in the entry but no one there. I stood just inside the door and stilled my thoughts. There were two people in the house - one upstairs, one toward the back of the house. Tucker’s wife was asleep in their bedroom, but he was toward the back of the house, awake, and going over figures.

Jonathan Tucker was sitting at a small desk in a dimly lit room filled with the scent of old paper and ink, going over a pile of detailed ledgers. I stepped behind him, watching the graceful dance of his quill as it dipped into ink, then traced a path along a column of numbers, pausing beside the name 'Winthrop'. Hester. Hester’s husband had barely been a day in the ground, and Tucker was already calculating the burden Hester would bear, making notes on the value of the land against the value he had loaned her husband. He jotted numbers on a separate piece of parchment and then slapped beads left and right on an abacus.

How boundless could one man's greed be? I wanted to strike him, recalling the strength that had sent the Indians fleeing at the mere sight of me—a strength I was still learning to control. I could melt his mind or tear him apart. I could destroy him, but would that serve my purpose or Hester's? Killing Tucker would create a power vacuum in the town, leaving room for another greedy man willing to manipulate faith for control.

Standing behind him, I closed my eyes and opened my hand, summoning the mystical energy that connected our world. It took a moment, but a thin tendril of blue energy left my palm and spanned the distance between us. As soon as it touched him, he inhaled deeply, like a chill had just gone through him. He opened and closed his eyes like he wasn’t sure whether or not he was fully awake, like he felt it but didn’t really feel it at the same time.

Though it was my first-time using Hester's gift, it felt as intuitive and natural as my own abilities. Pleasure is what I had given Tucker, a dose, a taste. Enough to change the route of his thoughts, tighten his chest a bit, and speed his heartbeat.

He shook his head, and even though the immediate shock had worn off, a transformation was evident in his expression. When I had found him hunched over his desk just a few minutes before, his face was furrowed and focused. Greed was pumping through him, and his face betrayed how much it meant to him, all those numbers, all that power. But now, after the feather-like tickle of power, he wore the face of a man that had just woken from a happy sleep, a wet dream perhaps.

I delved into his thoughts, slowly unraveling them, and found a hidden desire lurking beneath. 'I could have her,' he thought, his mind filled with lust and calculation. Catherine. That's what he wants—Catherine. A shiver of delight tingled through me, a sensation both thrilling and unexpected. Light blue waves of energy emanated from the man before me, visible only to my heightened senses. Why not indulge in this newfound power? It was a chance to explore, to understand, and perhaps even enjoy.

I withdrew from his thoughts, returning to reality. Outside of his mind, he still sat at his desk, his eyes were closed, and one hand rubbed along the front of his pants.

Catherine. He wants Catherine. A little shiver of delight tingled across me. Light blue waves of energy wafted off the man in front of me. I inhaled them and grinned. What the hell? Might as well have some fun, right? I slipped back into his thoughts.

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*9 Aria

She was half undressed. The light of the candle flickered, and shadows ran across the curves of her breasts. She wore a grin, a sultry, tantalizing grin, like she knew what she was doing was wrong, very wrong, but she didn't care. All she wanted was Tucker, with a longing that consumed his very soul.

It was all in his imagination. As he sat there at his desk, his eyes closed, and his fingers gently stroking his swollen cock through the heavy, rough fabric of his trousers, he thought of nothing but her and how he wanted her, how he longed to touch her, to run his fingers around her curves. He moved the scene to his own bedroom, the idea of Catherine in his home while his wife was away. He was sitting on the edge of the bed; she was standing next to a lone candle on the far side of the room without a stitch of clothing. He thought of her face, the wanton look, the desire that filled her eyes.

From my hidden vantage point, I watched his thoughts unfold like a scene in a movie, a knowing grin spreading across my face. He's doing pretty well. He wanted Catherine. This wasn't the first time he had imagined her. His thick cock bounced up, relieved from its confinement and throbbing with readiness. But I wanted to know everything. It was important. I needed to not only find Jonathan Tucker's weakness but make the first move.

I concentrated on the vision of Catherine he had created. It was almost exact, down to the almost ivory color of her skin.

I ventured to slip into the mind of Jonathan's illusion, driven by a need to understand his deepest desires and fears, to know what he truly thought of her. Inside the puppet of his own imagination, I would be able to

feel what he wanted, what he wished for - information that would be invaluable to Hester, and whatever plan she had in mind.

Through the fantasy, I was looking into Tucker's eyes. In his thoughts, this fantasy that I had slipped into, he was sitting on the edge of a bed wearing a dull, white nightshirt that barely touched his knees. He was well-built, tall with broad shoulders, and his physical strength was not just an appearance; it was a core part of his identity, a source of confidence and power. It was humorous, the difference between the way he saw himself and the way everyone else saw him. In his own fantasy, he was in his late teens or early twenties, the age he first realized what he looked like and how it made people react.

I felt my arms, Catherine's arms, move to slide the fabric off my right shoulder. Jonathan's eyes flickered to the curve of her shoulder. He was lost in the idea of Catherine, of taking her.

He sat and watched as Catherine started walking toward him. Every breath tingled through him. His throbbing member ached, straining against the nightshirt, pitching the fabric like a tent post, eager for release.

Catherine slinked forward; moving like everything inside of her wanted the man in front of her, like it was magnetic.

And then she was on him. A foot in front of him, she dropped to her knees and pushed the heavy fabric back along Tucker's thighs.

His cock bounced up, relieved and ready.

I took a slow, deliberate breath, inhaling the potent energy he was exuding, letting it fill me and connect me to him. The sensation was akin to swallowing a shot of rich whisky, leaving me warm, fuzzy, and insatiably hungry for more. I was a creature of desire, forged from the waves of pleasure that ebbed and flowed through the hearts of mortals. I remembered the way Enele had put off an almost radiant warmth, to be near her was pleasurable, to be touched by her was like exploding into a trillions sparkling bits of light.

Being inside Jonathan's fantasy, a part of it tingled through me. Catherine's grin became a smile, and her eyes went wide with lustful surprise.

His member wasn't overly long, but its thickness promised a pleasure that made her mouth water.

She wrapped her delicate hands around the throbbing girth and leaned forward, her eyes wide with lustful surprise. "It's so big," she cooed, her voice dripping with desire.

Tucker took a breath. His entire body quivered at her touch.

She leaned forward, and her breath tickled across the sensitive skin. He looked down almost overcome.

She slid her hand down, and Tucker's pink glans appeared. Her lips were an inch from his flesh.

He held his breath, and the energy of his desire swirled around me like a warm, intoxicating breeze.

In an instant, he was gone, leaving a void filled with longing and anticipation.

The intoxicating warmth of her mouth, the sensual weight of her red curls as they tickled his thighs, each sensation a symphony of pleasure.

Everything washed across him.

I slid free of the moment and stepped back into the room. I stared down at Tucker's face, captivated by the raw, urgent happiness that danced in his eyes, a reflection of human longing.

My attention was suddenly drawn to the eyes of an orange tabby cat, lying comfortably on a rafter in the corner, its gaze fixed on me with an unsettling intensity. Were mice problems so rampant in 1691 that every

household needed a cat? A shiver ran through me, pulling me back to the moment I had first entered, a nagging feeling that something was amiss. I thought back to my entrance. Had I noticed a cat then, or was this feline presence something more?

Jonathan moaned, lost in pleasure, and I looked at the man beside me, his face a mask of desire and fantasy. He was like I had found him, sitting behind his desk, his ledgers laid out in front of him, except now, his dick was free of the trousers. His hand fastened around the center of his throbbing member, working himself to the rhythm of his fantasy, each stroke a mimicry of Catherine's imagined touch. Every time he squeezed and tugged downward, I knew it was Catherine's mouth swallowing him.

But even though it was tempting to slip back into his thoughts and absorb more of his pleasure, it wasn't why I had come to the place. With purpose and curiosity, I slipped through the ceiling and into Tucker's bedroom.

It was impulsive, but I couldn't help it. Why not add an ally? Why not give Tucker the slightest taste of what was to come? If Hester could have a number of the town's women in her coven, why couldn't I turn Tucker's wife?

Aria Tucker, a youthful beauty in her early twenties, was younger than Tucker by more than a decade, a contrast that spoke volumes about their union. She was barely in her twenties, a beauty with long blonde hair, and breasts that pressed defiantly against the blankets though she rested on her back.

With only a thought, I slipped into her body, became like the air she breathed, instantly a part of her. It felt oddly right. I was instantly hungry. What Tucker had provided thus far had only aroused an appetite, a hors d'oeuvre, so to speak. His obsession with Catherine had piqued my own desire, and his wife just felt so right.

Aria was unlike most of the women I had encountered in this time; her delicate frame and pampered appearance revealed a life unaccustomed to labor. She was lithe with long, slender legs, arms, and fingers. The

moment I inhabited her thoughts, I could see who she was and what she had been through. It was like she had laid her mind open, her memories, and her thoughts. I wondered if she knew I was there.

She was from an affluent family on the outskirts of London, raised with the proverbial silver spoon and used to the finer things in life, luxuries the New World had not seen yet.

I delicately slipped through her memories, exploring them with the casual curiosity one might have while flipping through a magazine at the checkout counter. There was happiness, mischief, and all the rest. But there were also blank spaces, places in her memory that I couldn't see or feel. How can she block me? Without pausing too long, I moved across the places I could witness until I stumbled across a memory of her mother.

Her mother's voice rang clear, a blend of wisdom and pragmatism, "Listen to your father and keep this man Tucker as long as he gives you everything you ask for."

With a thought, I moved from her memories to her dream and was shocked by what I found. Where Tucker, even his dreams, lived in his own time and place, Aria dreamed of home, of London and high society. It was like she was detached from the reality around her, a part of it, but not a part of it at the same time.

The dream I had stumbled into was grandiose, set in a massive manor with twenty-eight bedrooms, sitting on thousands of acres of lush land, a testament to opulence. But that wasn't all. The moment I had arrived in was even more interesting

The two gentlemen in suits smiled, their presence significant but overshadowed by the soldier's allure, a favorite figment of her fantasy.

“I don’t believe you do,” the soldier smiled, his jacket falling to the floor, a symbol of surrender to passion, a detail she had crafted in her mind's theater. I took a step forward, and I saw a realization flash across her face. She knew that she wasn’t in control of the soldier anymore. But instead of scaring her, it thrilled her, I could feel it.

Her eyes flared as they worked over the soldier’s physique. She liked the soldier; it wasn’t the first time that she had imagined him with her, them together. He (now me) was one of her favorites.

I moved outside her body, back to the little upstairs bedroom and the heavy, warm bed. I was hungry. The powers inside of me seemed to come to life, stirring inside of me like the raging waters of a storm. I gave in to the desire and peeled back the blankets of Aria’s bed. I wanted to see her in reality, drink her in while she dreamt.

Her nightshirt was already up along the top of her thighs as if she had pulled it up and out of the way before I had arrived. The cool air of the room wafted across the soft skin of her legs, and little goosebumps appeared.

Reaching out, I ran my fingertips along the inside of her calves, the rise and fall of the muscles. Starting at the bottom and slowly moving higher, I watched her body react to my touch. She sighed and slowly spread her legs. The nightshirt, tight against the curves of her hips, rose.

Her flesh was warm to the touch.

In her dream, the soldier's jacket fell to the floor, a symbol of surrender to passion, a detail she had crafted in her mind's theater.

“It’s always you,” she whispered.

I swept my arm around her lower back and pulled her close. The other two in the room vanished, instantly forgotten as the desire surged through her. The light in the dream shifted and became weaker, as if she had blown out most of the candles to change the mood.

On her bed, my fingertips had reached the top of her thighs. I took a deep breath, absorbing the mystical energy that surrounded us, a magical fog that became a part of me, enhancing my aura. I felt the darkness inside of me, the almost animalistic urgency that Hester had somehow given me. I dug my fingers in, gripped her high on the legs, just underneath the little mound of pleasure I couldn’t stop staring at. I massaged. Her body writhed under my touch. The part of her mind that existed outside of her fantasy, the consciousness outside of the dream, relished the sensation. Her body flexed and stretched. I almost thought I saw her grin.

In her mind’s eye, she reached for my shirt, and in a blink, she swept us off to some darkened corridor of the mansion. One leg wrapped around my waist and pulled me close.

I pressed her back against the wall and put the full weight of the soldier’s body against her.

Our mouths became a frenzy of lips and tongues, each eager to devour the other.

She ground into me, shifting her hips to slide along the growing pressure inside my trousers.

Mmm…I like you.

While my fingers played along the plump curve of her thighs, I took a deep breath and watched the blue tendrils of energy wash around me, magical fog that tickled through me until it disappeared into my aura. The way I was sitting, on my knees between her legs, my cock stretched out over her body. The head danced above the gentle curves in the fabric that hid her breasts.

I will have her in two worlds, a conquest of both mind and body, a testament to my newfound power.

Pressed against her, the soldier’s mouth explored her neck, his hands impatiently pulling at the layers of her dress. Aria's fantasy was a whirlwind of desire, a rush towards ecstasy without pause for foreplay. Overcome with desire, her forehead glistened with the sweat of anticipation. She wanted it rough; she wanted the raw strength of the soldier - the way Tucker gave it to her when he had been drinking. She liked to feel it the next day, the spent and sore muscles. She liked to wake up the next morning and luxuriate in the physical ache of the memory.

He found the bottom layer of expensive fabric and raised it to her waist.

She giggled, her eyes locked on his as she reached for the bulge in the soldier’s pants.

In the bedroom, my throbbing member inched closer to her chin, a dance of desire and anticipation. I leaned forward, lifting her nightshirt,

revealing her in all her vulnerability and beauty. My breath caught as I exposed her, the flatness of her belly, the perfect handfuls that were her breasts, nipples that instantly stiffened in the cool air.

With the nightgown gathered around her shoulders, I sat back, taking in the whole of her, a vision of sensuality and grace. Her pussy, cast in moonlight from the window, and covered in ghostly wisps of blonde hair. It was round and ready. I looked at it like I had looked at my own when I was eleven, standing in front of a mirror thinking: I like the way it's shaped.

Her dream began to fade, and she found herself caught between two worlds: the hallway of her imagination and the reality of lying exposed on her bed before a goddess. She stretched and opened her eyes.

I froze, a pang of uncertainty gripping me. I had never ventured into this realm before, holding a human mind suspended between the subconscious and conscious worlds. It was a delicate dance, one that thrilled and terrified me. A surge of power filled me, a realization that I could do whatever I wanted. My eyes lingered on her body, savoring the sight.

There, in her bed, nestled between the warmth of her thighs, I revealed myself as a Futanari goddess. Desire coursed through me, my nipples aching for a touch, my cock throbbing, tantalizingly close to her lips.

Straddling both worlds, her mind a haze of desire and wonder, Aria was caught in a mystical dance only known to the gods. It was impossible to predict how her mortal mind would react. I contemplated shifting into the form of the soldier from her dream, but something held me back, a desire to remain true to my own form.

Control was slipping through my fingers, replaced by a raw, primal need for contact, for satisfaction. I leaned forward, my cock laying its full length along her body, a trail of sensation from between her legs to the valley between her breasts. Her skin was warm, and the flesh between my legs pulsated as my pussy tingled in anticipation of what would happen next.

On the bed, she reached out, her hand exploring the unique gift of my Futanari form. The blue haze of energy filled the room like fog. She grinned up at me, seeking my approval, and I realized that our contact, the touch of skin on skin, held her in both worlds. Tethered by my energy, she could straddle both worlds - the waking and dreaming.

Her fingers wrapped slowly around the heft of my cock, exploring its contours. She sucked in her lower lip, her grip moving with deliberate care up and down my length. I grew even more excited as I inhaled the joy of her attention.

I leaned forward, my body sliding along her skin, a dance of temptation and longing.

In the dream, she grabbed the soldier’s ass and pulled him closer, pressing his rod against the warmth of her mound. I moved the soldier’s hips, eager in both worlds, and thrust upward. The motion speared her quivering warmth, and she cried out. The sound echoed down the hall, and she bit into the soldier’s shoulder - thrilled.

She writhed as I filled her, the soldier's cock struggling against her narrow channel. Her young, tight cunt embraced him, and she moaned as she rocked her hips, pulling him deeper, lifting and pushing to take him fully. Her pussy milked his cock.

I inhaled deeply, savoring the attention she lavished upon the soldier, feeling it as if it were my own.

On the bed, I withdrew slightly, then pressed forward, the girth of my gift parting Aria's slick warmth. Her lips parted, caressing me with the slick warmth of her intimate embrace.

With her eyes closed in the bliss of what happened in the dream, she wrapped both hands around me and pulled my cock toward her lips. I watched, entranced, as her mouth opened, the warmth of her breath teasing my throbbing flesh.

My breath shuddered as she bucked her hips and stroked me with her cunt, moving against the base of my cock and then across my clit.

Her mouth was a hot haven, and she moaned, tasting the precum that oozed across her eager tongue.

Desire consumed me, a fire that threatened to engulf us both. I stared into Aria's sleepy eyes, and with a mere thought, made her nightgown vanish, baring her to my hungry gaze.

A dark tendril of energy, resembling a purple snake made of twisting arcs, extended from my chest and connected with her. I felt the pull as soon as it touched her, the way it seemed to draw energy from somewhere inside of Aria. My body ached for it. I wasn’t sure how the magic had done it, only that I didn’t want it to end. The sensation was new and powerful, dark but I didn’t care.

Aria’s eyes closed, and she moaned softly.

The soldier picked Aria up by the hips and pinned her against the wall to a height that suited the fucking he (I) was about to give her. He bucked his hips into her, his cock thrusting while she milked him with the angle of her hips.

Aria dug her fingers into his back, her mind wandering to the sensation of bearing a throbbing hunk of flesh, imagining what it would be like to have a penis. She imagined herself with a cock, the length of it rising in her imagination, and she began to meet the soldier’s fucking harder and harder, grinding as they came together, and tightening every muscle as he pulled away. Ah, to have both. To fuck and be fucked. The image of three different men in the village passed through her thoughts while the soldier’s cock swelled inside her.

Aria's mouth opened wider, eagerly accepting as I moved my hips, pressing my cock further into her waiting warmth. The motion of her tongue swirling across my rigid flesh sent shivers through me. But I knew that she was drunk on the energy that we shared. I was torn, craving more

of the sweet, honey-like energy flowing between us, yet a nagging voice in the back of my mind warned of danger.

I pressed deeper into her mouth until I felt the back of her throat. She moaned and bobbed her head, swallowing against me. Jacking my throbbing muscle with both hands while she swallowed as much as she could take, and my pleasure oozed past the corners of her lips.

Should I reveal myself? Should I succumb to the pleasure our bodies were aching for? Suddenly, the memory of Julia and the way Mira had cruelly taken her flashed in my mind, a haunting reminder. It was impossible, I wouldn’t take Aria the way she had taken Julia, through a lie, a thinly veiled illusion. Taking a deep breath, I pulled free of Aria’s grip and stepped away from the bed.

The tendril of dark energy vanished as I erased the moments of our touch, implanting a new thought in her mind: You want to check on Tucker.

It took a moment, but Aria woke. She looked around the room, her eyes filled with wonder. I had erased the episode, but there was residue, a sense of something that lingered. She saw the flickering candlelight through the bedroom’s open door and swung her legs over the edge of the bed.

I waited, unseen, observing as she glanced at the bunched-up fabric, her mind flashing back to the memory of the hallway, the soldier's cock spreading her wide. A wave of excitement rolled across her before she pulled the heavy linen down and stood up.

What could he be doing still up? I listened to her thoughts.

The moment Aria stood, I slipped through the floor, finding Tucker exactly where I had left him, lost in his fantasies. In the realm of dreams, time had its own rules, flowing differently from the waking world.

A triumphant smile crossed my face. My plan had worked. Tucker was caught, lost in a fantasy of Catherine. I saw the flicker of anger in Aria’s eyes; she had heard it.

The floor creaked as Aria appeared in the doorway, her eyes fixed on Tucker. His eyes were closed, brows furrowed in concentration, his hand gently stroking his genitals. He looked like a man in the middle of a very pleasant dream, serene almost. “Yes, Catherine, yes,” he said with pleasure.

I smiled. It had worked. Tucker had been caught masturbating to a fantasy of Catherine. I saw the flicker of anger in Aria’s eyes; she had heard it.

“Tucker,” Aria said, slipping the nightgown over her head and tossing it aside. “My love?” she asked, moving across the room, her eyes fixed on the throbbing bulge in his grasp. “Jag aer dine dröme,” Aria cooed the words softly. Tucker didn’t open his eyes; instead, his smile broadened, revealing a hint of his inner desires. “Jag aer dine dröme,” Aria whispered the words again as she stood on the opposite side of her husband’s desk. What was she saying? What mysterious language was that? Was it magic? Was she weaving some sort of enchanting spell? Driven by curiosity, I closed my eyes and slipped into Tucker’s thoughts.

He was where I had left him, sitting on the edge of his bed, his knees wide, and a look of pure ecstasy across his face. But Catherine was nowhere to be found, instead, in the same place Catherine had been, was his wife Aria. My breath caught. Had he heard her voice and shifted his fantasy? There was no reason he couldn’t, Aria was a fine specimen of a woman, I imagined that half the town had probably fantasized about fucking her, but a moment ago… It's magic; this entire town has somehow been imbued with a mystical force. More than once, some archaeologist would find some piece of something or a fragment of jewelry that the native legends said was magical, a gift of some god or goddess. Magic and power were ancient themes, moving through history like woven threads, binding the fabric of this world. But they had power. They were real, all of it was real. After all, what am I but a living legend, a story brought to life, more potent and real than the myths dared to whisper?

I extricated myself from the dream and stood near Aria, observing her intently. She couldn’t see me, but there was a strange smile on her face as she watched her husband’s hand move along the length of his tool,

completely lost in a fantasy that starred her. Glancing around the room, I didn't know what else to do. There was still nothing I could find that explained anything. I had arrived with a clear intention to strike a blow against Tucker, but instead, I found myself lost in a maze of uncertainty. Was Aria like Hester, a woman who knew and practiced some sort of magic? Was Tucker's fascination with Catherine a passing thing, little more than a fantasy? I looked at the two again. I understood even less than when I arrived and the feeling frustrated me.

With a deep breath, I soared back to the sea, my mind a whirlpool of emotions. My insides were a raging torrent, a storm of questions and feelings that threatened to consume me. I stepped out into the shallow waves that lapped the shore and did my best not to cry. I was alone, and it felt as though the entire world had conspired against me. "Enele? Can you hear me?" I whispered the words. "I need your help." But even as I spoke the words, I knew that she couldn't help. I thought of calling for Muma again, but didn't, because there, at the moment, knee deep in the bay, all I wanted was Kim. "I should have sought you out, run to you the very moment I was bestowed with this enigmatic gift." It was nonsense. Even if I had run to her, it wouldn't have been the same, I was different, I was no longer Emma Sans, the bi-sexual archaeologist, passionately in love with a beautiful photographer. After Enele, I had shed my humanity, transformed into…this.

Wandering back onto the shore, I found a place in the tall grass and collapsed. For some reason, a hunger gnawed at me, a weakness that seemed to echo the trials I had faced in previous chapters. Tears rolled down my cheeks, splashing to the ground and giving life to beauty. Every spot they touched burst into a lush carpet of vibrant flowers and twisting vines, more beautiful than anything I had ever seen. But I didn't care. Filled with a despair so profound it ached, I wept, each tear a testament to my isolation. Maybe it was the exhaustion, maybe it was a combination of my loneliness and frustration, but for whatever reason, when the first light of dawn lit the eastern sky, I disappeared into a dark and troubled sleep.

It felt as though I had been asleep for mere minutes when a faint sound reached my ears. It was faint, little more than a whisper through my

thoughts, but enough to wake me. It sounded something like a voice, maybe from far away. I couldn’t tell what it was saying or even if it was male or female, only that it was there. I focused and tried to listen, but couldn’t. I could hear it but it was like the memory of hearing it or maybe I couldn’t really hear it all but sense it. Either way, I couldn’t find it, couldn’t figure out where it was coming from.

I sat up, greeted by the enveloping darkness, and looked around, trying to make sense of my surroundings. I found myself still in the grass, sitting near the shore where I had collapsed, the memory of my exhaustion still lingering. I looked up, searching for stars, but the sky was eerily starless. Was I dreaming? I closed my eyes again and listened, hoping to solve the mystery, but nothing had changed, whatever it was it was still there, just outside of my senses, outside of my power. Frustrated, I decided to take a walk along the beach, try to gain some focus, and figure a plan. A hunger gnawed at me; I needed energy, substantial and real, not the mere wisps I had tasted from Aria and Tucker.

How I longed for Julia... her touch, her attentions, the intimacy we once shared. The water rolled along the sand and splashed across my naked feet, its cool touch a fleeting connection to the world I once knew. I took a deep breath and tried to find some comfort in my surroundings. For my entire human existence, the sea had always had a calming effect, as if the great energy of the ocean and the rhythmic roll of the waves were able to slow my thoughts and soothe my worries.

It was almost dawn when I found the little fishing village. I had been walking for hours, moving further and further away from Hester, Tucker, and all the new problems that 1691 had presented. A warm glow issued from the windows of the inn. The sign, gently swinging in the breeze over the door, bore the name: The Monarch, a promise of shelter. I peered through the window, glimpsing a fire in the hearth that warmed the great room, its flickering flames dancing on the wooden beams and rustic furniture.

Looking down at myself, I transformed into a traditional black dress, white apron, and collar, complemented by buckled shoes and a heavy riding cloak with a hood. I figured, if anything, I probably looked like a

wealthy traveler, a status that could afford some anonymity if the doors were unlocked. The latch clicked, and the top of the door struck a little bell as I stepped inside, its chime resonating like a herald of my arrival into the unknown. The fire had dwindled to a pile of red-hot coals, glowing with a faint promise of warmth. I let the warmth of the fire wash over me. The inn was quaint, a simple wooden structure with a great room at the front, a large kitchen to one side, and rooms upstairs. There was nothing particularly striking about the place, yet it held a rustic charm that beckoned me.

After a few moments, I heard a door somewhere on the ground floor open, and a young woman in a rather plain nightgown stepped into the room. She smiled, her eyes sparkling with genuine warmth. “Hello there, are you looking for a bed for the night?” Her eyes twinkled in the firelight. “Yes, I was also hoping for a bath?” The words escaped my mouth unexpectedly, sending a little shiver through me, as if guided by an unseen force. “We have a small room available and it has a basin,” the young woman looked me over like she wasn’t sure I either had money or knew how much of a luxury something like a bath would cost. “You have money?” I reached into my pocket, producing a handful of gleaming Spanish dollars, their weight a tangible reminder of my worldly connection. The woman’s eyes grew wide. “Right this way, please.”

We walked down a narrow hall and stopped at the last door. The young woman lifted a small oil lantern from the wall, its glow casting a warm light as she showed me inside. The room was tastefully appointed with a tall bed adorned with plush linens, a small nightstand bearing delicate carvings, and along the wall opposite the hearth stood a simple but beautiful basin, its elegance a contrast to the room's simplicity. The bath was a work of art, a hand-beaten slipper tub, its copper surface gleaming invitingly. Every facet along the copper caught the lamplight differently, creating a mesmerizing dance of reflections that seemed to tell a story of craftsmanship and care.

As soon as my eyes fell on the thing, the young woman set the lamp down on the stand. “I have hot water in the kitchen. Would you prefer your bath now, milady?” I could sense her eagerness to please, the amount of money I had given the poor girl must have been obscene. I walked to the

basin, drawn to its elegance, and ran my finger along the rolled edge, feeling its cool, smooth surface. “Yes,” I smiled, “may I?” The young woman smiled. “Absolutely,” she curtsied gracefully, “I will return with the water.”

When she left, I sat on the edge of an over-stuffed bed waiting on an inn’s hostess to carry water from the kitchen hearth. I looked at the little fireplace in the room. I still didn’t know why I had wandered so far, or why I had been drawn to enter the inn, or even why I had impulsively decided to get a room. The mystery deepened with every step, but there I was, sitting on the edge of an over-stuffed bed, waiting, and pondering the path that had led me here.

With a mere thought, a spark crawled across the wood stacked on the iron grate, and within a breath or two, it danced with the lamp's reflections along the tub, creating a symphony of light. The floor danced in jagged golden pieces as the flames moved, casting a magical glow that seemed to breathe life into the room's humble furnishings.

The young woman entered the room, her arms straining with a large bucket in each hand, her face flushed from the effort, the firelight dancing off her long, auburn hair that cascaded over her shoulders like a waterfall of flames. “I am sorry I arrived so late,” I said, my eyes fixed on her as she emptied the first bucket into the basin, the steam rising like a soft cloud, carrying with it the promise of warmth.

“It’s no trouble at all,” she reassured, her voice tinged with a hint of loneliness. “Things have been slow; only one room was taken this night.” She set the first bucket down and turned to me, her eyes filled with simple curiosity. “Would you care to get in now or would you prefer that I fill the basin?”

I deftly unbuttoned the cloak, letting it fall to the bed, before I set to work on the intricate buttons that held the collar and apron, each one a challenge to my patience. “How long have you worked here?” I asked, seeking connection.

“The inn was my dowry,” she said, her eyes softening as she watched me struggle with the heavy button at my throat, stepping over to help with a grace born of kindness. “But I was never married, so it became my inheritance.” Her fingers were strong, skilled in their task.

“Never married?” I asked, momentarily taken aback by her youth, but then quickly realizing the constraints of the time we were in, where marriage was often a girl's destiny.

“No, my parents would not force me to marry, though they wished I would settle for one of their choices,” she said, her voice tinged with defiance as she glanced at the fire over my shoulder, her eyes softening, “but I wanted to marry for love, something real and true.”

Love. The word resonated within me, a haunting reminder of what it had once meant to me as a human, a connection now lost in time. I thought of Kim and how, though we had only been together for a short time, I had loved her more than anything. She had become my everything, the person my soul longed for. But that too had changed. As I was being transformed, swept from humanity to godhood across the white linen of Enele’s bed, I had fallen in love then too. Of course, it wasn’t the same as it had been with Kim. No, with Enele it was different, more, almost holy in a way I could barely understand, but it was love. I loved and then lost her.

Naturally, my thoughts drifted to Julia, the first to worship me, one of my loves – different yet again. This time, love was not just an emotion; it was sustenance, the very energy that allowed me to exist. The emptiness moved across my thoughts the way a cloud moved across the sun. I was alone, adrift in a sea of time and change. Everyone I had ever loved, ever known, was gone, lost to the inexorable march of existence.

I took a deep breath, shaking off the melancholy that threatened to engulf me. Feeling sorry for myself wasn’t going to change anything; it was a futile indulgence. “Do you have anyone now?” I looked into her eyes, resisting the urge to peruse her thoughts.

“No,” she blushed, her voice carrying a weight of resignation. “I think it might be too late for me,” she sighed, a surrender to a fate she had not chosen.

My apron came free, and the young woman's gentle hands helped me out of my dress and into the high-walled basin, her touch careful and respectful. I had sculpted myself back into my old body with a few enhancements, the things I had always wished for as I was growing up - a fuller figure, elongated legs, and a more shapely silhouette.

When I sat down, the water barely grazed my legs, leaving me momentarily exposed. But the young woman quickly retrieved the second bucket, her movements efficient and practiced. As she turned the bucket over the edge and started to pour the hot water in, she looked over at the riding cloak I had thrown on the bed. A confused look crossed her face. “Where did you say you were coming from?”

“I have traveled a very long way,” I sighed, my voice carrying the weariness of a journey that transcended mere distance.

“Europe? Your accent is odd,” she remarked, curiosity dancing in her eyes as the water ran out. She started for the door, pausing to add, “Let me get another,” her voice filled with a willingness to please.

I leaned my head back against the curve of the tub and moved the warm water around my body. It felt better than I imagined, the gentle caress like hands moving across my skin. The last few days had been a blur. I was exhausted.

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*10 Ravenous

I closed my eyes and savored the warmth of the water around me while the young innkeeper was in the kitchen fetching more. I could sense her presence as she filled the water from pots hanging in the kitchen hearth. She hadn’t expected me, my sudden arrival late in the evening, and her mind was filled with questions. Relaxing in the water, I tuned into the young woman’s thoughts, letting them float through my mind as I lay there luxuriating, a subtle use of my divine ability to sense the thoughts of others – my first real respite from the torment of this unfamiliar place. Could she have traversed the perilous southern lands, guarded by the fierce tribes known as savages? Surely not, they would have killed her like they kill the rest.

The water kissed the sides of the copper basin, a gentle caress as I stretched, reveling in the warmth. It was nice to listen to the innkeeper's thoughts, her simple curiosity, especially when my own thoughts were only dark and afraid. I had wandered from Tucker’s home, aimlessly along the shoreline, dark hopelessness consuming me. I couldn’t shake it. I was adrift, lost in a sea of loneliness, a stranger in a strange land.

With every day that passed, no matter what I did, my situation seemed little better than when Toniat, a goddess ancient and powerful, had banished me here. I still had no idea how to get home and, even if I did somehow manage it, what then? I was no match for her. She had laughed in my face when I had tried to fight her. I had been foolish, I should have known better, but it was all just so much – I wanted revenge.

I sighed, my gaze drifting to the heavy wooden timbers of the ceiling. I thought of Hester and her bargain, the way her power had somehow mixed with mine and become a part of me. How was that even possible? What was she? What power did she wield, and why? What of my

own powers? How was I to use them? I was somehow different now, affected.

And Aria? That was the last thing I had expected at Tucker’s home. Why did his wife seem to have magic as well, magic different from Hester’s or my own?

Anger surged through me, a fiery tide of confusion and frustration. There was so much I didn’t understand, so many questions without answers. My fists clenched beneath the water's surface, and I took a deep breath, striving to steady my turbulent thoughts. It wasn’t easy. Being alone brought a despair that clung to me, a shadow I couldn't shake. I doubted myself, my ability to actually figure this out and get away. The power that had put me here had countless worshippers, souls who did nothing but fuel her existence. I was a goddess unmoored, without worshippers or temple, a lonely deity in a world fraught with danger and uncertainty, far from the realm I once ruled.

I recalled the moment Enele had vanished before my eyes. How she had handed me the artfully crafted box I had rescued her from with that look in her eyes, the compassion, the love…and then she was gone. Is that how I will go? Will I simply disappear?

Closing my eyes while the water moved across my skin, I tried to focus on the innkeeper’s thoughts again. It took a moment, but then I heard her filling the heavy bucket as her mind filled with observations and questions. She’s so beautiful, the innkeeper's thoughts whispered to me.

I smiled, a wistful thought crossing my mind. If only she knew. I inhaled deeply, losing myself in the sensation of water caressing my skin, a momentary comfort. All the troubles in the world can’t beat a good bath.

After a few moments, the woman’s footsteps sounded along the floor as she entered the room, but I didn’t move. My body perfectly relaxed, I simply lay there, enveloped by the water, lost in a murky haze of relaxation and worry.

“Some more water, milady.” Her voice was soft like she wasn’t sure if I was awake or if I had drifted off to sleep.

“Please,” I said, opening one eye and grinning. “What’s your name?”

“Imyne. Imyne Galren.” For some reason, she blushed.

“Well, thank you very much, Imyne.” The water began to splash into the tub, and the heat of it tingled across me. I stretched my muscles, spread my arms and legs. I thought of Kim, memories of our shared baths filled with love and tenderness, a stark contrast to my current solitude. I recalled the scent of her cigarette smoldering in an ashtray on the toilet lid, our voices echoing in the confined space. An old ache, one of longing, filled my chest. It seemed like so long ago, hundreds of years, even though it was only months. I wondered about her current whereabouts. What archaeological dig was she working on, and with whom?

I missed that life, my old life. Stop pitying yourself. We’re not out of this yet. I attempted a smile at my own foolishness, the sound of water spilling into the tub grounding me back to the inn's dark walls and flickering candlelight.

I withdrew from the labyrinth of my own thoughts and attuned myself to Imyne's, a delicate dance of minds that revealed her deepest desires and fears. Had I been blessed with a body like hers, I wouldn't be here. With breasts like hers, I would have been married before mother and father came here. I would have had my choice between Stephen and James. I would be gone, a thousand miles away, maybe on an island somewhere. Wait, why is the water still flowing? How?

Imyne suddenly realized that the bucket in her hands was still pouring hot water into the tub long after it should have been empty.

I succumbed to temptation; the sensation of fresh, hot water swirling around me was a delightful caress, a seductive dance that I could not resist. Besides, manipulating the water was effortless.

Imyne turned the bucket upside down to dump the remainder, but the bucket didn’t empty. Staring at the wooden vessel in her hands, her mind exploded with questions. Am I dreaming? This must be some fantasy. She tapped the wooden side, a tentative knock as if a simple touch might halt the magic, but the water defied her, continuing its relentless pour into the tub. I am asleep and all of this is... She tilted the bucket upwards and the water came from the bottom like there was a hole somewhere she couldn’t see. Is it magic? Is she a witch?

The word 'witch' sent a shiver through me. I halted the water's flow and fixed my gaze on the young innkeeper. She really was a beauty. How she had managed to remain unattached was a mystery to me. Though not voluptuous, the hard work of running an inn had sculpted her into a lean and strong figure, enhancing her natural beauty.

The darkness inside of me stirred, a ravenous hunger awakening, a beast unchained, yearning to be fed.

Wait—she thinks I'm a witch? Memories of the notorious witch trials in Salem and other northeastern villages flooded my mind.

She held my gaze; obviously a bit embarrassed by the way I had been staring at her.

I inhaled deeply, the water rising like a lover's touch along the curves of my breasts, caressing my skin with a sensual grace until only my nipples dared to pierce the surface, teasing and tantalizing. I tried not to think about the darkness, about the appetite that stirred inside of me.

Despite the steam that rose off the water, I felt cold on the inside, cold and tired, and weak. I stared at the innkeeper and remembered Julia at my feet, my first worshipper, and the energy she provided. But with that memory came the image of Toniat and what she had done.

Looking at the young woman perched at the end of the tub; a sudden desperation filled my mind. Panic choked me. I didn’t want to fade away. I didn’t want to die stuck in history, hundreds of years before my own time.

No, I owed Enele more than that. I owed the world more than that. No, as long as there was a Toniat, the world needed me as balance. But what am I supposed to do without someone to worship me?

Take her, the temptation whispered. You need the strength to survive.

A shiver of fear moved through me. Memories of Toniat's temple surfaced, where slaves masqueraded as servants, their unwitting devotion fueling her strength. A dark parallel to my own temptation.

I glanced at the innkeeper again, her presence as enticing as a cold glass of water on a sweltering day. The urge to take her was relentless. My eyes fell to the water, reflecting my inner turmoil. The temptation to take her, to make her my own, was a siren's call.

I could take her, claim her as my own, even if just once, and then return her. But the darkness within me stirred, a ravenous hunger awakening. I remembered Julia's madness, a haunting reminder. No matter how much I craved the innkeeper's vitality, I knew it was wrong.

But the darkness inside of me moved. It was a hunger. Hester’s magic, the mix of exchanged energies, had done something, changed something inside of me. Where Enele’s gift had been light, Hester’s was dark and hungry and unafraid.

If you could have anything, I whispered the question into the young woman’s thoughts, what would it be?

"Can you hear me? Can you hear my thoughts?" Imyne's voice trembled, frozen beside the basin, empty bucket in hand, her eyes locked onto mine. "Then it wasn't a dream? You did that with the water?" Her voice cracked, disbelief in her eyes.

“No,” I said, closing my eyes and leaning back in exasperation. Can't one thing go right?

“You're a witch!” she exclaimed.

In this time, 1691, magic was a matter of life and death. A mere suspicion could lead to execution.

Imyne's eyes widened, her gaze fixed on me, as if trying to comprehend the incomprehensible.

I'm not a witch, I assured her, concentrating to ease her mind without exerting control. But just reaching into her thoughts made the hunger stir. A sudden urge overcame me to dominate her, to slip into her mind, bend her knees, and make her kneel before her goddess.

I clenched my jaw, every fiber of my being straining to keep myself in the tub, resisting the dark urge.

“If you are not a witch, then what? How can you?” She glanced at the traveling cloak on the bed.

I inhaled deeply, the weight of my revelation settling. “Magic, power, energy,” I said, my fingers dancing through the water, sending ripples across the surface. “I embody all of these things.”

“But the witches...” she stammered, her voice trailing off, lost in the terrifying folklore of her time.

“There is no reason to fear, Imyne.” It was difficult not to chuckle at her naiveté. Her mind grabbed at every memory she had of the word magic. Few of the stories brought her any comfort.

“I'm not a witch,” I reassured her, my voice gentle. I looked at the woman in front of me, her fear mirroring my own internal struggle. While she wrestled with the unknown, I battled with Hester's dark magic, a hunger that threatened to consume me.

My gaze lingered on her, taking in the plain black dress, white apron, and broad buckled belt that adorned her pretty figure. The innkeeper's hands fidgeted as I looked her over. She stared down at the floor

self-consciously. Fear and uncertainty were gaining ground in her mind, and I knew that if I hesitated even a moment longer, she would flee.

And then I got an idea.

“If you could have anything you wanted,” I said, gesturing around the room with a theatrical flourish, my voice tinged with a tempting inflection, “what would it be?”

“What?” The floor creaked as she took another step backward toward the door.

She looked like a startled fawn. I took a calming breath. “If you could have anything you wanted, anything, what would it be?” My patience ran thin. I could feel her fear winning, so I slipped into her thoughts and tried to find the answer to my question.

“I, uh, um…” She tried to settle on one of a hundred ideas. "I would be rich, travel the world. I wouldn't be stuck forever in this inn. I would be someone else... I would be like Sarah."

Sarah. The name conjured images of a young woman, Imyne's age, with jet-black hair cascading like shadows over her shoulders, her eyes as blue and brilliant as diamonds. Inside her thoughts, I could see her favorite memories like I was standing right beside her.

They had been friends in her homeland, a picturesque coastal city with a distinctly Italian charm. Her father had been a sea captain, they were wealthy. There were beautiful dresses and ribbons. Sarah had been rich and beautiful with suitors and fine clothes while Imyne had always been left in her shadow, a poor family that worked Sarah’s estate. Imyne envied her, always wished that her own family had been more than servant class. She had always wanted to be Sarah.

Reading the innkeeper made the darkness inside of me stronger, like it knew that I was closer, that I could take her. I took a deep breath, trying to ignore the tumultuous battle that raged within me, a conflict between desire and morality.

Standing in the innkeeper's mind, watching her memories, I felt torn between two selves: Emma, the woman I knew, and a darker, more terrible version that beckoned me. A version that, inexplicably, I found myself less afraid of. There was sweetness to the power I felt. It was almost intoxicating, the predator that wanted to be free.

I looked at Imyne, tasting her fear, a flavor that was intoxicatingly sweet.

I smiled, and without uttering a word, I set the transformation in motion, reshaping the young woman before me.

First, her auburn hair darkened, transforming into jet black curls that cascaded over her shoulders. She looked down with wide eyes. "What…?" She took the hair in her fingers like she wasn't sure it was real.

Next, her breasts began to transform, the small mounds bulging and broadening into a voluptuous shape. But although I was fulfilling the truest desire poor Imyne had, I did nothing to hide the discomfort of her body's change. I brought it slowly, molding her like a sculptor molds clay, pushing and pulling, prodding her from the inside out.

She bent at the waist as the pain knifed through her. "What are you doing to me?" She nearly collapsed to her knees, her body wracked with agony.

I subtly broadened her shoulders, elongating her frame, before returning my focus to her breasts. I expanded them deliberately until they were almost twice their original size. With a mere thought, I accentuated them with hard nipples that strained against the fabric of her now-stretched dress.

I sat in the tub, watching the changes take shape, her body yielding to my will. The muscles in her body contorted and tightened, writhing under the sweep of agonizing pain. And a part of me wanted to stop the pain. It wasn't necessary, I could have changed her in a blink with no more than a passing sigh from her, but I didn't.

When the first change finished and the pain dissipated, she straightened her back and threw an evil glance at me. “You are a…”

I raised an eyebrow and stared at her chest.

She looked down at the curves that stretched the heavy black fabric and realized what I had done. “How?” Her voice trembled as she ran her hands along her new pair. “How did you…”

I thought of the question. She hadn’t asked why. No, the innkeeper wasn’t angry with the pain I put her through, she was fascinated, curious, and, judging by the way she squeezed and prodded her new, ample breasts, pleased.

I inhaled deeply, letting my gaze wander across the rest of her transformed figure. I wasn’t half done, but I felt a surge of life, a vitality I hadn't felt in days, fueled by the dark energies I was channeling.

The candlelight flickered in the innkeeper's eyes as she glanced at me, and in her eyes, a spark of greed ignited, a hunger that transcended pain. She craved more, and I sensed her willingness to endure the agony for the pleasure that awaited.

Lying back in the tub, struggling with the new desires and feelings, I gave in and transformed the woman slowly. The pain I tasted fed the darkness within me, and I reveled in it. I continued to mold her, sculpting her body into the image of her deepest desires, all the while savoring the mix of pain, wonder, and control.

The pain I tasted was a feast for the darkness within me, a craving I indulged with a savage delight, as one might savor a gourmet meal rather than toss table scraps to a begging dog.

Why am I hurting her? Why am I enjoying her pain? The questions floated through my thoughts as the innkeeper's eyes closed tightly, her face a mask of agony, and she almost fell to her knees. The bones of her fingers stretched and lengthened until they were no longer the thick, hard-working fingers of a frontier innkeeper and, instead, the slender piano-playing fingers of her rich friend.

I opened my arms wide, embracing the pain she felt, absorbing it into my very being, a dark symphony that resonated with my soul. Her soft whimpers were as intoxicating as the moans of two entwined lovers – different in nature, yet equally sweet. The energy swirling around me, like ethereal vapor trails, each breath more intoxicating than the last, tickled across me, and I felt stronger.

Stop! A voice within me shouted, piercing the haze of pleasure, and I released the innkeeper momentarily.

Imyne grabbed at the night table like she had been drinking. Her breath came in short gasps. Her face was streaked with tears.

We stared at each other for a moment. My heart was racing. It felt like Imyne understood what was happening, that the pain was the price for her transformation. A knowing grin traced its way across her lips, confirming my suspicions. In her eyes, I saw understanding, acceptance, and a hint of mischief. She knew.

The pleasure of the young woman's discomfort was like a rare, chilled whiskey, a forbidden indulgence I couldn't resist. That I had no right to torture and torment.

I surveyed my handiwork, a transformation so profound that the woman before me was a stranger, a tantalizing creation that bore no resemblance to the Imyne I had once known. No, the strong woman I had met earlier was almost completely gone. She wiped the back of her hand across her eyes and stared down at her arms and fingers.

“Do you want me to stop?” I asked, my voice laced with anticipation, as I looked across her form. The transformation was almost complete.

She wrapped her arms around her belly, panting and trying to control the pain. A tear splashed onto the hardwood at her feet. “No,” she looked up at me for a moment and I read her thoughts. I will be beautiful and different. No one will know me, I will be free.

I returned her little, devilish smile, the smile that said we wanted more, all of it, and that she would give me everything if I would give her freedom.

Devouring the mix of energies - the blue of her devotion that I needed to sustain my existence and the new warmer, red energy that moved into me - I felt a thousand times stronger, more alive, and more powerful than I had since arriving in this era, a time so different from my own. I didn't care about the difference, the strange cocktail of pleasure. The new energy fed a different part of me, a new part of me I was sure I had been without before Hester but was now mine.

I wanted to despise the tantalizing ribbons of energy that came from her pain, yet they ensnared me, binding me to a pleasure I couldn't resist. The new energy made me almost giddy. I was drunk with it.

The innkeeper's eyes widened and she barely stifled a scream. With both hands braced against the wall to keep from falling, she endured the stretching and molding of her legs, her bones reshaping to form new hips and waist. I sculpted her frame, adding an inch to her height and molding the voluptuous curves of her ass.

With a flourish of my fingers, her complexion transformed, her skin deepening to a rich, warm shade, as if kissed by the sun. She leaned against the wall, sweat mixed with her tears.

An inch taller and almost an exact replica of her friend, the innkeeper turned and looked at me. Though her face was etched with pain, a weak grin managed to break through. “Look at me,” she did her best to turn without falling over, and the bottom of her dress flared around her, “I'm new.” Her voice broke.

I smiled and put the finishing touches on her transformation, changing her eyes from pale green to sapphire blue. I took a breath and inhaled her pain, leaving her with none.

A tall, oval mirror framed in dark, heavy wood materialized beside her. “Are you pleased with your new form?” I asked, my voice laced with anticipation.

She took a breath and wobbled a bit on her new legs before she looked in the mirror. “Sarah?” She touched the mirror's surface like she wasn't sure that it was her and not her friend standing on the opposite side of the glass.

Her fingers explored her face, marveling at the heightened cheeks and the alluring curve of her newly formed lips. “It's truly me. You've transformed me... I'm her mirror image now.” She swept her hands along her body's new curves and then tossed the dark curls of her new hair over her shoulders.

I looked across her form, my eyes lingering on the transformation, a mixture of pride and guilt warring within me. It was almost complete, and the result was both beautiful and terrifying.

"I gave you what you wished for," I whispered, my voice echoing through her thoughts.

“But how? I am…am I?” She placed her hand atop her head, realization dawning that her new height offered a fresh, altered perspective. She squeezed her round breasts and turned around again and again in front of the mirror, examining every inch of her new body.

A silly grin, akin to that of a child who has just discovered a secret, crept across her newly formed face. “It’s magic. You’re magic.” She glanced at me happily, wiping away the tears of joy that rolled down her new cheeks.

My fingers moved through the water as I watched her excitement. The wisps of energy her pain had brought were gone, and a part of me wasn’t happy about it. I wanted more. There was something so sweet about the energy that fed Hester’s magic. Now I will take you.

The thought sent a shock through me. I recoiled at its intensity, yet as I watched the young woman twirl in the mirror, glee in her eyes, I found myself craving more of the pleasure her pain and fear had bestowed upon me. I imagined breaking her. I almost wanted to.

Staring down at the water, I wrestled with the desire. I was hungry, weak, and alone, but now there was something else—something new and dark that I couldn't comprehend, yet it was ravenous, and feeding it made me stronger.

If this is a dream, I don’t want to wake. Let me stay in it forever. The innkeeper's excitement resonated with me, her joy tingling along my skin, a connection that was both thrilling and unsettling.

Choices waged a war within my mind, each decision a battle between desire and morality. With a thought, I tore her dress free and left her standing in front of the mirror naked. I didn't want to seize her; I yearned for her to willingly surrender herself to me.

The innkeeper froze as her eyes traveled her new body. She ran her fingertips along her olive skin. “You are a god!” she exclaimed. “Goddess,” I corrected, smiling as I too examined the masterpiece my power had fashioned. The change had left her weaker, but she seemed unaware of the toll. She was drunk on the power and magic, fascinated by what was happening to her.

I couldn’t blame her. Her existence, all I had learned wandering across the surface of her thoughts, had been deadly dull. Living on the village outskirts, closer to the docks than the main road, she found herself isolated, with few she could truly call friends. What was happening to her, here and now in the little room, was unlike anything she could have ever imagined.

“A goddess?” The idea seemed to stop her. She looked me over, staring down at the water in the tub. “Like the Greek gods and goddesses?” She spread her legs slightly, her eyes lingering on the curve of her thighs

and the intimate place where they met. I had left nothing untouched, and her fascination was evident.

I recalled my days in Rome, sifting through ancient relics near The Colosseum, a young scholar uncovering the mysteries of a time long past. Could she have been a Futa?

But I was not a deity like them. I was something else, something distinct and more fragile than Aphrodite or her immortal peers. I was Emma, created of Enele. And I had been banished here. Left to die.

I looked back at the young woman before me, the innkeeper whose dreams I had realized through a torturous transformation, a dance between pleasure and pain. “Yes, like the Greek gods and goddesses,” I smiled through the lie.

She stared at me for a moment, trying to think of what to say or do, and forgot that I could hear her thoughts. She's a goddess. That explains her solitude tonight. Such power! And look at me now! She turned back to the mirror, her eyes wide, still stunned by the reflection gazing back at her. What do I do? How did the Greeks worship their gods? Should I kneel? Yes, kneeling is a good idea.

She bowed her head in reverence and walked to the side of the tub. “I don't know what to say or do, milady—Goddess. Forgive my ignorance,” she stammered, her face reddening with embarrassment.

“There is no reason for forgiveness.”

Energy swirled around us, a tangible force that set every nerve in my body alight with sensation. I could feel the strength she could give me, the energy she held. I felt what I had felt when Julia had fallen at my feet, something like joy, like seeing someone again that you have missed for a long time.

Happiness. That's what it was. For the first time in what felt like an eternity, I was enveloped in happiness, and its embrace was intoxicating. I

absorbed the energy of her worship. Yes, she was afraid. Yes, she was unsure of herself. But who wouldn’t be, especially when faced with something as powerful as me?

My eyes scanned the sparse room, lingering on the simple bed, the small oil lamp perched on a three-legged table, and the copper basin casting chaotic arcs of golden light across the floor and walls. In this secluded world, untouched by the clamor of modernity, conveniences like televisions, phones, the Internet, cars, and planes were mere myths. Here, the timeless rhythm of nature held sway, a dance of seasons and elements that shaped life's ebb and flow. There was purity in that, a simple but powerful purity.

Imyne looked up at me with a mischievous grin, like a child who just realized that there were no rules. “Then I am yours, goddess.” She stood and glanced at her ass in the mirror again. “How can I serve you?” Her eyes wandered across my body, still lying in the massive copper tub. “Tell me how to serve you.”

Bold and brave, the young innkeeper met my gaze, her eyes alight with a fearless curiosity that intrigued me. As her fingers grazed my hand, a tangible energy surged between us, a connection both electrifying and intimate. She sucked in a deep breath and closed her eyes. “Oh!” she half-moaned as an orgasm crashed across her body. Blue vapor emanated from her as if she were aflame, her knees buckling as she teetered on the brink of collapse. She grabbed onto the edge of the tub and moaned again, squeezing my hand.

Shedding the traveler's illusion, I stood in the knee-deep water, embracing my true form as a goddess, a being of power and desire.

The young woman's eyes widened as they fell upon the glory of my Futanari gift, a mixture of awe and curiosity dancing in her gaze. “Goddess,” still holding my hand, she lowered herself to her knees. Sweat beaded across her forehead and her cheeks became a rosy pink. “I am yours,” she panted the words, delirious from the pleasure of my touch.

Stepping free of the polished copper basin, I moved toward her, naked. I smiled and savored her worship.

Without a word, her hand reached out, tentatively exploring the soft flesh of my flaccid cock. A gasp escaped her lips as another orgasm washed over her, her teeth biting into her lower lip in a futile attempt to contain her pleasure. A shiver ran through her, and I could smell the musk between her legs.

Her mind swirled with pleasure and curiosity, a tantalizing mix that beckoned me closer. My hand found her head, a gentle touch filled with unspoken promise.

“Yes,” she closed her eyes.

My cock began to lengthen, growing slowly in her hands. Taking a deep breath, I tried to fight the urges that battled inside. The part of me I knew and understood, at least well enough not to question, was the desire to bask in the innkeeper’s worship, to simply accept the gift of her energy and pleasure. But the darkness, the remnants of whatever it was Hester had left me with, wanted more, much more.

A deep-seated anger churned within me, a resentment at being banished to this place, a longing for what was lost. I looked down at the innkeeper, a hunger rising within me to consume her very essence, leaving only a hollow shell behind.

As I grew erect in her hands, the innkeeper leaned forward, her cheek caressing the underside of me with a tenderness that sent shivers down my spine. I bit my lip, savoring the exquisite sensation of her touch, a delicate dance of skin against skin.

“Let me please you,” she whispered, staring up at me, her eyes filled with longing. “Take me in your fashion,” she murmured, her hands slowly stroking my length.

I extended my hand, an invitation as I rose to my feet, the water cascading down my body. I lowered myself to my knees and leaned forward to kiss her lips, but before we touched, a bolt of energy snaked out of my chest and snapped against Imyne.

Her scream reverberated through the room as another bolt, as thick as my arm, lashed against her belly, a purple lightning strike that left us both breathless.

In a fluid motion, I moved away from her, my back against the opposite wall. My robe wrapped around me as if summoned, a barrier between us.

But the damage was already done. The twisting purple energy sparked and snapped around the innkeeper like she was being attacked by a nest of slithering snakes.

“No!” I cried, rushing to the young woman's side, only to stop short, fear gripping me that my power might inadvertently harm her further. I reached out, desperately trying to retract the tendrils of energy, but they defied my will, continuing their relentless assault.

A faint voice whispered through the chaos of my thoughts, urging me to counter the attack. 'Use your own power,' it insisted. The room was bathed in a surreal blue glow as waves of energy erupted from my hands, enveloping the innkeeper and the malevolent magic that had struck her.

With a sudden surge of my will, the bolts of purple energy vanished, replaced by a protective shell of my own power that enveloped her fragile form. I stared down at the young woman on the floor at my feet. She was alive, her breathing shallow, and there were spider web-like burns where the energy had touched her, but she was alive.

I attempted to slip into her mind to offer comfort, only to encounter a cool, impenetrable darkness, a barrier that defied my intrusion, a mystery that beckoned and repelled.

“Imyne,” I whispered her name as I knelt beside her, “can you hear me?” She didn’t stir.

What happened? What was that? I sat back on the floor and pulled my knees up to my chest. Tears filled my eyes. None of it made sense. What had happened? What was this new energy that I couldn’t control or understand? Anger welled up in my chest. A thought nagged at me, wondering if Imyne would harbor anger like Julia had after enduring Toniat's cruel torture.

The innkeeper sat up and gasped for air like she had been drowning. She waved her arms and shook her head violently back and forth. “Imyne?” I reached toward her and then stopped, afraid of what might happen if I touched her.

She seemed to focus on my voice and stopped shaking. Her black hair fell forward as she stared down at the floor. She resembled a discarded rag doll, lifeless and forlorn in the middle of the room, a haunting image of vulnerability. “That’s a lovely name,” the innkeeper tilted her head and looked around the room, “Imyne.” Her blue eyes sparkled. “She feels Irish.” She held out her arms and stretched her fingers a couple of times. “I feel…” she tilted her head and stared up at the ceiling like she was looking for a word, “…weak? I need strength. Power.” Her eyes wandered across my body for a moment. “Where is my master?”

It was Imyne’s body, Imyne’s voice, but it wasn’t Imyne. A shiver ran through me. The magic. Hester’s magic. I slipped to the far side of the room, magically disappearing and reappearing a moment later.

The innkeeper held up her hands, studying her fingers with a detached curiosity, as if seeing them for the first time. She tilted her neck from side to side like she wanted to know how far it might go before it broke.

The Exorcist. I remembered the movie, the way the demon had inhabited the girl. Was that what this was? Is this what Hester’s magic had

done? I had brought something into this world, birthed something? And why had it asked for its master?

I froze, haunted by the darkness, the insatiable power that had lingered ever since my encounter with Hester. What had she done to me? What had we unleashed? I stared at the innkeeper in silence. Part of me wanted to run away, but another part of me wanted to hold her in my arms. Who was she? What was she? Where had Imyne gone? And why was I so conflicted – afraid and almost…angry?

Thunder roared across the sky, a cacophony that seemed to come from every direction at once, growing louder and more insistent with each passing moment. The boards under my feet began to vibrate. It was the sound of a thousand thunderstorms, a hundred hurricanes sweeping toward us all at once. The entire building vibrated with the sound.

I stared into the innkeeper's eyes. There was a lump in my chest. I didn't know what had happened. I didn't know what I had done, but now there was something else. Two things – something had left me and something was coming.

The thunder grew louder, closer, and the innkeeper's pale eyes darted around the room, like she knew what it was.

Everything shook. A sudden memory overtook me, a flashback to sitting at the end of an airport runway with Kim, our eyes fixed on the planes taking off and landing, a moment of innocence now overshadowed by terror. I thought of her hand in mine and the way she would squeeze my fingers as the planes rushed toward the car, how we would hold our breath for a second, wondering before the plane's wings bent and they passed over our car as loud as thunder. I remembered... how I would lean into her, knowing I was safe but still afraid of the sound that rattled the old car to the bolts.

I watched the innkeeper slowly back away from the copper basin, her eyes darting frantically between the ceiling and me, a look of impending doom in her gaze. She was like a small child who knows it's about to be punished.

I felt the void inside of me. I suddenly felt for her. I wanted to move to her side, clutch her in my arms, but fear held me still. The part of me that had somehow caused this was afraid, but something else inside of me, something stronger, knew better. Whatever it was, wherever it was from, it was dark. It was the opposite of what I was.

The thunderous sound converged directly above the inn, and in a split second, a bolt of bright yellow light exploded into the room, a lightning strike that illuminated the chaos. I turned away as a blast of hot air shattered the room's windows and flipped the heavy bed against the wall.

The clatter faded, and then it spoke. “Too late,” a quiet, deep voice said in a disappointed whisper.

I opened my eyes, and in the center of an almost angelic glow, a man stood near the door. He was tall and strong, dressed in long, dark robes with golden symbols that moved and swirled across the fabric, like my own. He stood still, his head slightly tilted away from me.

I fixated on his robe, feeling a rush of excitement tingling through me, a spark of recognition that ignited my curiosity. Was he like me? Was he a god? Could he be the answer to how I was going to get home?

From where I was standing, I could see him in profile, the tall form, the strength of his frame, his thick hands. On his head, he wore an ornate, golden helmet. I couldn't see his face, but I could sense his power. There was something familiar about it, like I recognized it, but I didn't know why?

I took a step to the right to look into his eyes, but the helm was unlike anything I had ever seen. Instead, it was a work of art, a manifestation of power and identity. It looked like someone had poured pure gold over the top of the man's head, and the metal had slowly covered not only his head but his eyes and nose as well. Only his mouth and chin were visible under the place where the metal had hardened. The rest was smooth and glowing.

He didn't turn to look at me but kept his gaze fixed on the young innkeeper tucked away in shadow near the splintered bed.

“Always so dramatic,” Imyne's voice slithered through the darkness.

With a thought, the symbols on my robe grew bright and brought light to the room.

The innkeeper's eyes narrowed as she studied the newcomer, a calculating glint in her eyes as she assessed this new player in the unfolding drama. “But you're right you know,” her face wore a wicked little grin, “you are too late.” Something inside of me awoke, a sensation I couldn't quite place. I looked back at the soldier, my chest tightening as the tendrils of energy began to tear at the protective shield he had summoned, a shield I somehow knew he had crafted with precision.

The soldier turned his head, and I stared at my own murky reflection in the glowing gold of his helm, a relic of the ancient warriors. I wondered what his eyes looked like under the metal. Why do I somehow know you? The golden sphere sparked and flickered, like a star struggling to shine through a stormy night.

“No,” the soldier slowly pulled his sword, a blade forged in the ancient fires of the kingdom, free from the floor and stood. The darkness stopped its attack. Imyne’s body looked weak and gray. She was breathing hard. But she wasn’t finished yet. “She sent a captain for me,” there was a hint of respect as she slowly got to her feet. Her hands began to glow again, this time brighter and stronger.

The soldier took a step toward the innkeeper, lifting his sword. I watched, breathless, as they clashed, swords and magic intertwining in a deadly dance. Energies tangled and sparked in the air around us. Imyne screamed as the sword touched her shoulder. I watched in horror as the soldier’s helmet smoked and melted, the acrid scent filling the air.

Imyne focused her power and black lightning snaked from her hands only to meet the blue haze of the soldier’s sword and spark and die. Meanwhile, the soldier’s sword was a flurry of deft movements that parried

almost every attack the innkeeper dealt. But his defense kept him from moving forward. He gained half a step here and there, but within moments I could tell the two were evenly matched.

I locked eyes with Imyne, seeing past the innkeeper's facade. She looked desperate, almost afraid. The angry arrogance was gone, replaced by desperation and fear. A tear rolled along her cheek and I saw the soldier move forward. His robe smoked and burned where the energies had touched it. There were dark marks across the metal of his helm, places where the innkeeper’s magic had burned through.

I was torn, my heart aching with uncertainty. Who was I to aid in this battle of wills? I looked back at the innkeeper and I heard Imyne’s voice in my thoughts. You are a goddess. My goddess. Help me. He will kill me if he can. Her eyes went wide as the soldier took another step forward.

My breath caught in my throat. Enough. With a determined stride, I stepped into the space between them, my heart pounding. “Yes,” Imyne’s voice rang through my thoughts. The soldier took another step forward and lifted a hand toward me. His energy washed across me like a cool breeze in the heat of summer. I felt it through the fabric of my robe, something safe and reassuring. I smiled.

But it was too late. From the other side, the innkeeper’s magic struck me. I felt the darkness move through me, a chilling sensation that gripped my very soul. I froze. I expected pain, but instead felt the stream of power flowing into me. Dark energy poured into me from the innkeeper, a new worship. I looked at Imyne and saw the being again.

Imyne’s skin lost its gray pallor and there was color in her cheeks. I felt a surge of power, akin to the intoxicating touch between Hester and me. I threw my head back, a moan escaping my lips as the sensation rolled across me, as intense and pleasurable as a throbbing orgasm.

I couldn’t focus. I glanced to my right and saw the soldier step around me. I reached out and touched his shoulder. You cannot help me, my dear. Our fates are sealed. The words floated through the haze of my

thoughts and I realized they were his. He took another step and I saw the dark energy hit his chest. The fabric of his robe lit where the bolt touched him and burned away. He moaned and fell to his knees.

“No!” I shouted the word as another snaked into his shoulder and neck. His body went rigid. I drew a ragged breath, shaking my head to clear the fog of battle. I had to stop the flow between the innkeeper and myself. It was our energy that overcame the soldier. I couldn’t let it happen. I couldn’t be the cause of his pain or death.

Angry, I lifted my hand and poured my own strength into the fray. The innkeeper didn’t blink, her eyes fixed and unyielding. She had tasted my power and found the strength she needed. She waved her hand and something slammed against me so hard I tumbled backward, like a ragdoll tossed aside by an angry child.

I felt like my skin was on fire, like I had been drenched in flame. I screamed and waved my arms, convinced that my robe was burning around me, but there was nothing—only the illusion of fire. The golden symbols across the dark green fabric of my robe moved and shimmered, a dance of ancient magic that had always been a part of me.

I couldn’t understand. I sensed her impending victory, a palpable energy in the air. With a thought, I appeared beside the soldier. Enough. I focused on the innkeeper's mind, on the conduit that somehow existed between us.

But there was nothing. A blinding light filled the room for the space of a moment, and then everything went dark. Suddenly, I was no longer in the room, in my body, anywhere. I felt the emptiness of space, the vastness of nothing.

I could feel the soldier's presence, a fading echo in the void. He was slipping away, his very being dispersing into nothingness.

A hand slipped around my own. “Come with me,” it was the soldier. I squeezed his fingers and knew, even in the pitch darkness, that we were moving.

Suddenly, I was on the beach. The sun was setting behind me; the last few rays of warmth fell over my shoulder. The soldier sat beside me, his

face turned toward the waves, his battered helm reflecting the pink and orange clouds of the dying sun.

“I am sorry that I failed you,” he said, his voice tinged with regret, his gaze fixed on the horizon.

“What happened? Who was that? Where are you from?” The questions spilled out of me because I knew time was short. The sand, the shore, the sea in front of us under a beautiful sunset, it was all a creation. The soldier had brought me to an elaborate stage, a setting, for his death. We were between dimensions, not here or there, but in a void. The soldier had pulled me aside.

“I am but a soldier, a servant of a higher power. I was sent to kill your servant, bound by duty and command.”

His life force moved around us, a leaf caught in the breeze. He was slipping away. I took a breath and focused on him. Maybe I can heal him. I can give him my own life force.

“No,” The soldier tilted his head. “It is what we are,” he tilted his head toward the symbols that moved around his robe. They were slower now, sluggish and faint, like they were slowly dying too.

Sadness enveloped me like a heavy, suffocating coat. I leaned toward him and wrapped my arm around his shoulder. I couldn’t bear to watch him go, to witness the finality of his end.

The ocean waves softened and the light in the sky dimmed. The soldier turned, and I stared at my own reflection in his helm. “You must find a way.”

I stared at the hardened metal, at the places where the magic had marred it. “How?” Hopelessness filled me again. I didn’t understand what was happening. Tears filled my eyes as I noticed the ocean waves grow darker, their sound softer. The clouds that had been brilliant and billowing were now only faint outlines. “This is all my fault. I did this.”

“Find your strength,” the words were so quiet I wasn’t sure they weren’t my own thoughts.

And then I was laying on the shore a hundred paces from the waves under the earth’s familiar blanket of stars. He had taken me from the inn and left me by the shore.

I tried to move, but weakness overcame me. Imyne had drained my strength, sucked it out of me with a cold, merciless touch, leaving me hollow and defeated. I sighed as the tears rolled back along my temples and into my hair. I recalled Imyne, her form kneeling beside the tub, a haunting image etched in my mind. I saw the soldier's robe aflame, smoldering embers and arcs of energy reflecting across his helm, a symbol of his struggle and sacrifice. I saw Hester’s eyes, the devilish twist of her lips. I felt the soft light of Enele’s temple.

Was this peace? Was this the end I had been seeking? What would be left behind?

The sun broke the horizon, a fiery blade cutting through the darkness, separating sea and sky in a dance of light and shadow. Though weak and alone, I knew deep within that I wasn't finished; my journey was not yet over. I closed my eyes.

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*11 Preceptors

I could feel the earth moving under me. I was on my back, the sky a dark, endless void above me, as unseen hands pulled me through the shadowy, whispering woods. Opening my eyes, the trees were black silhouettes against the night sky. I was lashed on top of crisscrossed branches, hewn from the dark woods around us, that dug into my sides and back, a crude reminder of the primitive world I found myself in. My mind raced with questions, wondering who was pulling me, but as I tried to crane my neck to see, the pain overwhelmed me, forcing my eyes shut and my thoughts back to my immediate reality. Before I could take a breath and try again, I slipped back into unconsciousness.

“No, she cannot stay here,” a man's voice rumbled, deep and slow, from somewhere nearby. I could hear it but only barely.

“There is nowhere else. Look at her, she needs our help.” A young man’s voice pleaded and, even though I couldn’t open my eyes, I knew they were talking about me.

“Darkness eats her soul,” the old man's voice whispered, sending a shiver down my spine.

“But…”

“No,” another man’s voice interjected, this one not as old or young as the other two but filled with authority. “Gokokhoko is right. Take her to the twins; they will know what to do.”

There was something about the last man's voice that comforted me; it was strong but soft, authoritative yet gentle, like a father's reassurance.

I took a breath, attempting to ignore the cutting pain that arced through me like a lightning bolt, but it was too much to bear. I gasped, the world spinning, and fell back into the engulfing darkness.

When I woke, the stretcher my body was tied against still moved. Pain rippled across every nerve and muscle, like I was being stabbed from a hundred different directions. I focused my energy, wanting to heal myself, but nothing seemed to respond to my desperate plea. A chilling realization struck me; I felt almost human, vulnerable and weak. Taking a deep breath, I strained against the ties. I pulled against the cord that crossed my shoulders, but the effort lasted only a second, pain shattered through my chest. It felt like every bone in my body was broken. What happened to me? I fought to stay conscious, desperate to try and figure out what was and had happened, but I couldn't seem to keep my head above the pain. Every breath made me tired, and then it was too much, and darkness swept over me like the whip of a magician's cape.

"Oh, it's Catoako," an old woman's voice crooned, pulling me from the depths of my sleep. I heard footsteps, soft like they were moving through grass. The stretcher had stopped, and I was leaning at an odd angle, like I had been propped up against something. "What have you brought us, young warrior?" The tone was playful.

"Enola," it was the young man's voice from before. He was tired, panting, and obviously exhausted from the excursion of pulling me on a stretcher. I heard a second set of footsteps. "Alawa, good both of you are here."

The stretcher, but gently. "Set her here," commanded a new voice, Alawa, from my left, as they dragged me a few more agonizing feet.

"Gokokhoko told me to bring her; he said you could help," Catoako's voice trembled, full of concern and uncertainty. I wanted to open my eyes, see the warrior that had saved me, but I couldn't. I didn't have anything left. I could only listen.

I heard soft breathing, the world around me fading into a gentle murmur before someone finally loosened the bands that crossed my body. "She is weak," I felt the palm of a hand cross my forehead, the skin was warm but dry like parchment. "And there is much darkness still in her." The women's voices were weak and brittle, they were old.

"I feel it too," the other woman said softly. "Catoako, help us get her into the house and then you may go." There was urgency in the tone. Hands

slipped under my body, behind my shoulder blades, and someone grabbed my ankles.

If I could have screamed, if I had had the energy, I would have. Pain exploded behind my eyes. But I couldn’t make a sound, it was like I was halfway between awake and asleep, caught in the middle. But I was sure I was going to die. The sensation was as if a massive tree had fallen upon me, crushing every bone in my body with its unrelenting weight. I took a sharp breath and began to scream, but no sound came out. I heard calming voices, but I couldn’t make out the words, and then everything went silent, and I fell into the darkness yet again.

When I opened my eyes, I found myself staring up at a ceiling constructed of raw, naked tree branches, intertwined like the fingers of a giant. I'm in a hut. I smelled smoke, a sweet, soft smoke. Turning my head, I discovered that I was lying on thick, comforting blankets spread on the ground beside a small, crackling campfire.

I fixated on the little tower of sticks, mesmerized as the fire slowly consumed them, each crackle echoing my confusion. The pain had receded to a dull ache, leaving me feeling numb and disoriented, as if drugged by unseen hands. I took a breath, and a gray pain radiated through me. I stared into the fire, trying to assess the situation. Where was I? Who were all the voices I had heard? Why was I so weak?

“She is awake,” I heard Alawa’s voice, low and quiet. I turned my head and saw a thick brown strip of fur hanging like a door. “You may go, young one.”

“Thank you,” Enola said.

And then an ancient woman pushed the heavy hide aside and stepped into the room with me. I didn’t know which one because I had only heard their voices, but she looked kind. Her face was etched with a thousand wrinkles, each one a river on a map, telling tales of wisdom and age. But when I looked in her eyes, I saw youth, mirth, even a bit of mischief.

She smiled down at me and held the hide back until another woman, just as old, entered the hut. Then the hide closed, and the fire flickered in response.

“Ah, you’re awake,” Enola stepped forward. “I am Enola,” she reached down and ran her fingers through my hair. “This is my twin Alawa.”

I looked over at the door and tried to smile. They were both covered by a thin hide cut like a sackcloth dress, formless and embroidered with shells and beads. Enola had a yellow sun painted in the center of her dress while Alawa had a dark red, crescent moon across hers.

The man I had heard had called them twins, but they looked nothing alike. Both women exuded kindness and care. But there was also something else, something I could feel but didn’t understand. Maybe I was too weak, but I could sense something about them.

I focused on Alawa, attempting to slip into the labyrinth of her thoughts, but was met with an impenetrable silence. I turned my gaze to Enola, desperation mounting as I tried again, only to be met with emptiness. A chilling realization settled in: I had become powerless. Fear filled my chest.

Enola laid the palm of her hand on my cheek and closed her eyes. Warmth spread through my face. “Lie still,” her voice was barely a whisper.

I could feel the warmth of her hand but that was all, warmth, human to human contact. A void opened within me. It's gone. I'm human again, stripped of the essence that once defined me. I stared at the fire. I lost it. It’s gone, I’m human.

“You are weak.” Enola ran a cool handful of wool across my forehead. “We will heal you.” She leaned down and kissed my forehead. “Ancestor.” Her eyes twinkled.

Excitement shot through me. Where had I heard us called that? And then it came to me, Muma, outside of my temple. I remembered sitting beside him listening to the history of the world. It was the ancestors, the beings from other dimensions who traveled to earth so long ago, that eventually led to me and my kind. And these women knew what I was, who I was.

Alawa’s smile was kind and empathetic. “Welcome back,” she said, her smile a beacon of warmth, as she tucked a little cook pot onto the fire's glowing red coals.

It was wonderful how safe and warm I felt warm in their presence. It was like I was back in Kate's old apartment, curled up on the couch beside her. I tried to speak, I wanted to tell them, but I was still too weak. Just keeping my eyes open was a challenge.

"It will take both of us," Alawa ran her fingers through my hair. "It's a wonder she's still with us."

Enola knelt down and traced a symbol into the dirt near me. "It is the only way."

I wanted to see what she was tracing but I didn't have enough energy to move. Everything felt heavy, my arms, my legs, even my tongue and lips.

Still too weak to speak?" Alawa glanced at me.

I strained to say yes, to nod, to give any sign of understanding, but my body betrayed me, remaining still and unresponsive. Like I said, it was exhausting just holding my eyes open. My thoughts were mired in a thick fog, and trying to remember everything that had transpired felt like trudging through waist-high mud in a relentless rain. Is this what Enele felt as she slipped away? Weakness and then…nothing?

After a few lingering moments, a new, earthy aroma joined the sweet scent of smoke, filling the hut with a pungent mystery. This smell was something altogether different, earthy and pungent, reminiscent of wet autumn leaves tossed into a crackling fire, a scent that spoke of ancient rituals and hidden knowledge. Enola picked up a cup and held it out to her twin. "Are you ready?"

With a graceful motion, Alawa lifted the small pot, filling the cup with the steaming liquid. Her eyes met mine, a knowing glint in them. "It is time," she whispered. Enola inhaled the steam, her eyes closing in reverence as she tilted the cup back, savoring the liquid as if it were a sacred elixir. She handed back an empty cup and began to slowly hum a tune I didn't recognize.

Alawa filled the cup again and then drank it off in one go. She smacked her lips when it was empty and smiled at me before tracing more symbols into the dirt around me. After a few entrancing moments, her

fingers danced in the dirt, tracing symbols hidden from my view. She then rose, joining Alawa in a dance that seemed to transcend time.

I watched her move around me, the tune felt like it was something tangible, a ribbon that wrapped around my thoughts. Enola watched her twin's form, dappled in the firelight that danced around the little hut. For a moment, I thought I saw a hunger in her eyes.

After a few moments, she traced symbols I couldn't see into the dirt on the other side of me and then stood to join Alawa in the dance. The two interlaced their fingers over my body and stared into each other's eyes. Both hummed softly. It was mesmerizing how they moved, slowly circling me as the fire crackled nearby. I felt as if I were caught in a hallucination, adrift in a surreal dream world where smoke wove into shapes and shamans danced with ethereal grace.

Blue. I caught it out of the corner of my eye, it was just a wisp, barely visible. But I saw the color in the air as it was mixed with the sweet-smelling smoke of the fire. I blinked to make sure and watched a wisp slide from Alawa's fingertip. My heart leapt in my chest. I could almost taste it, the energy I so desperately needed.

I closed my eyes, surrendering to the feather-thin strand of energy as it cascaded to my chest, a gentle caress before it vanished into me. A tingle shivered across me. I instantly felt a little better, the pain subsided.

The twins carefully knelt on the floor on either side of me. Another thin vapor of energy fell from Enola's hands. I watched it swirl in the air and fall to my body. Warmth spread through me, like the fire in the room had been stoked into something bigger, a bonfire maybe. But I could feel myself strengthening, the weakness slowly began to fade away.

Then there was a shift, almost imperceptible, but something moved or changed around me. I opened my eyes and the light was different, no longer flickering from the fire that had warmed the hut. No, we were somewhere else.

I took a breath, and the air filled my lungs with a freshness, a purity that seemed to cleanse my very soul. Under me were soft blankets and a mattress. I was on a bed. I tilted my head looking for Enola and Alawa and found them on either side of me. Only they were not the same women that had been in the little hut. No, the old women that had been humming and dancing around me were gone, replaced by two much younger women, but somehow (maybe it was their eyes) I could tell it was them, just changed, transformed.

The ancient shamans, who had tended to me with wisdom and care in the humble hut, were gone, leaving behind a mystery that tugged at my mind. Both twins were a vision of beauty, their transformation profound yet subtle. Alawa's height still distinguished her, but everything else had metamorphosed into something new, something divine.

Yet beyond the astonishing transportation to another realm, there was something else, an underlying current of power and mystery that resonated in the very air. Both women had transcended their former selves, not merely young, naked, and beautiful, but emanating a glow, a radiance that seemed to come from within, illuminating their very essence.

I laid my head back, gazing at the ceiling, lost in thoughts that seemed to stretch back a thousand years, a distant memory now brought to life. “Who are you?” My voice was barely a whisper, like a sheet of paper being slowly torn in two, but I didn’t care. I was thrilled I could finally talk at all.

“We are the servants of Marduk, ancient of creation.” Enola smiled. “You tried to save one of our granddaughters, Cecilia.”

“She spoke to us from beyond,” Alawa looked over her twin and grinned mischievously.

I laid my head back and looked up at the ceiling. It felt like a thousand years ago. I remembered the woman, the long, colorful dress, a different gold or silver ring on every finger, and the large necklace with different-colored crystals that hung from a strange, filigree symbol.

I remembered the book she had grabbed from the shelf, our short talk about who I was and where I was from. These were her grandmothers. Servants of Marduk, a god or goddess I had never heard of. But somehow Cecilia had reached back through time and talked to them, told them our story, and now they were here helping me.

Tears clouded my vision. I felt weak and strong, happy and sad all at once. Cecilia had been so kind and paid so dearly. And still, she had found a way to aid me, even after she was gone.

“She was so kind,” I whispered as tears rolled down my face.

Alawa crawled over to me and kissed my forehead. Her lips were soft as velvet, a gentle caress against my fevered skin. She smelled like wildflowers on a spring day. Her breasts, full and inviting, hung down from her chest, reminiscent of ripe fruit ready to be tasted. “Heal,” she said before closing her eyes and moaning softly.

I glanced down, catching sight of Enola on her hands and knees, her eyes filled with a mischievous glint that spoke of her unspoken desires. There was a sudden swell in the amount of energy that wafted off of Alawa as Enola pleasured her.

I inhaled the intoxicating blue mist the twins conjured, a tangible manifestation of their shared pleasure. A warmth spread through me, a sensation unique to our world, where pleasure and magic intertwine.

With a newfound urgency, I pressed my hands against the bed, shifting my body closer to Alawa, drawn to her like a moth to a flame. Impatience overcame me, and I lifted myself, eager to meet her velvet lips with a kiss that promised more.

I was alive again, reborn through pleasure and connection. My body ached with a need so profound it felt like I hadn’t known pleasure in a thousand years. A familiar pressure began to build at the core of my being, a mounting wave of desire.

I reached out, my fingertip tracing the curve of Alawa’s breast, a spark of energy arcing between us. A sheen of sweat coated my body, a testament to the arousal that consumed me.

I licked Alawa’s lips, and my unique futanari gift began to respond, a symbol of my otherworldly sensuality. Her lips, wet and glistening, bore the evidence of her sinful indulgence.

Time seemed to slow as I put my hands against the bed, each movement deliberate as I shifted closer to Alawa. I was alive again, not just in body but in soul, a resurrection born from pleasure and connection.

My eyes were drawn to Enola's hand as it reached between her thighs, a deliberate movement filled with intent. A longing so intense washed over me, as if I hadn't known the touch of another in a thousand years.

I was getting stronger, each wave of pleasure mending what was broken, each shared touch bringing me back to life. I reached out, my fingertip caressing Alawa's breast, feeling a surge of energy, a connection that went beyond mere physical touch, binding us in that intimate moment.

The sensual torture had awoken the darkness in me, but it was apparently part of them as well. Alawa leaned down and bit Enola's thigh, right where she had used the whip. She was rough and aggressive, and her twin writhed in the mix of pleasure and pain.

I licked my lips and my hand found the base of my cock. The purple energy, the dark magic that I had learned to fear, flowed into me. But my hunger for the darkness was different than my hunger for the blue. It was sharper, greedier, I didn't need it as much as I wanted it. It was a part of me, a part of us, a balance that only we could understand.

The twins looked at each other, their eyes filled with understanding and a shared purpose. "We are balance," Alawa whispered, her voice filled with wisdom and mystery. "Some call it Yin and Yang," Enola added, her voice soft and knowing.

Together, they guided me, teaching me to embrace both the light and the darkness within me, to find pleasure in pain, to heal through desire. They were my mentors, my lovers, my guides on a journey that transcended time and space.

In their arms, I found myself. In their pleasure, I found my power. In their love, I found my home. A tantalizing pressure filled my clit, causing it to swell and throb with anticipation. Alawa glanced down between us, her breathing coming faster, her kisses more insistent. I could feel her orgasm brewing, a storm of pleasure on the horizon.

Her energy flowed into me, a connection so profound it was as if our very souls were intertwined. She lowered her mouth to my breast, and sucked my nipple between her teeth. The heady mix of pleasure and pain flowed across me, a dance of sensations that left me gasping.

“Oh!” Alawa pulled off of my breast, her face contorted as if in pain, yet her eyes held a pleasure so intense it was almost torture. I slipped into her mind and, for the first time, I felt welcomed, like she not only wanted me there but she could commune with me as well. It was almost like we were one person, our minds and thoughts somehow melded.

Her ecstasy was my ecstasy. I could feel Enola’s devilish tongue buried in Alawa’s pussy, sliding in and out of her, while the second appendage flicked her mons and the third throbbed inside her asshole.

Her orgasm washed over me like a crashing wave, a tumultuous sea of pleasure that left me breathless. “I’m cumming. Yes, I’m cumming!” Her pleasure reached a crescendo and her orgasm rolled across us.

My engorged cock slid along Alawa’s smooth belly, eager for more, aching for release. My head swam. I moaned and sucked Alawa’s tit into my mouth, the hot flesh of my cock growing longer and thicker.

And then Enola pulled away from her twin's dripping pussy. Her lips were swollen and red, her face glistening with pleasure. “My turn,” she looked down at my rapidly growing cock and licked her lips, this time her tongue was normal.

“I want…” I started to get up but Alawa laid a hand on my chest.

“No, let us heal you first.” She moved back on the bed, trading places with her twin.

Enola's presence was a contrast to her twin's, quieter and less mischievous, her eyes holding a depth of wisdom and maturity. Her long, black hair cascaded down like a dark waterfall, a silken stream that kissed the blankets below. “Master,” she glanced down at the throbbing cock and

smiled. “You are not fully healed.” Her pouty lips touched mine and I fell into her kiss.

She rolled onto her back and spread her knees apart. Alawa sat between her twin’s legs and stared at my cock. “It’s unbelievable.”

My cock was almost fully erect, lying against my belly just under my breasts. I looked around at the blue haze that surrounded us, the energy that restored me.

Enola was impatient. She writhed on her back, her body anxious. She ran her hands around her breasts and then down her belly and sides, until she reached her pussy. Her fingers spread her lips and I saw her twin’s smile. I could smell Enola’s musk. I wanted to taste it. I wanted to dip a finger into her glistening hole and lick her ecstasy from it.

Alawa opened her hands and a length of thick, white rope appeared. With a flick of her wrist, the rope coiled around her twin’s ankles, first one and then the other. She snapped her fingers and rope appeared around Alawa’s wrists as well.

Enola chuckled as the ropes spread her arms and legs wide and held them there.

Then Alawa made a motion like she was lifting something with both hands. The ropes obeyed, each rose to the ceiling and hauled Enola into the air. She looked like she was swinging, held just a few inches above the blanket, but taut and stretched out.

“And now,” Alawa’s eyes narrowed. “Let’s play with the other side.” She looked at me with a cool, devilish grin before a black leather whip appeared in her hand.

She wasted no time. As soon as the whip was in her hand, the leather straps smacked against the inside of Enola’s thigh. The sound was as sharp as the pain. Suddenly, there was a knot in my chest. I felt the darkness.

Enola giggled. “Harder,” she said.

Alawa slapped the other thigh with the whip, this time harder, and a series of little red marks immediately appeared.

“Mmm, just like that,” Enola purred, her voice a sultry melody that sent shivers down my spine.

Alawa leaned forward and raked her tongue along the hot red streaks.

Enola, suspended by her arms and legs, hung her head backward. Her long braid fell like a black waterfall onto the blankets below. “More,” she whispered.

Alawa brought the whip down again, this time on the other thigh. Then she swatted the side of her legs and ass.

I could taste the pain, a bitter-sweet symphony that resonated with the darkness within me. It mixed with the blue haze, the dark energy that had seemingly been given to me. I was as greedy and hungry for it as I was for pleasure. The feeling scared me as much as it thrilled me. I hadn’t felt it since the battle with the centurion. I honestly thought it was gone.

“Who are you two?” I asked, my voice trembling as my cock finished growing, sliding between my breasts, twitching and jerking for attention.

“We are balance,” Alawa ran a line of kisses up her twin’s red, inner thigh, her voice filled with wisdom and mystery.

“Some call it Yin and Yang,” Enola moaned softly and grinned, her eyes reflecting a depth of understanding that went beyond mere words.

“But the darkness…”

“It is a part of you,” Alawa said, reaching up to grab Enola’s breasts. They were smaller than her own, perfect handfuls instead of the firm orbs that jutted out from her own chest.

“But…”

“Oh,” Enola writhed as Alawa grabbed her nipples and pinched. A slender ribbon of purple energy connected their bodies, a mystical bond that seemed to pulse with life.

I was caught between fear and fascination, a tug of war within my soul. The sensual torture had awoken a darkness in me, a thrilling yet terrifying force that I now realized was a shared, primal part of all of us. Alawa leaned down and bit Enola’s thigh, right where she had used the whip. She was rough and aggressive, and her twin writhed in the mix of pleasure and pain.

I licked my lips, a newfound hunger awakening within me, and my hand found the base of my cock, guided by a desire I had never known before. The purple energy, the dark magic that I had learned to fear, flowed into me. But my hunger for the darkness was different than my hunger for the blue. It was sharper, greedier, I didn’t need it as much as I wanted it. And I liked watching Enola’s eyes clench shut every time Alawa administered pain.

Alawa looked at me and I slipped into her mind. She loved it, the sweet torture, she loved giving it and watching it work. The darkness thrilled her like it thrilled me. It was power.

She reached up and slapped the top of Enola’s swollen, glistening pussy, the sound a sharp crack in the room, followed by a moan of pleasure. As her hand came away, a bolt of purple energy snaked back and forth over the distance.

I looked at Alawa’s body, taking in her narrow hips, her round, firm breasts, and the peach-sized pussy that hung between her legs, each detail a testament to her raw sensuality. I ran my hand slowly along the length of my cock, knowing instinctively that it was exactly what Alawa needed. With a thought, I gave her one, a big one.

With a thought, I pulled on her clit.

Alawa gasped. She spread her knees and looked down as I transformed her. She leaned back on the bed as her new clit expanded and stretched and thickened. An orgasm shivered through her, and I watched her cum drip down her thigh.

When I was finished, Alawa held it in her hand. “Goddess,” Alawa breathed, her new cock jerking back and forth excitedly. “It feels so good.”

“Fuck me,” Enola pulled against the ropes, her eyes glued to her twin's new toy. “Fuck me,” she ordered, her voice dripping with sultry desire.

A large drop of precum squeezed out of my cock, rolling tantalizingly along the curve of my breast. I couldn’t believe how quickly my strength had returned. I licked my lips and watched Alawa wipe the head of her tool against Enola’s quivering pussy. She rubbed it up and down, and up and down, spreading her twin’s wet lips as she went.

“Stick it in me,” Enola whined, desperation in her voice. “I can’t take it any longer.”

Enola’s pussy stretched as her twin’s member pushed inside of her. She writhed in ecstasy and reached over her wrists to grab the ropes that held her. “Oh, fuck,” she gasped, pleasure and pain mingling in her voice. “It’s too big, but don’t stop.” She spread her legs trying to make room. “Fuck,” she gasped. “Don’t stop. Fuck me.”

“Yes,” Alawa grinned and thrust her hips, pushing more and more of the iron-hard tool inside her twin.

“Don’t stop. Faster,” Enola commanded, spreading her legs. I watched intently, slowly stroking myself, anticipation building as I waited my turn.

Alawa buried herself deeper and deeper into Enola’s cunt, each thrust a deliberate half-inch, accompanied by an erotic moan from her twin, drawing out the pleasure.

I inhaled the mix of energy. Bolts of blue and purple energy, the very essence of our dark magic, surrounded all three of us, crackling with forbidden power. It was like we were caught in an electrical storm with bolts snapping and moving through the clouds of energy.

After a few intense moments, Alawa’s cock was fully buried in her twin, and Enola’s orgasm was a slow, delicious drip onto the bed.

“Give it to me,” I demanded, looking at Alawa who grinned like a demon. She pulled her cock out of her twin’s twat with a satisfying pop and offered it to me.

“Goddess?” She waved the dripping tool in front of me.

I crawled over, animalistic in my desire, and began to lick the hot flesh clean. While I slipped the head of Alawa’s cock between my lips, with a thought, I untied Enola and lowered her to the bed. I wanted both of them, I wanted everything.

The lightning crisscrossed between us, and I lowered my head, swallowing Alawa’s cock as I went. I felt more alive than I had ever felt in 1691. I opened my throat and swallowed more of the throbbing flesh. I could feel her head again, this time pushing her further. She covered my tongue in precum and moaned again.

Suddenly, I felt my pussy being pushed open, a sensation that caught me off guard. I sucked in a breath through my nose as Enola’s hot tongue, long and thick, wriggled into me. The second part of her tongue snaked between my thighs, wrapping around the base of my cock with a strength that resembled firm fingers. I reached down and slowly stroked myself, anticipation building as I yearned to cum.

"Fuck my mouth," I spoke the words into Alawa’s thoughts, and without a second’s hesitation, she reached down, grabbing the back of my head. The storm of energy around us intensified, a physical manifestation of our shared desire and connection.

With a mere thought, I endowed Enola with a cock, begging her to take me from behind. Alawa began to pull her dick to my lips and then slam back down my throat. Her precum oozed in my mouth, our energies mixed in the storm. I was in heaven, ecstatic, lost in a whirlwind of pleasure and sensation.

Enola's hands found my hips, and she began to penetrate me, each thrust deliberate and measured, building the tension. The dick I had endowed her with was enormous, and I could feel my tight, little pussy stretch wide. It hurt, yet nothing could have felt better. I arched my back, sliding Alawa’s cock to my lips as her twin filled me from behind, pleasure and pain mingling in my voice.

I reached into their minds together, a silent plea echoing between us. "Give me your seed," I begged, feeling their response in the very core of my being. I started to suck harder, desperate for Alawa’s cream.

She pumped her cock down my throat over and over again. I could feel the pressure building. I felt every bump, every vein, and curve of her cock. The energy around us intensified. Blue and purple lightning flashed in the cloud of energy like we were in the middle of a hurricane. Bolts of blue and purple energy, the very essence of our dark magic, surrounded all three of us, crackling with forbidden power.

Enola’s heavy cock hammered away at my pussy, each thrust a delicious assault on my senses. My own was drooling pre into a clear pool of liquid on the bed and bouncing up and down every time she drove into my sopping cunt.

“I’m cumming!” Alawa cried, her eyes clamping shut as she pressed my nose to her belly, lost in the throes of pleasure. Bolt after bolt of warm jizz was pumped down my esophagus.

My own orgasm began, a wave of pleasure that started at my feet and moved across me like a shadow, but I let go of my cock, I wanted to wait. I moaned and swallowed as much of Alawa’s bliss as I could before I had to pull off to breathe.

As I did, another stream of cum splattered across my cheek. And then Enola groaned and froze. I felt her cock jerk and a warm, liquid squirted deep inside me. I squeezed my pussy tight around her cock, feeling every pulse as she pumped everything she had into me.

When she pulled out, both girls slipped around to the foot of the bed, their eyes glued to my throbbing cock and the pool of light blue liquid it had expelled.

I wrapped my hand around my girth, teetering on the edge of release. "Come," I commanded, "bask in my glory." The girls crawled forward, their cocks thick but limp, anticipation in their eyes.

Alawa opened her mouth and swallowed the tip of me while Enola's hot mouth sucked and licked the side of my shaft. I moaned, a sound torn from deep within me. I was fuck drunk, my body quivering, my senses overwhelmed. I couldn't take anymore.

The energies the two of them had given me, the orgasms they had filled me with, were all part of a mystical connection that bound us together. I leaned back. My cock pulsed wildly, and my climax began. Cum gushed into Alawa's greedy mouth, a testament to our shared pleasure and connection. She swallowed but not before I filled her mouth, and light blue fluid leaked past her lips.

She pulled her head away, gasping. Cum drooled onto her chest and thighs. But Enola didn't miss a beat. As soon as Alawa backed away, Enola grabbed my throbbing member, her eyes filled with lust, and stroked a stream of light blue across her breasts, a look of pure satisfaction on her face. "More," she demanded, pulling me into her mouth as I gushed again and again, her voice filled with insatiable desire.

Lying in the warm afterglow of our intense lovemaking, Alawa and Enola curled up on either side of me, their bodies a comforting presence. We were still winded, our bodies covered in a thin sheen of sweat, my cum still here and there across both twins. With a thought, I brought my robe onto the bed and covered us. I watched the symbols swirl, glow, and fade across the fabric. I felt so good. Alive and healed.

"She knows so little," Enola said, looking at her twin with a knowing smile.

"She'll never get back if we don't teach her," Alawa replied, sitting up and looking back and forth, concern in her eyes. "Someone has to teach her."

I sat up, my heart pounding with anticipation. "How did you know...are you talking about my time?" I asked, confusion in my voice. It didn't make sense. How could they know that I had been displaced in time? That Toniat had thrown me back hundreds of years?

“We were all together,” Enola explained, her eyes soft, “our minds.”

“Our thoughts were one stream,” Alawa added, running a finger through a drop of my cream. “So, we know all about you now, where you come from, and everything that defines you.” Her voice carried a hint of my time, a subtle echo from the future.

We all laughed, the sound a shared joy that connected us.

It had never occurred to me that it could happen, that sliding into someone’s thoughts also gave them access to yours. “Can everyone do that?” I asked, curiosity in my voice.

Enola looked at me, her eyes filled with wisdom. “What do you mean?”

“When I slip into someone’s thoughts, can they see mine too?” I asked, a hint of vulnerability in my voice.

Alawa chuckled, her laughter warm and inviting. “You were right,” she said to her twin, her eyes twinkling. “She doesn’t know anything.”

“Someone has to teach her,” Enola replied, her voice filled with compassion. “No, only we can do that, because we are similar to you, not the same, but similar.”

“Teach me,” I begged, desperation in my voice. “I have to get home. I need to understand who I am.”

The twins exchanged a knowing glance, their eyes communicating in a silent language I couldn't decipher, a connection that went beyond words.

Then Alawa got up, moving with a grace that accentuated her hourglass figure, the round curves of her ass bouncing with a hypnotic rhythm with every step. She was beautiful, her grace and power captivating,

and I felt a surge of gratitude towards the young warrior who had brought me to them.

When she was on the far side of the room, she turned and gave me a quizzical look. “You do not understand energy,” she said, her voice gentle yet firm, as she waved her hand and a robe materialized around her. It was black with gold symbols, ancient runes of a forgotten language, that moved across the fabric like mine, appearing and disappearing, a secret dance of power.

“I know there is good and evil, light and dark. That…” I began, my voice faltering.

“No,” Alawa interrupted, shaking her head. Then she closed her eyes and lifted her hand.

Without a word of warning, a purple lightning bolt of energy leapt from her palm, a sudden flash that flew across the space between us, time slowing as I realized what was happening. I barely had time to blink before it crashed into my chest and slammed me up against the headboard. It felt like someone had hit me with a tree trunk. I tried to move, but the bolt slithered across my chest and pinned me to the wall. Panic surged through me, a wild fear taking hold as the energy crackled hot and loud across the front of my robe, searing my flesh.

I tried to think of what to do, what she expected me to do. The bolt she controlled grew tendrils of energy, branching out into ten or twelve little bolts that struck across my robe, each one a separate force, all connected to the main energy.

I watched, horrified, my heart pounding in my chest, and then my defenses slipped, a cold fear washing over me. My robe began to smoke. I felt my energy being drawn away, as if Alawa was siphoning it, pulling it from the very core of my being, a sensation both terrifying and intimate. The pain was intense, a fiery brand on my skin, and I clenched my jaw, grabbing the snaking bolt of energy with my bare hands.

The tendrils snapped and cracked, leaving light gray marks along my skin. The pain made me angry, a rage building within me.

“Energy,” Enola whispered in my ear, her voice a soothing balm, “is not just a force; it's your essence, your being. It's what you are made of, and it's yours to control. Embrace it.”

I took a deep, shuddering breath, and tried to focus, to find my center. I summoned my strength, let go of Alawa’s attacking lightning, and sent my own torrent of energy back.

With a graceful movement, she raised her left hand, her eyes fixed on mine, and met my energy with a second bolt, a dance of power and control. The energies collided. Light flickered around the room as the two forces fought, pushing back and forth a few feet in front of Alawa.

Frustration welled within me, a burning desire to strike back, but my energy faltered, my power slipping through my fingers. I tried to slip into Alawa’s mind, but when I did there was nothing but the quiet echo of her laughter. I could feel my energy draining away, being sucked away. The weakness I knew too well. I looked at Enola, my eyes pleading for guidance, a silent cry for help.

“You do not understand energy,” Alawa said again, her voice now stern, as she waved her hand and the bolts retreated. The robe around her was black with gold symbols, ancient runes of a forgotten language, that moved across the fabric, appearing and disappearing, a secret dance of power. “I know there is good and evil, light and dark. That is not enough.”

I gasped for breath, the pain still lingering, a reminder of my ignorance. “Teach me,” I said, my voice a whisper, my eyes filled with determination. “Please teach me. I have to get home.”

The twins looked at each other, a silent conversation passing between them, a connection that spoke of years of understanding, and I felt a pang of longing to be part of that bond.

“You do not understand energy,” Enola said, her voice gentle, echoing her sister's words. “Energy is what you are, it’s what you are made of, it’s yours to control.”

I nodded, my mind reeling, trying to grasp the concept. “I want to learn. I want to understand.”

Both of them were beautiful, their grace and power captivating, and I felt a surge of gratitude towards the young warrior who had brought me to them. They were shimobe, ancient servants of the creators, bound by destiny and magic, and they were offering to teach me.

“We will teach you,” Alawa said, her voice filled with resolve. “But it will not be easy. You must be willing to face your fears, to embrace your power, to become what you were meant to be.”

I looked at them, my heart filled with hope and fear, excitement and trepidation. “I am ready,” I said, my voice steady. “I will do whatever it takes.”

They nodded, a shared understanding passing between them, and I knew that my journey was just beginning. A journey of discovery, of power, of becoming who I was meant to be.

I was ready to learn, ready to grow, ready to become the goddess I was destined to be. The path ahead was uncertain, filled with challenges and dangers, but I was not alone. I had found guides, mentors, friends.

I had found my way home.

“Draw from me,” she said, spreading her arms wide as if about to embrace me. “Use me.” I didn’t know what she meant. Her twins' attack sucked more of my life force away. “How?” I yelled over the sound of our fight. “Here,” Enola took my hand and put it on her chest, squarely between her naked breasts. “Draw from me.” Like she was my worshipper, Enola’s energy flowed into me. I closed my eyes, relishing the warmth that spread through me like a gentle caress. It felt like it moved through every vein and

vessel. I closed my eyes and let it rush into me. My attack grew stronger and pushed against Alawa’s.

And then I felt it. Somewhere in the back of my mind, the darkness awoke. I concentrated and drew more from Enola. My skin healed. I opened my hand and attacked Alawa again, sending another deep blue bolt of energy against her own. The powers sizzled in the air between us, a crackling dance of energy that vibrated with intensity. A warm satisfaction rolled over me, a heady blend of power and desire. My cock thickened with excitement, the physical manifestation of my growing confidence and dominance.

I concentrated, pushing Alawa's attack back little by little, a battle of wills and desires, until my energy snapped against the black fabric of her robe. I liked it. I liked the idea of beating her. I wanted to beat her, defeat her where she stood. I drew more energy from Enola.

“Enough!” Enola's shout broke through my concentration, severing the coupling between us. But I wasn't finished yet. I raised my hand, and a bolt of energy snapped to life, connecting us again. Enola's eyes met mine, a stern warning in her gaze. I didn't care. A newfound arrogance surged within me. I was a goddess, and this was my domain, my power, my mystery.

But there was a part of me that recognized what was happening, a whisper of caution in the back of my mind. I knew this darkness, this power-hungry craving, and it terrified me even as it thrilled me. Enola tried to separate us, and in an instant, I threw her against the wall. I held up my hand and continued to pull her life force away. She looked at me angrily, but I couldn't stop. The darkness wouldn't let me. I wanted more of her energy; it was different, slightly less powerful than any worshipper I had had, but it was also somehow purer.

Enola's laugh rang out, cold and mocking, a chilling sound that lingered in the air. And in a blink, the twins were side by side. Alawa attacked again. This time two bolts of energy raced toward me and then disappeared into the ground at my feet. “Missed,” I taunted, taking a deep

breath, ready to strike back when the floor began to vibrate ominously. I looked down at my feet just as the floor began to move and bend. Something pushed up from underneath. Memories of Cecilia and Julia flashed through my mind, along with the sinister vines that Toniat had used. Fear raced through me. Were Alawa and Enola like Toniat? Were they evil?

The vines raced up from my ankles, coiling around me like serpents ready to strike. I looked up at the twins, Alawa's focus unwavering as she manipulated the vines, her energy a tangible force of control. Enola stood next to her, cuddled against her twin and watching me. Her hand slid into her twin's robe. Blue energy wafted up from both of them. Enola's smile was wicked as she squeezed her twin's breast, her touch deliberate and sensual, a provocative act that fueled their combined power.

I could feel Alawa's energy increase. Two vines separated from my thighs and grabbed my wrists. Enola was helping her, giving her more power. The vines tightened around me, their sinuous grip cold and unyielding, a living restraint that sent shivers down my spine. Alawa lifted her arms, and the vines lifted me into the air. I felt like I was crowd surfing. I was staring at the ceiling. The vines continued to grow and slither around me. My legs and arms were completely wrapped in them.

“You have so much to learn,” she smiled, her eyes twinkling with mischief as she mimicked the parlance of the future. “Sleep,” Enola whispered, her hand gliding across my forehead, a wave of calm washing over me. “Sleep.”

When I woke up, we were somewhere else. Somewhere I didn't know. The bed and I had been set in a small clearing in the middle of a dark forest. I looked around, my heart pounding, the silence of the dark forest closing in on me. The twins were nowhere to be found. I looked around.

The clearing, hemmed in by towering oaks and maples, was just big enough to accommodate the bed. Everywhere else were massive trees and large flowering bushes, their names eluding me. The gray sky was almost completely hidden, leaving me to wonder if they had abandoned me. But something deep within told me otherwise.

I stepped out of the bed, and it vanished immediately. I almost called out for them, a cry of desperation on my lips, but something deep within stopped me. This was a test, part of my training. I examined my surroundings closely, my mind racing. What were they trying to teach me?

I took a breath, steadying myself. Alright, this is training. I'm going to learn how to use my powers. How do I do this? I took a cautious step in that direction, my eyes straining, but the dense underbrush concealed whatever had moved. Its form eluded my sight, but a tingling sensation told me it was there, watching.

A shadow. I caught the smudge of darkness out of the corner of my eye. It darted between the trees to my left, tall and elusive. I couldn't discern its form, but those glowing eyes, level with my shoulders, hinted at something massive and predatory.

I stared at it, a mixture of awe and terror gripping me, uncertain of what it was or how to respond. I could feel my face blanch, the blood draining as terror took hold. And then it stepped from the forest, its head as big as a summer watermelon, a colossal feline with deep black fur, its size and menace surpassing any panther I had ever seen.

I was a goddess, not a mere mortal lost in the woods. "Enough," I commanded, my voice resonating with newfound authority. "I am your master." But the feline wasn't intimidated. It kept slowly walking around me, like it was measuring what I was capable of, looking for a weakness.

Without conscious thought, I blinked, and suddenly I was ten or twenty yards away in the woods, my heart pounding in my ears. Both cats stood in front of me, their growls a menacing symphony, until the first one leapt, a blur of power and grace.

My eyes darted desperately, searching for refuge, but the forest offered no sanctuary, only a labyrinth of trees and shadows. Finally, I stopped, my breath ragged, my mind racing. I needed a new plan. Both cats approached, their movements deliberate and predatory.

The absence of the twins' familiar presence left a void, a chilling uncertainty. If this was their doing, they had concealed themselves masterfully, leaving me to face the unknown alone. I looked around desperately, the forest's shadows closing in, the rustle of leaves and distant growls my only companions. There was no safe place, only an endless maze of trees.

I stared at them, a whirlwind of emotions churning within me. Was this Alawa and Enola's doing, or was this test something more sinister, something beyond their control? Both cats stood in front of me growling until the first one leapt toward me.

I moved, blinking myself further away, but each move drained me, the exhaustion creeping into my limbs. The felines adjusted and came after me no matter where I went. Finally, I stopped. I needed a new plan. Both approached. I tried to calm myself and think of what to do.

The jungle cats loomed before me, their size and ferocity sending a chill down my spine. Both growled and snapped, their teeth a terrifying blur of white death. I tried not to flinch, but they were so big.

“That’s quite enough, you two.” Enola walked up to where the three of us were facing off as nonchalantly as if she had just stumbled onto a gaggle of goslings.

As soon as the cats looked at her, they shifted. I use the term 'shifted' because words fail to capture the surreal transformation that unfolded before my eyes. It took half a breath. One minute they were two, massive, jungle cats, and then they simply changed form, it looked like they were made of liquid for a second, and then they were standing on either side of Enola.

I looked back and forth between the two. They weren’t human, that much I knew, but they weren’t exactly cat either, they had simply retained some of the cat’s features. Each of them sported breasts, modestly concealed by a deep blue ribbon of cloth that resembled a tube top, adding a touch of human femininity. Around their waists was a similar wrap. But that was where the congruity with humans ended. Each had a pair of furry cat

ears on the top of their head, each retained the long, hairy tail. Their noses were a mix. The muzzle was gone, but instead of a nose like ours, theirs was a cat nose.

I had never encountered beings like these before, and the novelty of their existence sent a thrilling shiver through me.

“We weren’t going to hurt you, dear goddess,” the smaller Neko purred, her dark brown eyes twinkling with mischief as she smiled.

“You said to keep an eye on her,” the one with black hair and fur rubbed her cheek against Enola’s shoulder, like a house cat does when it wants attention.

“Goddess, please excuse and allow me to introduce, Brigitte and Kimagure.” Both girls stepped over to me, their tails swinging, and offered me their hands. “Sorry we scared you,” Kimagure said, shy and slightly ashamed.

“Are you a real goddess?” Brigitte leaned in close, her brown hair releasing a scent of wildflowers as she studied me.

“Yes,” I said, happy that they weren’t about to kill me anymore, “I am Emma.” I shook their hands. “What are you exactly?” I glanced at Kimagure’s ears and Brigitte’s tail.

“Neko!” Kimagure laughed.

“They were created by Marduk, here, in this realm.” She waved her hand around, and I realized that the forest was not on earth. We were somewhere else, somewhere like the temple where Enele had taken me when I freed her, or like my temple far in the future.

Alawa appeared beside her twin and smiled when she saw me. “Oh, good, you’re awake.”

Kimagure moved to Alawa’s side. I watched as the Neko rubbed up against her.

“I see you’ve met the girls,” Alawa reached up and rubbed behind Kimagure’s ears. “Aren’t they lovely?”

“You scared the living daylights out of her,” Enola chided, her eyes narrowing at the Neko.

“They were more than fine,” I assured, smiling at Brigitte. “They’re truly amazing.”

Brigitte’s tail slipped around my waist, it was so long and soft. “Thank you,” she grinned.

“Where is this place?” I inquired, my voice a mixture of awe and curiosity, echoing the novel's consistent tone of wonder and exploration.

“Another dimension,” Enola explained, her eyes twinkling with ancient knowledge. “A realm where magic and reality intertwine, where beings like us reside.”

“It’s where we live until someone needs us,” Alawa laughed.

“Walk with us?” Enola invited, leading the way through the mystical forest, her voice guiding me into the heart of their world. “While you slept, Alawa and I discussed your situation,” Enola said, her long blue robe brushing the ground. Behind her, a trail of delicate blue flowers sprouted in the grass, as if paying homage to her presence.

“Can you help me get home?” I watched Kimagure’s tail slip around Alawa’s back.

“We cannot get you home,” Alawa confessed slowly, her voice breaking, allowing the gravity of the statement to sink in.

“But we can help you when you get there.” Enola said. The trees began to thin a bit, and I saw a beautiful lake off to our left. It was surrounded by meadows of tall, green grass.

“How? What do you mean?” I was confused.

“Time,” Alawa stopped and looked at me, “you have a long way to go, but because Cecilia was from your time, we are tethered there. We can reach you. Think of her life like a mile marker on a highway” She made a motion like she was reaching for something far away.

“But to reach there,” Enola sighed, her eyes filled with wisdom, “you must not only master your powers but also remember the very core of why you wish to return.”

Anger boiled in my chest as I thought of Toniat, our last meeting, and how easily she had disposed of me. “Revenge,” I hissed, the word heavy with the weight of betrayal and loss, resonating with the novel's recurring theme of vengeance.

“It should be more than that,” Alawa said, her eyes narrowing as she studied me, a curious tilt to her head. “You are not darkness.”

“What about Kim, Julia, Cecilia, and all those you hold dear?” Enola asked, her voice soft, her hand gently caressing Brigitte's head as the Neko circled her, tail swishing in playful delight.

I swallowed my anger, feeling it quench like a flame doused by Enola's words, replaced by a sudden clarity. I thought of Kim. I missed her. With everything that had happened, I had lost track of that feeling. It had been buried under everything else, everything I was going through. They were right, all I wanted was revenge, I had lost focus, and I had forgotten my purpose.

“So,” Alawa gave me a little grin, “we are going to teach you a few things.” We walked out into the clearing by the lake. The water lay still as glass, mirroring the gray, streaking clouds, a perfect reflection of the sky's

moody canvas. The prairie was ankle deep, green, and lush. And the air smelled like spring.

“You think that there is good energy and bad,” Alawa said, exchanging a knowing glance with her twin, her voice a blend of wisdom and gentle reprimand. “And you’re not completely wrong.” Kimagure slipped into her cat form and ran after Brigitte who had done the same.

“But you are the one that colors the energy.” Enola opened her hand and a sphere of white light appeared. It was about a foot around and pure.

I watched, my mind a whirl of questions and anticipation. I didn’t understand exactly what they meant, but I was eager to learn.

“Anger,” Enola intoned, and the sphere morphed from pure white to an ominous black. “Happiness,” she continued, and the sphere reverted to its pristine whiteness.

“Then what was the…” I began, but Enola interrupted.

“The energy that left you?” she asked, closing her hand, and the sphere vanished, leaving a faint trail of luminescence that danced in the air. “It was dark energy, your power manifested.”

“But how?” I was confused, my mind grappling with the complexity of what they were teaching me. How did my dark energy possess Imyne?

Alawa watched the Neko run along the shores of the lake, chasing each other. “Hester’s spell,” she said without emotion.

“Her magic acts like a leech, siphoning off your energy,” Enola explained, her voice tinged with caution.

“But how did I?” I stammered, still struggling to comprehend.

“You didn’t. Hester is more powerful than you think,” Alawa said slowly, letting the words sink in, her eyes fixed on mine, assessing my

reaction. “She has minions, demons that she commands. There was one with you at the inn. And it took your darkness and climbed into Imyne.”

It all made sense, but it seemed impossible. Of course, the moment I thought that, I remembered that I was a goddess standing in another dimension with demi-gods and their cat-people pets. Nothing is impossible.

“So, I am the architect of my own darkness?” I asked, a realization dawning within me.

“Your anger and despair color your energy, yes,” Enola affirmed, her voice resonating with the novel's theme of self-discovery and control.

“But dark energy is not solely for dark purposes,” Alawa chuckled, her eyes glinting with mischief. “Remember the little whip? The pleasure it brought?”

“And now, we will teach you to control your power,” Enola declared, gracefully floating into the air, her legs crossed, her eyes alight with purpose as she commenced my lessons.

My lessons stretched on, timeless in the dimension where the twins resided, a place where mundane needs like sleep or food were irrelevant. Some of the lessons were historical, about the elder gods or the creators. Others were practical, how to manipulate objects in nature, how to mold them to your purpose. This went on for I don’t know how long, days, maybe weeks. Being what we were, we only had to stop when I was too weak to go on.

But even that had become a lesson. Every time I began to falter, the twins would launch an assault, forcing me to dig deep, to defend myself, and to discover reservoirs of strength I never knew I possessed. It was a brutal but effective way to teach me my limits and how to push past them. It was like a return to my college days, a relentless pursuit of knowledge and mastery, but on a cosmic scale.

The three of us stood there spread out along the sandy shore of the crystal clear lake. Enola stood in front of me with Alawa behind. “You will draw energy from me and pass it onto Alawa,” Enola instructed, her voice firm yet encouraging, guiding me through the complex exercise.

I concentrated. The idea was simple, we had been practicing for days, but it wasn’t as easy as it sounded, especially because Enola guarded her energy and while I did my best to find a weakness, her twin attacked my mind in an effort to stop me.

Enola maintained an aura of serene calm, her face tranquil even as I openly attacked her, a picture of unshakable composure.

Meanwhile, Alawa struck at my mind and tried to steal my energy. They were the perfect pair of teachers. Challenging, to say the least.

It felt like a return to my college days, a relentless pursuit of knowledge and mastery, but on a cosmic scale. Some of the lessons were historical, lessons about the elder gods or the creators. Others were simple, how to manipulate objects in nature, how to mold them to your purpose. This went on for I don’t know how long, days, maybe weeks. Being what we were, we only had to stop when I was too weak to go on.

It felt like a return to my college days, a relentless pursuit of knowledge and mastery, but on a cosmic scale. Some of the lessons were historical, lessons about the elder gods or the creators. Others were simple, how to manipulate objects in nature, how to mold them to your purpose. This went on for an indeterminate amount of time, perhaps days or even weeks.

Once, as I stood on the edge of the lake, having just finished a mind battle with Alawa, I had grown frustrated. Frustration gnawed at me, darkening my energy, yet it still had no effect on Alawa, her composure unshaken. I struggled to slip into her mind or attack her outright, my efforts thwarted at every turn.

“You must focus everything you have left,” Alawa had winked at me. (It was her new favorite thing from my time, winking. She thought it

was extremely sexy.)

“It’s not always wise,” Enola had cautioned.

“It will leave you weak. It may be your last attack, but sometimes, you can’t stop. It’s best if you have someone nearby.”

“But sometimes it is the only way.” Enola had said.

“Concentrate,” Alawa sat down in the grass and crossed her legs.

I remember closing my eyes, focusing my energy, and drying the lake with the last bit of strength I possessed. Alawa and Enola had both laughed as I collapsed into the grass, drained and exhausted.

“She dried up the lake!” Alawa exclaimed, rolling over in laughter.

“Yes, she did,” Enola had chuckled. “You are stronger than you look sometimes.”

And after the lessons that left me with nothing left to give, the twins and I would play.

I remember a particular exercise where I had drawn mystical energy from the lake, a source of ancient power in this otherworldly realm, and surrounded it with mountains that pierced the clouds. I sat down in the grass with the twins and their Neko. The effort had left me exhausted and weak. I put my hand to the earth and pulled a bit of energy. “Take from me,” Alawa’s robe fell open slightly.

I caught a glimpse of the alluring curves of her cleavage, igniting an acute hunger within me. I raised my hand and her robe disappeared. The end of training had always been my favorite. My hunger, both physical and carnal, was always sated by them, a ritualistic feast that bound us together. My cock immediately began to lengthen under my robe in anticipation.

Kimagure nuzzled against Alawa and the first wisps of blue energy began to rise off the tips of her furry ears. “Perhaps you should partake first,” Enola looked at her twin with a mischievous grin.

Alawa ran a finger along Kimagure’s shoulder then down to the blue ribbon that hid her Neko’s breasts. “Really?” Alawa looked at me like she

needed permission.

I nodded.

Alawa's finger slipped past the fabric's edge.

Kimagure looked at me and purred as the fabric came loose and her large, round breasts fell into the open. Without a word, she reached down and loosened the fabric around her waist.

I stared down at the glistening mound between her thighs, my cock twitching in eager anticipation. Enola sat down beside me and kissed me passionately. I surrendered to her kiss, losing myself in the stream of energy that flowed between us, a dance of passion and power.

Brigitte reached into my robe and pulled my throbbing member free and began to slowly stroke it. I inhaled the mix of energies around me. Every nerve in my body tingled.

My tongue met Enola's and I felt warmth, joy, and happiness. My hands held her face as we kissed. My pussy ached to be touched, and the moment I thought of it, Enola's hands slipped between my thighs and into my hungry snatch.

I loved how our minds worked together, how all three of us communed in one headspace when we were together. I moaned softly as our tongues danced and probed.

I glanced over, catching sight of Kimagure lavishing attention on Alawa, mirroring the pleasure Brigitte bestowed upon me, each movement deliberate and synchronized.

I reached out, my fingers tracing a path down through Enola's moist pussy lips, then gliding back to her mons, each touch a spark of pleasure. She moaned into my mouth, and I circled her clitoris until it was totally erect.

Warm breath washed across my erection, and then Brigitte's mouth was around my tip. I squeezed my nipples hard, and then reached down and put my hand on the back of Brigitte's head. I groaned as she swallowed my length.

I kissed Enola hard, aggressively, and she returned my ardor. Then I felt another rough little tongue along my shaft. I looked down, and Kimagure had joined Brigitte while Alawa entered her from behind.

Alawa's face was pure ecstasy as she slowly began to inch her way into Kimagure's swollen pussy.

I moaned and cried out, urging Brigitte to devour me with a fervor that matched my own.

She swallowed me into the back of her throat, and I began to face fuck her mouth.

Enola leant down and sucked my hard nipple into her mouth, and I slipped two fingers into her slit. "More," she moaned, and I put another finger inside and then curled them upward, stretching her wide and eliciting another long moan.

Brigitte's mouth sucked harder, and I watched as Alawa gave Kimagure everything she had.

And then I fell into a bottomless pool of ecstasy. The orgasm started in my pussy and radiated up to my cock. Warmth and energy surged through my genitals. The storm cloud of energy enveloped all of us. It felt like a star was exploding inside of me.

Waves of pleasure ran through me. My seed flooded Brigitte's mouth, and when she pulled away, another stream of light blue fell across my breasts and Enola's thighs. I arched my back at the same time that Alawa did. I added another finger into Enola, stretching her wide, and she joined us in a symphony of orgasmic bliss.

When the ecstasy finally subsided, we all collapsed into a tangled heap – the twins and their Nekos intertwined around me. We fell asleep then, not because we needed to but because it felt good.

But when I awoke, I was no longer on their plane. I was back in the hut. The little fire the girls had built was dead and cold. I stepped and saw nothing but the sun setting across the marshlands. I was engulfed in

confusion. Had everything that just transpired been merely a dream, a fleeting illusion? Had I been in a coma?

And then I felt it. Hester's call. As it had always done, the call resonated within me, tugging at the very core of my soul, an unbreakable bond that guided my destiny. It had to be why I was back on earth. I stood and pulled my robe tight. I had no idea how long I had been gone, and it didn't really matter.

I was not the goddess that I had been. No, now I was more. I was stronger, smarter, and ready to find a way back home.

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*12 Treachery

I inhaled deeply, Hester’s call weaving through the air like tendrils of smoke, beckoning and elusive, a seductive whisper that caressed my body and mind, a mix of temptation that I could not resist. And I wanted to answer it, except I was suddenly afraid, a question that gnawed at me, it was trust and betrayal that left me both intrigued and wary. I don’t know where it came from. It hit me all at once. I was back. Standing along the shore, watching the waves against a grey sky, the rhythmic dance of the sea mirroring my own turbulent emotions, a sensual ebb and flow that pulled at me. I tried to gather myself, a sensation that was both disorienting and exhilarating. A disorienting sense of lost time gnawed at me, leaving me adrift and uncertain of how long I had been gone. I surveyed the landscape, noting the autumnal hues, the rich colors painting a tapestry that mirrored my own transformation, a the wheel of life and decay.

A languid wave crashed nearby, its foamy fingers caressing my feet, a sensual touch that sent a shiver up my spine, a lust for power that was both intoxicating and alarming. I sensed Hester’s call again, a haunting melody that seemed to resonate in my very soul, a siren's song that pulled at my core. I turned my head, straining to listen, drawn towards its source. I took a breath and realized what lay ahead of me. Home. A place now foreign yet achingly familiar, a world of contrasts that mirrored my own duality, a connection between my past and present. I wanted nothing else to matter, but there was still a great deal to attend to here. I had left my mark on this place, a sensual ripple in the fabric of its existence that could not be undone, a seductive echo of my power and desire.

I had saved Catherine’s life, our connection immediate and profound. I had bonded with Hester, a relationship complex and enigmatic, only to have her steal the very darkness within me, a betrayal that stung and intrigued. I didn’t know if Hester was my enemy. I didn’t think either of us

understood what was happening. And besides, I needed her followers, her coven of witches. I needed their power, and I had made a deal with Hester, a pact sealed with a kiss, a promise that bound us in a game of power and desire.

I promised her an appearance, and she had promised me a coven of witches – enough energy to get home. The notion of having worshippers, souls devoted to me, sent a thrilling shiver down my spine, a realization that stopped me in my tracks, a game that I was now a player in. The idea of enough power to bridge points in time made me shiver with excitement. And my time with the twins had taught me how to get home, the problem was the amount of energy I was going to need.

Then Toniat. My fists clenched instinctively. All of it. Everything I had been through up until now, this strange town, the dark energy, everything, it all led back to Toniat. I could see Toniat's face, her eyes ablaze with a power that resonated with the very fabric of this world, a force that beckoned and challenged me, the tightrope of dominance and submission. I knew I could defeat her, even siphon the energy from her own worshippers if I so desired, a moral dilemma that both excited and troubled me, some weird web of right and wrong that I was now entangled in. I could burn her world to the ground, reducing it to ashes. The only obstacle was finding my way back, a challenge that loomed large in my mind.

The ideas galloped across my mind. I realized that I could harness the energy from the entire town, a wellspring of power waiting to be tapped, a feast of energy that I could taste, savor, and consume. I could draw the energy out, a slow and deliberate extraction that would leave this place barren and lifeless. The darkness inside of me stirred to life. Destruction, a dark mirror reflecting the other facets of life and love, a balance that I was now beginning to understand.

I thought of Hester’s promise, a coven of seven or eight worshippers, their faces etched with devotion, their bodies a canvas for my pleasure and power, a symphony of sensations that I could orchestrate with a mere thought. A hunger stirred within me, a craving for power and control that was both exhilarating and terrifying. But I took a breath and balanced

myself. I understood the power now. Enele had left me with so many questions and finally, I felt like I had at least a few of the answers I had been looking for. I was the embodiment of love, a goddess who wielded desire, lust, pleasure, and pain as her tools, a symphony of sensations that I could orchestrate with a mere thought. Enele hadn’t told me everything. Hadn’t had time to explain all that we were.

How does a person explain their whole life in a day? I recalled the intoxicating warmth of her skin, the heady scent that lingered in the room after our first shared climax. My body hummed, and I closed my eyes. I felt weak and famished, as though the journey had drained me of both energy and sustenance. Memories of the twins flooded my mind, their smiling faces a beacon of warmth and comfort in a world filled with uncertainty and danger.

But how long had I been gone? Doubts gnawed at me, focusing on Hester. Was she truly to blame, or was my mind playing tricks, seeking someone to hold responsible? A nagging doubt crept into my mind: Was Hester truly to blame, or was I merely seeking a scapegoat? The charred remains of Catherine's and Imyne's homes stood like haunting skeletons, a grim testament to the devastation. With a single stride, the world shifted, and in the blink of an eye, I found myself transported to the edge of the Jesop farm, a place once brimming with life but now scarred by recent events.

The destruction stood as a stark reminder of the unleashed power, a sensual testament to the consequences that had rippled through our lives. The air hung heavy with the scent of burnt wood, and a lingering darkness clung to the soil, a tangible presence that spoke of loss and transformation. It felt cold, deep in my soul.

The once-sturdy structures lay in ruin, reduced to mere skeletons, their haunting remnants whispering tales of loss and transformation. Next door, the Winthrop place lay in ruin, reduced to a dirt patch and a heap of stone from the collapsed chimney, a silent witness to the chaos. The scorched earth bore witness to my absence, the grass yet to reclaim the land

from the ravages of the fires. I recalled the way Hester's magic had bound us, a fusion of energies that lingered on my skin like a lover's caress.

My mind drifted back to Hester's magic, a fusion of energies that still lingered on my skin, a sensual reminder of our shared experience. Catherine shook her head, her eyes downcast, revealing a vulnerability that tugged at my heart, a glimpse into her inner turmoil. “He knows we don’t have it. He wants to put me in debtor’s prison, and for you,” Hester looked at her friend with fear in her eyes, “he has other, more sinister plans.”

A wave of relief washed over me as I approached them, their somber faces clashing with the joy bubbling within my heart, a complex dance of emotions that resonated deep within me. I reached out, gently probing Catherine's thoughts, embarking on a sensual exploration that was both intimate and tantalizing, a dance of minds that left me breathless. Over the time I had been gone, Tucker and his men had tightened their grip on the town, a stranglehold that suffocated hope and bred fear.

A memory flashed before me, Tucker's face leering, his smile twisted. “Something more creative.” The threat was palpable, and it made me angry, a dance of rage and resolve that filled me with a determination that was both empowering and intoxicating.

Hester spun around, her hair whipping out into a wide fan, her eyes wide with surprise and joy, a connection that was both physical and spiritual. “You’re here!” She leapt to her feet and wrapped her arms around me, her body trembling with emotion.

I knew I couldn't trust them fully, but I also realized I didn't have to fear them. “I am,” I laughed, holding Hester tightly, feeling the connection between us.

Catherine stood and joined our embrace, her face glowing with relief. A current of energy surged between the three of us, a tangible connection that bound us together, a symphony of sensations that I could feel in every part of my being.

I took a step back, drinking in the sight of the two of them, their faces glowing with trust and determination. Catherine's smile was radiant, a spark in her eyes signaling her restored faith in me. “You were right,” she said softly, touching Hester's arm. “I should have never doubted you.” Then she turned toward me and dropped to her knees. “Or you, Goddess.”

As I stood there, I felt a newfound strength coursing through me. Hester wiped the tears from her eyes and dropped to her knees beside Catherine. “We are your servants,” she declared, her voice trembling with reverence.

The energy danced around us like the northern lights, a mesmerizing symphony of color and light. Their faith and devotion surged through me, a heady blend of power, love, and connection that filled me with a desire and resolve that was both intoxicating and empowering. Deep within me, something profound stirred, awakening a connection that transcended mere devotion, resonating with the very essence of who I was. I reached out and gently lifted them to their feet. "Rise, my friends," I said softly, my voice filled with warmth. "We are in this together. You are not my servants; you are my allies, my companions on this journey."

I opened my eyes and saw the energy sizzle and crackle around Hester. The purple lightning crackled, a vivid display of her magic, unique and mysterious. I thought back to the twins and their ominous warning, a prophecy that now seemed all too real. I looked down, fascinated by the black ink of her dark magic as it moved through the veins of her fingers, a manifestation of her complex soul. I held out my hand, palm open, a willing vessel ready to receive her energy, to understand her darkness.

She sat up and looked into my eyes. A little smile traced her lips, and her eyes glittered. Catherine, her eyes wide with curiosity and excitement, sat up and looked back and forth between us. “Can you feel it?” Hester asked Catherine. “Yes,” Catherine laughed, and the energy moved around us like fog. Hester’s magic struck my palm like angry lightning, a sensation I drank in as if quenching a thirst that had tormented me for weeks in the desert. I closed my eyes, a newfound clarity washing over me, illuminating the path I had to take. Hester would gather the women, her

coven of witches would give me the vitality I needed, the energy I would have to have to bridge so much time. The idea burned through me. A group of adherents, a room full of supplication, a collective energy that could be harnessed for a greater purpose.

Questions swirled in my mind, and I slipped into Hester’s thoughts, asking silently, “A fortnight?” Her eyes flashed when she heard me. 'I want you,' she thought, arching her back in front of me, her breasts pressing against the fabric of her dress. Through the thin fabric of her dress, the outline of her nipples was tantalizingly visible. My heart sped. My desire for her was matched only by my longing for them both, a complex web of emotions that I was only beginning to understand.

I looked down at Catherine, her smile radiant, her soul resonating with the harmony of our united spirits, a bond that went beyond mere friendship. I extended a hand to each of them, my eyes inviting them to join me on this journey, a silent promise of what lay ahead. “Come with me,” I whispered, my voice dripping with promise. And I swept us away, leaving behind the charred remnants of what was once a thriving village, now a desolate landscape of burned grass and skeletal houses. This was where it had begun. This was where Hester and I had saved Catherine, and, in effect, Hester had kind of saved me.

I reflected on my former self, marveling at how far I had come, how the weakness of the past had transformed into strength. I thought back to that pivotal moment, Catherine suspended between life and death, a delicate balance maintained by my limited energy and Hester's potent magic. I envisioned her naked form, her nipples standing defiantly, her labia teasingly visible from the delicate folds of her warmth. And Catherine. I looked down at her body. I had been her visage, taken on her form in Tucker’s fantasy. Now, I would taste her. The moment Hester had looked at me with cold determination. “Take my strength,” she had said. I remembered her words. “Goddess of earth, part my soul…” And then we had shared all that we were, all I had left. The memory was vivid, a connection that transcended the physical, a bond forged in trust and desire.

"When the two of them touched my hand, we were transported, standing in the center of my own creation. A room conjured from the void, a

replica of the room where I had awakened with Enele, every detail a testament to my power and memory. The room I had spent days exploring pleasure in. Throughout everything, that room had always been a touchstone for me. Every time I thought of it, it gave me strength, reminded me of what I was and why I was here. It was the place I had evolved, been given this great gift.

Catherine's disbelief was palpable. Her mouth opened in a silent scream, a mixture of awe and terror frozen on her face. Hester let go of my hand and ran toward the massive feather bed covered in quilts and pillows. She climbed onto it and jumped up and down, her joy unbridled, like a child discovering a playground for the first time. I watched as strands of her black hair escaped from her bonnet, their silkiness catching the light, a fragrance of wildflowers adding to her youthful charm, as if nature itself was part of her allure.

In the world I once knew, she would have been a supermodel, her grace and beauty gracing the runways of Paris. But here, in this harsh time, she faced a fate of being locked in the stocks, left to the mercy of the unforgiving sun.

It was so odd. Looking back and forth between Catherine and Hester. The one stood in a state of utter shock, almost unable to move while the other simply accepted the reality and took it as a gift.

I laughed, a sound of pure joy, as I watched Catherine's eyes dart around the room, her mind struggling to comprehend our otherworldly surroundings. “Where are we?” She wasn’t afraid, but she was unsure of what was happening. She looked at Hester. “You had proclaimed her power, but I doubted every word.” She looked back at me and fell to her knees. “I am your servant, Goddess.”

I laughed. “Rise,” I took her hand as she stood, “I want nothing but your love.” I leaned forward and touched her lips with mine.

She kissed me, first slowly. Our lips touched and then parted. Then she leaned forward and kissed me again. This time with a little more

pressure, like she was waking up from what she thought was a dream, but I was still there. Then again, this time with more urgency.

I slipped my arms around her slender waist, pulling her close, feeling the warmth of her body against mine. My gaze drifted to where Hester sat on the bed, her eyes sparkling with mischief and anticipation. Her bonnet lay discarded on the floor, her black hair cascading down to her shoulders in loose, wild strands, a symbol of her unleashed desire.

Caroline moaned into my mouth as I slipped my tongue between her lips. Her body was supple and graceful, her thin frame tall and slight, a delicate sculpture of femininity. I could feel her ribs as I held her in my arms and she kissed me, giddy with the energy that moved between us.

Hester stood up and stepped out of the knee-length cotton underwear. She kicked the pile of fabric away from her feet and stood up straight and proud, displaying her exquisite body. I craved the fire and thunder of our union, a tempestuous storm of passion and power that roared within us. With a mere thought, a ripple of magic, my robe vanished into thin air.

Catherine's hands fell away as she stepped back, her eyes wide with shock and wonder at the sudden transformation before her. She took me in, the naked goddess in front of her. I could feel the heat of her desire, a flame ignited by our kisses, a promise of passions yet to be explored. Her eyes wandered across me, and then her eyes fell on my gift.

My cock began to rise, slowly lengthening and thickening under her fascinated gaze, a physical manifestation of my arousal, a throbbing pulse that echoed the beat of my heart. There was a mix of fear and curiosity across her face. I gently probed her thoughts, allowing myself to slip into the labyrinth of her mind, seeking to understand her fascination and fear.

It took a moment, but I found her memories of sex. They were not like Aria’s. Unlike Aria, Caroline's background was humble; she was not the daughter of a wealthy European. Instead, she was the daughter of a shipwright she had never met and a whore who had retired when a wealthy

lover left her just enough money to drink herself to death when Caroline was twelve.

The tavern owner adopted her then, and she became a sort of slave mistress to the old man who had almost as much trouble with alcohol as her mother had. Her memories revealed harsh and ungentle stories, a stark and painful contrast to the world I had once known. I felt a pang of empathy, a connection to her struggles, a shared understanding of pain and longing.

In the depths of Caroline's thoughts, I heard a whisper of awe, 'She’s even more beautiful than Hester described.' Hester walked up behind her friend, reached her hand under the long red curls, and began to work the buttons of the dress. “Oh, Hester, she…” Caroline didn’t stop staring at me.

I cupped my full breasts, rolling a fingertip across the aroused nipples, savoring the sensation of the hardened skin against my touch. “She’s amazing, isn’t she?” Hester looked me in the eye while she kissed Caroline’s slender neck.

I watched as Hester's lips traced the delicate curve of Caroline's neck, her hands skilfully unfastening the dress. The fabric slid down Caroline's body, revealing her in all her vulnerability and beauty. The room was filled with the sound of our breathing, the tension building to an exquisite crescendo.

Our eyes met, a silent understanding passing between us. This was a moment of discovery, of surrender, of embracing the unknown. We were on the brink of something profound, something that transcended mere physical pleasure.

With a shared glance, we stepped into the abyss, letting go of all inhibitions, all fears. Our bodies became instruments of pleasure, our souls intertwined in a dance of passion and power.

The world around us ceased to exist. There was only the here and now, the sensation of skin against skin, the taste of lips and the sound of

moans. We explored each other with a hunger that knew no bounds, a desire that was both primal and divine.

Time lost all meaning as we lost ourselves in each other, each touch a revelation, each kiss a promise. We were creators and destroyers, gods and mortals, lovers and warriors.

In that room, in that moment, we were infinite.

My primal hunger grew, a longing that sent my hand drifting past my throbbing phallus and into the velvet folds of my desire. With a shy, uncertain glance, Caroline instinctively lifted her hands to cover her exposed breasts, a blush of embarrassment coloring her cheeks. I stepped forward, my eyes locked on hers. “No,” I whispered, my voice soft yet firm, “you are so amazingly beautiful.” My arousal was evident, my engorged member pointing insistently at Caroline’s slender waist. Reaching up, I took her wrists and gently pulled them away from her breasts. I leaned forward, my lips finding the inside curve of her left breast, a place I knew she loved to be kissed, a secret shared between us.

Hester's naked hip and leg peeked from behind Caroline, a tantalizing glimpse of what awaited. Two worshippers, two supplicants, ready to explore the depths of pleasure with me. My cock slipped between Caroline's legs, brushing the inside of her thighs. Catherine moaned. Hester reached down and cupped the head of my penis. She swirled the precum she found there along the head and then brought her fingers to Caroline’s lips. “Taste,” she whispered. The taste of my precum acted as a potent aphrodisiac, igniting a fire of desire that danced in Caroline's eyes.

With a mere thought, a whisper of ancient magic, I transported the three of us onto the silken sheets of the bed, a place where pleasure knew no bounds. Caroline giggled and rolled on top of me. Her small, pert breasts pressed against mine, and my cock found a warm, inviting valley between her thighs. She leaned down and licked a drop of the clear liquid from the tip of my cock. Her eyes met mine, filled with a mix of wonder and desire. I reached up, my fingers lost in the silk of her hair, pulling her down to kiss me, a kiss that spoke of longing, of connection, of us.

Our lips met, and I tasted myself on her tongue. Our lips parted, and there were long strings of liquid that connected us. Hester ran a finger through the pre and slurped it into her mouth hungrily. The intoxicating scent of her arousal filled the air, a heady perfume that beckoned me closer. Then she kissed my lips, and our energies began to mingle. Suddenly, my body was fire. I loved the strength of her magic, a force that resonated with my soul, binding us in a dance of power and passion.

Hester quit our kisses and moved down the bed. Caroline pulled the tip of my cock out of her mouth with a tantalizing popping sound, her lips finding mine, a kiss that tasted of lust and promise. Her tongue found mine, and then I felt Hester’s hand on my thighs. There was hot breath along my skin. Caroline tucked a lock of my hair behind my ear as she kissed me. I drank in their energy, their passion, as if I had been parched for days, and they were the oasis I craved.

Caroline moaned. Her back arched, and her hips shifted. I realized that Hester was licking her pussy. I could feel her between our legs, her hair brushed against my thighs. I shifted my hips, eager for attention, and felt Hester slip a finger into my dripping snatch. It felt so good. Her fingers explored, teasing, slipping in, then out, a slow dance of first one, then two, a rhythm that built anticipation.

“Come here,” I reached down, my eyes locked with Caroline's, a silent plea in my gaze. “Let me taste you,” I whispered, a request filled with longing and trust. Caroline followed my motions and wriggled over me. I reached up and held both of her breasts as she dragged her soaking cunt across my right breast to straddle my face. Then she turned to watch Hester before kneeling over my waiting mouth. Her pussy, small and adorned with delicate red curls, glistened with anticipation. I slipped my tongue across her wet flesh. Her musk, a heady blend of desire and femininity, filled my senses, a fragrance that drew me deeper into her essence.

She moaned as my tongue reached her hole and pressed against the tight little slit. Hester took the opportunity to slide on top of me. I felt her hand grasp my cock, holding it firm and straight, an arrow aimed at the heavens. I felt her motions on the bed as I sucked and nibbled on

Catherine’s vulva and clit, sliding my tongue deeper inside of her every time she moaned. And then I felt the slick skin of Hester’s pussy rub my shaft. Holding me steady, she rocked her pussy against my shaft. Her pussy coated me with her love juice. When she was satisfied, she impaled herself on my length.

I felt her pussy part, a gateway to intimacy, the flesh hot and slick, a testament to our connection, our shared journey into pleasure. I reached down and found Hester’s hips. I pulled as she pressed the first few inches into her. Her inner warmth enveloped me, a velvet darkness that beckoned me deeper. She stood and then dropped herself onto me again. This time, I went deeper. “Oh!” She cried out as my turgid member stretched her wider and wider, her body sucking me in deeper and deeper with every motion.

Caroline’s hips shifted. I felt her lean forward, her body drawn toward Hester, a magnetic pull of shared pleasure. She put her hands on my breasts and squeezed as she began to undulate her hips against my tongue, driving herself closer and closer. I gently widened Hester’s entrance, and she gasped, a sound of pure pleasure, as half my cock slid into her welcoming depths. I dug my fingers into Caroline’s thighs as her orgasm reached a crescendo, and I swallowed her nectar. Hester sank deeper onto my cock.

Her darkness was velvet, a sensation that enveloped me in warmth and pleasure. She stood and then dropped herself onto me again, each motion taking me deeper, each cry from her lips a symphony of pleasure. Caroline’s hips shifted, her body responding to the rhythm of our passion. She put her hands on my breasts and squeezed, her touch a connection that drove her closer to the edge.

I widened Hester’s entrance, and she gasped as half my cock slid into her. I dug my fingers into Caroline’s thighs as her orgasm reached a crescendo, and I swallowed her nectar. Hester sank deeper onto my cock, her body a perfect fit, her movements a dance that matched the beat of my heart.

The room was filled with the sounds of our pleasure, the scent of our desire, the taste of our passion. We moved together, three bodies intertwined, three souls connected, three hearts beating as one. The pleasure built, a wave that grew and grew until it crashed over us, sweeping us away in a tide of ecstasy.

"Yes," I groaned as her fiery cunt engulfed my cock. She was so tight. Her pussy rippled as she swallowed me. Another moan escaped her lips.

Caroline moved off my face and turned to find me on the other side of her.

She jumped when she first saw me.

Then she looked back to where Hester was sucking my right nipple between her teeth and grinding her hips against me in a fury.

I couldn't help it. I needed to be in two places at once.

I slipped my arm around her and laid her on her back beside Hester and me.

Hester looked over and saw me hovering over the witch. Her eyes flashed in surprise and then she got a strange look on her face. It was only for a second. It was like she realized something she had never thought about before. And then it was gone.

I reached down and slipped two fingers into Caroline before introducing the tip of my cock.

"Goddess, you are so beautiful," Caroline kissed my neck and wrapped her legs around my waist.

I spread her wide and filled her in one thrust.

Her eyes glowed blue and she moaned in delight. "Yes," she panted, "yes."

I pulled back until only my tip stood at her entrance.

She smiled and nodded.

And I gave her another long thrust.

My pussy was on fire. I could feel both of them, their bodies wrapped around me. I fucked them in unison.

"Give her your cum," Hester gasped.

I slammed my cock into Hester and then Caroline.

“Yes!” Hester screamed.

“She loves it,” Hester said, her body shivering from the orgasm that controlled every muscle. “Give us your cum.”

Hot juices warmed my thighs as I heard their pussies slurping and sucking at every thrust.

Moans and cries mixed with my own.

I fucked them and fucked them.

Their eyes glowed like mine.

Their sweat glistened on their skin.

They begged for more and I gave it them until my cock boiled.

I held my breath as the familiar pressure filled me.

Hester slammed down; her pussy sucked me to the hilt.

Her eyes flashed blue and the black magic moved like ink across through her veins.

I closed my eyes and felt the exchange, the back and forth of our powers. We were caught in a cyclone of desire, feeding off each other, each growing stronger and then weaker.

I rushed toward my own climax. I thrust my hips in and out of her, faster and faster. I watched myself fuck Caroline.

I watched my ass move back and forth, the long lean muscles of my legs, my pendulous breasts swinging over Caroline’s body.

I watched the column of my flesh appear and disappear inside of her.

I had never done something like that before, broken myself into two, but it felt so natural and it was such a turn on to watch myself fuck Caroline.

“Cum!” Caroline clenched her jaw and every muscle went rigid as my hips stopped and my cock gushed inside of her.

I looked at Hester. She was watching me fuck Caroline too. Her fingers pinched her nipples, pulled on them, as her hips heaved, and her cunt milked my cock.

I let go.

My dick shot rope after rope of bliss inside of her.

She closed her eyes and rocked her hips gently back and forth.

I felt cum slide down my legs and over my ass. I had filled her and still I came.

Her belly bulged as her pussy overflowed.

It was another seven or eight hours, our umpteenth orgasm behind us, that the three of us laid there spent. I created a table of wine and cheese and fruit that we nibbled on while we laid on the bed and talked.

It reminded me of my youth, when I was just Emma, the awkward high school freshman who still had sleep overs.

I had been gone for two weeks, and Tucker's grasp on the city had only grown tighter. "Theresa Milner has been in the stocks for two days," Hester said, her voice tinged with concern.

"Her husband has accused her of witchcraft," Caroline added, her head laid against my right breast while I ran my fingers through her hair.

"For what?"

"I believe she is in love with a new young man from England," Hester sighed, her eyes narrowing.

"But that's not witchcraft," I said, curious.

Caroline chuckled. "Tucker needs the new young man to work for him, to expand his ever-growing empire."

"Putting him in the stocks won't serve Tucker's purpose," I observed.

"So," I sighed, realizing what was happening, "you punish the wife."

I thought of the way these women were constrained, every aspect of their lives dictated by others. A couple of hundred years and all of this would be gone. No one would remember Hester or Caroline. No one would know what they were a part of or how they fought to make their world better.

“And there is more. There has been talk of burning the tavern boat that anchors on the river,” Hester said, her voice filled with righteous indignation. “Tucker and his brother are taking over everything.”

“But the women,” Caroline said with some excitement, her eyes gleaming with hope.

“There are more and more of us,” Hester sat up, her face thoughtful.

I smiled. “That’s wonderful.”

“We need to take over the town,” Hester said, her voice filled with conviction.

Caroline sat up, and so did I.

“Take over the town?” I asked, my voice tinged with surprise.

“I have an idea,” Hester smiled, her eyes narrowing as she began to formulate a plan. She looked down over my body. “How many of you can there be?” She asked, like a kid who couldn’t keep a secret anymore, and I realized I had seen the germ of the idea earlier. But what was she planning?

“I don’t know,” I said, a hint of uncertainty in my voice. “I’ve never thought about it before.”

“Can you look differently when you divide and become more than one?”

I investigated her eyes. What was she getting at? “I don’t know,” I said, my voice filled with curiosity.

And then I was two.

The one behind Hester slipped her arms around her waist.

Then I was one more. This time beside Caroline.

“Oh,” Caroline gasped, her eyes wide with astonishment before a playful giggle escaped her lips. “I like it when I have one all to myself.” She slipped a leg between mine and captured my lips in a lingering kiss.

And then I was one more. This time I looked like Hester with dark hair and clever eyes. I leaned over and kissed Hester’s lips with her own.

Then I became another. I sandwiched Caroline’s me with a new Caroline.

“What if you seduced the men?” Hester asked, her eyes gleaming with a spark of mischief. “What if we could somehow seduce the men and catch them?” Hester mused, her face thoughtful, taking a moment to let the idea sink in.

“I want larger breasts,” Caroline said, her eyes fixed on her own modest pair, a longing in her voice.

Then her breasts grew, first on her and then her copy. It took a moment, but they swelled. The flesh ballooned, the nipples expanded. And suddenly, she had two large, heavy breasts that stood up and out. She ran her hands around the curves and smiled proudly. “How?”

“What happened?” She looked down at her chest, excited.

“It’s an after effect,” I said, my voice calm. “Our coupling. It will wear off shortly.”

“Can I grow one too?” she asked, her eyes fixed on the futanari gift lying against my thigh, flaccid.

Her clit began to slowly grow, a transformation that held everyone's rapt attention.

Caroline sat up and spread her legs. She watched her clit lengthen. Her body grew hot almost instantly. Her eyes glowed a pale blue, and she arched her back and bent her knees as the transformation moved through her.

Hester couldn’t resist, and soon there were five people crowding around Caroline’s sweating body.

Hands, fingers, and mouths explored everywhere, a symphony of sensation. As pleasure mounted, I manipulated time, driven by a greed for pleasure that knew no bounds.

And so, I gave us a day, almost a day, like twenty hours or so. I only stopped because I had exhausted them. It was impossible not to be. Both had been so eager.

And then they slept.

And while they slept, Hester and I walked along the shore.

I took her consciousness and gave it form.

“I missed you so much,” Hester said, her voice tinged with sadness as we walked. “Where did you go?”

“Something happened,” I said, my voice firm, determined not to delve into the painful memories. “I am better now.”

“I want to somehow besmirch them, to tarnish their false piety,” Hester said, her voice filled with righteous indignation.

“How will you stop them, then?” I asked, my voice filled with curiosity.

Hester stopped and looked at me, her eyes twinkling with a clever plan. “You,” she said, her voice filled with conviction. “You will seduce them, and together, we will expose them.”

I looked at her, intrigued. “How?”

“The hunting trip,” she chuckled, her eyes twinkling with a clever plan. “Of course.”

We continued to walk, the moon casting a soft glow on the water as we delved into the details of Hester's plan. The idea was daring, audacious even, but it held promise. It was a way to fight back, to reclaim some control in a world that seemed determined to suppress us.

I thought back to the history of the area, to the time of Puritan beliefs and shrewd business deals, a time when men used their influence and religion as power. Nothing Hester said surprised me, but it ignited a fire within me, a desire to challenge the status quo, to make a difference.

“I felt it,” Hester said, wrapping her arm around my waist and hugging me as we walked. “It hurt you. I wish I could have been there; I could have lent aid the way you lent me aid when Catherine almost died.”

I took a breath, the memories of pain and loss threatening to overwhelm me. “I am better now,” I sighed, my voice firm, determined not to tell the story. There was no reason. What had happened couldn't happen again. I had far better control over my power and hers.

“I want to somehow besmirch them,” Hester said after we had walked in silence, her voice filled with righteous indignation. “To tarnish their false piety.”

I nodded, understanding her anger, her desire for justice. “We will find a way,” I said, my voice filled with determination. “Together, we will make them pay for what they have done.”

We walked in silence for a while, the sound of the waves lapping at the shore a soothing melody. The world seemed to hold its breath, waiting for what was to come.

As we returned to the others, I looked at Hester, her face illuminated by the soft glow of the moon. I saw strength, determination, and a fierce intelligence. I knew then that we were on the brink of something significant, something that could change everything.

I took her hand, squeezing it gently. “We will succeed,” I said, my voice filled with conviction. “We will take back what is ours, and we will make a difference.”

She looked at me, her eyes filled with trust and determination. “Yes,” she said, her voice filled with resolve. “We will.”

And as we settled down to rest, the promise of a new beginning, a new fight, filled the air. The world was changing, and we were at the forefront, ready to shape it, to mold it into something better, something just.

***

I brought us back the evening that I had swept us away. It took an amazing amount of effort, moving through time, even such a short distance, was taxing. We appeared on the blanket in the field. The sky was a canvas of deep red and orange.

I took a breath. I felt like jelly.

Time was difficult.

Caroline pulled her shawl tight over her shoulders. “There’s a chill,” she looked around the empty fields around us.

Hester smiled. “I love this place,” she touched my hand. “It still echoes our power.” She smiled.

I remembered my secret. I thought of *that* moment. The moment Hester’s magic had mixed with mine. The moment we had saved Catherine’s life, but also created something else. I wanted to tell her, I wanted to tell her the whole story, but I didn’t.

And she hadn’t asked.

“We need to get back to the inn, Mary and Henry will be serving supper soon.” Catherine stood.

We stood and gathered the blanket. There was a bit of sadness as we began the walk back to town. We had shared so much bliss over the past two days. We had held each other exhausted only to rest, eat and drink, and then exhaust ourselves again.

But now we were here, back.

We reached the road that led into town.

“Do you think we can do it?” Catherine asked.

“It’s not going to be easy,” Hester stared at her feet. “All of them have to fall, we have to catch them in the transgression.” She glanced at me.

“The goddess can do it,” Catherine gave me a toothy smile.

“I will be irresistible,” instantly, I was naked except for a sheer, see through shift. I exaggerated my steps, acting as slink sexy as I could as we walked down the dirt road.

Both women laughed and laughed.

I changed back into my Puritan uniform.

“We will need witnesses. We will need men.” It was the only part of the plan that Hester seemed to struggle with.

“Henry would be good.” Catherine said.

“And the Ezekiel, the smithy.” I added. “He’ll be at his forge.”

“We want all of the wives.” Hester said.

“I think we should ring the bell.” Catherine folded her hands in front of her.

“They’ll hear it,” Hester said.

“No, they won’t,” I smiled.

We walked to the edge of town and I vanished from sight. I was still between them, but only they could see me.

“What will we do once we have them in stocks?” Catherine asked.

Hester looked around at the warm orange glow in the windows. A man on jackass road to the inn and tied up his animal. He gave the two

women walking toward him a long look before he turned to go inside.

"We will show them the power of the goddess," Hester looked at me and smiled. "We will start a new way of life, a new religion." She reached up and removed her bonnet. Her dark hair fell around her face.

The inn was crowded. From the window, we watched Mary walking between the six tables with a clay pitcher of house wine and wooden cups. Two of the tables were filled with French trappers all laughing and obviously happy to be out of the weather for a change.

We decided to forego the front door and used the back entrance. When Mary saw the two, she nodded and then rolled her eyes. We turned and walked upstairs to Hester's room.

"Good, now a few people have seen us," Hester smiled.

"Can we go back?" Catherine looked at me expectantly.

I reached out, took their hands, and we were back on the large bed covered in heavy quilts and pillows in the place I had created for us.

Catherine giggled and hurried to take off her clothes.

Hester smiled. "We only have a couple of days before the hunt," Hester said.

"I know," I smiled, and my robe vanished. "Plenty of time, right?"

***

Invisible, I watched them from the bell tower. The four were ready. Each man had a bedroll, a rifle, water, and other supplies for a few days in the wilderness.

It had been a tradition for them since they had landed from Europe. Every year the four would wander off into the woods for a few days. They went for deer, enough to feed their families for the winter. And every year they brought back at least three or four, dragging them on skids they constructed in the woods and pulled behind Victor's donkey.

But today was going to be different.

I watched as they finished. I had left Catherine and Hester at the inn and slipped to the bell tower. I wanted to watch them from the beginning. I

wanted to hear them talk. I wanted to really see what kind of people they were.

Following along, the four of them wandered down the dirt, main road that led out town. They didn't speak much. A few comments on the weather. A few arguments with the pack animals that wanted to back in their barns.

Eventually, curiosity got the better of me and I listened to Tucker's thoughts.

Hester's loan will be due in a week, but what am I going to do about Catherine's? I wish I could talk to her alone. I could show her that I could take care of her and that no one would have to know. Isn't that better than being in Hester's situation.

We need to construct a debtor's prison, like we had in the old country. I would keep her there till she rotted away. A pox on Hester, that woman is a plague. Why do so many women seem to follow her? We have to find a way to stop that practice.

I stopped listening. Anger welled-up inside me.

The crisp air was heavy with fog as the town disappeared behind them and they turned toward south toward the dense forests at the foot of the mountains.

Only, I didn't let them go toward the mountains.

No, as they road into the woods, I led them in circles. I drew my energy from the forest around me and made them see what they wanted, what they expected to see, while I led their animals and them in large circles.

What they perceived as hours of riding toward the mountains was really a long journey all the way around our town, just past the furthest farms and along the river.

They road until the sun was almost straight up in the sky before they decided to stop. Tucker picked a spot along the banks of a river and climbed off his horse. He scratched the wiry grey hair of his porkchop sideburns. "We can rest for a bit here," he announced. "Let the horses drink, we've been riding for hours." He pulled a water skin from his saddle and took a long draw from it.

Victor climbed off his horse and looked around. “How far do you think we have gone?”

I watched them from beside Tucker’s horse, where I stood stroking the nose of the animal, invisible to everyone except the horse.

A man named Abiel, one of Tucker’s closest friends, led his horse to the water and looked around.

I concentrated. Holding onto their perception was tricky. Making all of them see exactly what each of them expected along with everything they didn’t was like managing four marionettes with one hand.

Abiel looked across the river and saw the foothills he expected. “I would say we will be there before evening.” He pointed across the stream.

Now it was time for the second stage of the trap. While holding onto each man’s perceptions, I had to step away. Thankfully, I didn’t have to go far, maybe a few hundred meters, just out of sight.

When I had turned a gentle curve in the river’s flow, I found a small clearing surrounded by thick tangles of bushes and new trees. I closed my eyes and concentrated. We discovered that I had the ability to duplicate myself, creating various appearances to suit our needs. I had managed to manipulate Hester and Catherine's perceptions, but handling four men, creating individual copies, and orchestrating their discovery was proving to be a challenge.

I sat down on the ground. I put my hands on the dirt and closed my eyes. I balanced the four perceptions, allowing each man to see exactly what he expected even though none of it was real. Then I pictured four Indian women, four different faces, four different bodies, and ages. I thought of their eyes, their lips, the shape of their ears. I drew a little from each of the men’s personal desires. It wasn’t difficult. And then there were four of me.

I looked around at the team. We were all sufficiently different. I adorned us in the traditional attire of the local Native American tribe, a thin leather smock, complemented by necklaces and bracelets. I gathered a handful of leaves and turned them into blankets.

Each one of me began a different task. I concentrated on what I needed the four of us to sound like. I needed to get the attention of the men. I needed them to come looking for us. I began to talk about the laundry, how many blankets we had to do. One of me complained, another made a joke about how the men should do the washing.

Then we all laughed.

It was fun making the four different laughs. The younger me had a high-pitched twitter of a laugh, while the older woman, probably in her late thirties, had a husky laugh. Years of frontier life would harden her, I thought.

I listened and heard the men.

“Did you hear that?” Victor's voice trembled as he whispered from the bushes. Silence answered him, followed by the rustling of leaves as the man he asked rose, his eyes fixed on us, his rifle at his waist but ominously pointed in our direction.

I kept us talking. It didn’t matter what we said, we were too far away and speaking a language none of them had ever heard. We laughed and washed our blankets and then beat them over rocks.

The four of us worked for almost ten minutes before I heard heavy footfalls coming toward us along the shore.

It had worked.

I got excited, but that was only the second hurdle. There was still a whole bunch that could go wrong.

I concentrated and slowly sipped at the energy of the river that ran around my ankles, drawing just what I needed to keep a hold of all the strings. It was refreshing, almost cold, as it fed into my spirit.

Their footsteps grew closer. The laughter of a bunch of women brought them like firemen to a fire.

But they slowed as they got closer, and I knew they were hoping to see us before we saw them.

I stepped deeper into the stream with a blanket. The water was cold around my bare ankles. I turned toward where I knew the men were hiding and laid the blanket in the water.

Bending over, my breasts hung in full view.

All of them stared.

The water splashed at the back of my knees. I took an unsteady step and splashed into the water face first.

I couldn't help but laugh as I reappeared, the soaked leather dress clinging to me, a playful moment amidst the tension.

The three other versions of me all pointed and laughed as I playfully struggled to stand again, my blanket floating away downstream.

I reached down, grabbed the bottom of the smock, and quickly pulled it over my head.

My breasts bounced into view along with the rest of me.

I threw the soaked dress at the older version of myself.

I sensed the men's excitement, their desires tangled with my own conflicting emotions as I stood there, wet and exposed. My bronze skin glistened, my chest heaved with each panting breath, a mixture of exhilaration and fear pulsing within me.

Tucker stepped out from the bush first. He didn’t say a word to his companions. He simply stepped onto the shore and pulled a knife from his

belt.

He looked determined, bigger than he had looked earlier, it was like his determination had puffed him up.

I met his eye. I could see the excited anger, he was a madman, a predator. The naked woman in front of him was already worthless because of her race. To him, I was less than trash.

It was exactly like we had thought. Four women alone in the woods would be too much for them. Alone and unafraid, they would lose their sacred oaths.

The blanket flowed downstream which signaled Catherine and Hester to free the horses.

All four were untied and tore away back toward town, carrying both women as they went.

“Did you hear something?” Victor whispered from the bushes.

But the man he asked didn’t answer. Instead, he too stood up and started toward the four of us. His rifle at his waist but pointed at us.

I watched them move toward us.

All of us were silent.

I wondered if the other two would follow.

I could feel their dark energy, their raw lust, the animal desire.

My own darkness stirred.

Tucker looked at me, the youngest me, with hunger in his eyes. “You,” he waved the giant knife. “Get over here.” He pointed toward the shore.

I obeyed.

Then I heard Victor and the other man step out of the bushes.

They two had their guns pointed at us.

I had all four of them.

With a deep breath, I closed my eyes and spread my arms. Time seemed to freeze as all four versions of me moved in perfect unison. Then, in a heartbeat, I was one again, a goddess standing before them, invisible and powerful, the tension in the air palpable.

The men stood frozen.

I slipped into their minds and gave them their fantasies.

In his mind, Tucker held the knife to my throat as he bent me over a large stone, my breasts pressed into the wet grit and mud as he fucked me from behind.

I inhaled his desire. My own darkness stirred.

I felt his little cock poking in and out of my pussy.

I looked over and felt Abiel's much larger cock at the back of my throat. The leaves and sticks pressed into my knees.

Victor's thrusts, while my legs were wrapped around his waist, his robe behind my head, were hard and angry. I couldn't believe how tortured he was.

I wept as I gave them each the fantasy they desired. They were horrible men. Evil men. Hester had been right.

I continued to drain their energy, siphoning it away until they were weakened and vulnerable. But this was only the beginning; I had something

far worse in store, a plan that would unfold with each passing moment.

It took almost two hours before I heard horses. I held out my hands and gave them back a little of the energy I had drained from them. Their bodies writhed in pleasure and their attacks were renewed.

And then they came thundering through the woods.

Ezekiel was still wearing his heavy black apron. And in his left hand, like it was a part of him, was his hammer . He cut an impressive swath of space as he tromped forward through a shoulder-height thicket of thorns and brambles. But he stopped the moment I opened his eyes.

Tucker's wife Aria, Abiel's wife Edith, and Luke's wife Clarity were next.

Then came Henry and Mary. Henry had to squeeze space through the bramble, so he could see why everyone had suddenly stopped.

I used the bush as a border and gave each a vision of what was happening. Again, I became the puppet master with too many strings.

Three other women I didn't know pressed through the bushes too.

I closed my eyes as they approached and reached into their minds. All of them. And showed them what the men were doing.

I painted the scene exactly as they had pantomimed it.

Edith screamed. Clarity looked around for half a breath and then fainted, as did two other women.

I concentrated and held their perceptions – the men their transgression, the women witnesses.

Catherine and Hester stepped into the clearing. They could see me, and their eyes glowed a gentle blue for a split second.

Hester smiled. “They were all so concerned.” She glanced over her shoulder at the men and women from town.

“Well, the town elder’s horses come running into town ne’r a rider it is right to wonder, Hester,” Catherine laughed.

Hester looked around at the four. “I didn’t think Aria would come.” She said.

I looked at Aria and remembered the strange night of pleasure we had shared. It pained me that she could not.

“She looked terrified when she came running out of their house.” Catherine said.

“Yes, but then she saw us, and I thought I saw something…” Hester trailed off.

Then she turned to me. “It’s truly horrible isn’t it?”

“Yes,” I sighed, watching the crazed men fuck all around us.

“It’s the beginning of their undoing.” Hester gave the situation an appraising eye.

“And Friday is a full moon,” Catherine clapped with glee.

The coven. A few more days and I would meet the coven Hester had promised me. Tomorrow, I would get to see if any of this was going to be possible.

“Are you ready?” I looked at Hester who took Catherine’s hand and walked back through the bramble.

And then I became the four. I put everything in its place. And let time go.

The men looked at the crowd around them.

I screamed, then another me.

One of me ran away, naked into the forest.

Tucker had me by the wrist, his cock dripping cum onto my breasts when he saw Aria.

I thought his heart was going to stop.

Victor, alone after I had run into the woods, looked at the men and women standing in front of him. Then he looked down at his naked body. Then he fainted.

Mary screamed and pointed at Tucker. “Treachery! Vile lechery!”

The smith stepped forward with his hammer and ordered each of them to kneel. “We will bind them and bring them back to the town.”

Aria looked at Tucker and then turned and started back toward the town alone.

Another woman screamed and beat her fists against Luke’s chest. He stood there and took it, staring straight ahead, terrified of what was about to happen to them.

Henry took a step toward me, picked up Tucker’s shirt off the ground, and slowly handed it toward me. “Here, love.” His eyes never left mine.

I took the shirt and then ran into the woods, the last of us, gone.

I could hear the shouting and screaming behind me. We had just destroyed the entire town’s leadership. By sunset, the four stocks that Tucker had constructed outside the church would be filled with the disgraced men, a grim testament to their downfall. A power vacuum

loomed, a void left by Tucker and Victor, a void that would soon be filled by someone, heralding a new era of uncertainty.

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I retreated to the river, my feet tracing the familiar path along the shore, as the sun bade its slow farewell, sinking into the western horizon. Events had unfolded with a dizzying swiftness, leaving me breathless in their wake. A darkness settled over my thoughts, a shadow I couldn't shake. The punishment I had inflicted, the essence I had stolen from them, it haunted me, a question of right and wrong that gnawed at my soul.

Memories of the punishment I had meted out weighed heavily on my conscience. When they tied Tucker’s wrists, he looked ten years older than when he had arrived. His brother was the same. Abiel and Luke had fared better but only because they had had more to give.

A chill crept into the night air, sending a shiver down my spine, and I found myself turning back toward the warmth of the town, walking over the dunes and past the tall whip grass and forgotten shells. Exhaustion weighed me down, a heavy burden I couldn't shake. The darkness I had drained from the four men lingered within me, a tainted energy that offered little solace.

As I stepped into the shadowy embrace of the woods, darkness wrapped around me like a cloak, hiding the world from view. Images of the ancient church, with its weathered stones and hidden secrets, filled my mind. I was on the verge of stepping into its shadowed embrace when a rustle to my left caught my attention.

Glancing down, I discovered a cat, its soft purrs filling the silence as it affectionately rubbed its side against the rough bark of a tree. With cautious curiosity, I took a step toward the creature, and it halted, its eyes locking onto mine, filled with an unspoken understanding.

A smile tugged at my lips. “What are you about, little one?” I asked, leaning over with childlike wonder, arms outstretched in invitation. The

cat's eyes sparkled with mischief as it slow-stepped around a sapling, its tail playfully curling around a branch, teasing me with its grace.

A fascination took hold of me, and I found myself leaping after it, drawn into its enigmatic dance. A memory surfaced, unbidden—the cat at Victor's house, its grey, smoky fur and piercing green eyes. A connection I couldn't quite grasp.

The air shimmered, a tangible ripple in reality, and I felt a profound shift, as if the very fabric of the world had been altered. In an instant, the world shifted, and I found myself standing in Tucker's house, Aria's presence filling the room, her eyes wide with surprise.

“You don’t understand the delicate balance here,” she said, her head tilting to the side, her voice laced with a warning I couldn't quite grasp. “You have to get Tucker out of the stocks.”

I stared at her, my mind reeling. What had just transpired? Was she a witch, or was there something more to her power? I opened my mouth, words forming and dissolving in a whirl of confusion. I closed it again, the silence heavy with the weight of unspoken questions.

“But her powers, the way she had found me and traversed the distance with such ease, it stirred a curiosity within me, a longing to understand the deeper forces at play,” I thought to myself.

“You cannot trust Hester,” Aria looked me in the eyes, her voice filled with urgency. “You don’t understand.”

“Tell me,” I urged, my voice tinged with frustration and desire.

“There’s no time,” she whispered, her eyes filled with sorrow.

She blinked and vanished.

I reached out to touch her before she was gone, but the space where she had stood was empty, leaving me with a sense of loss and a multitude of

unanswered questions.

But I knew where she was going.

To the church.

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Author's Note

Hey there,

If you've made it this far, I bet Emma and her sultry circle have left you a little... intrigued. Thank ypu for letting me tease your imagination and tickle your senses.

Craving more delicious secrets and forbidden spells? I've got a treat for you. I've just uncorked my brand-new Patreon, where the magic gets even naughtier.

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Until our next rendezvous,

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